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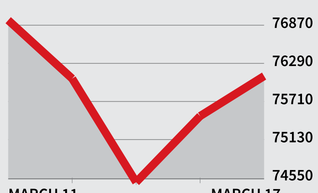

IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23581.15	+172.35
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.88	+0.15
US Dollar (in ₹)	92.37	-0.05
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	155045.00	-45
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	252340.00	+3629

WAR IMPACT. **Demand for Indian cotton yarn** picks up in China, Bangladesh and Vietnam, following the disruption in global logistics **p9**

DUTY STANDOFF. **At WTO MC14,** India opposes the US bid for a permanent ban on e-commerce duty **p10**

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QUICKLY.

COMPLIANCE BOOST

SEBI eases nomination rules for demat, MF a/cs

Mumbai: The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has proposed changes to simplify nomination norms for demat accounts and mutual fund folios, aiming to reduce onboarding friction and improve compliance. The regulator has suggested making nomination the default option for new accounts, with investors required to explicitly opt out if they do not wish to appoint a nominee. **p6**

SETBACK FOR UNITS

LPG crisis triggers migrant labour disruption

Chennai: With almost a week gone by since the LPG crisis hit industries, the hospitality, medium industrial units and logistics sectors are staring at a labour crisis with migrant workers either returning home or not in a hurry to get back to work. Migrants from Assam and West Bengal working in Tamil Nadu were planning to go home in April to cast their votes, but some have already left for their hometowns as they are not able to manage food, said a Chennai restaurant manager. **p11**

Low on gas: Fertilizer shortage feared ahead of kharif season

NUTRIENT DEFICIENCY. Govt pushing coop units to raise output, faces higher subsidy burden

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

With no end in sight to the Iran war as Tehran retaliates, India's fertilizer industry is worried whether the country will have ample urea supplies for the coming kharif season.

The season accounts for 60 per cent of annual agricultural output.

One clear signal that emerges is that the country may have to pay a higher price for fertilizers this year, particularly urea, pushing up production costs and potentially increasing the government's subsidy burden.

The government is trying to ensure adequate supplies of urea during the kharif season, mainly through cooperative manufacturing units such as IFFCO and Kribhco, besides public sector NFL.

A former senior official of the Fertiliser Association of India said that as the government had directed fertilizer companies to use all the produced ammonia only for urea production, it would help generate additional output.

SUPPLIES RISE

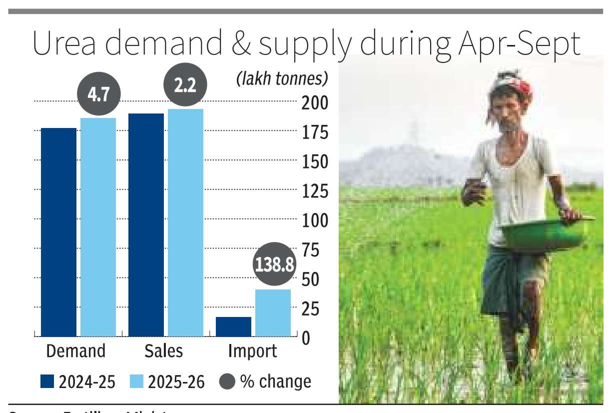
Sources said cooperative major IFFCO continued to run three of its five urea plants at full capacity as the gas received (at 65 per cent) for all the five plants is currently being used by the three operational units. Two plants are closed for annual maintenance.

Similarly, another cooperative, Kribhco, has been operating its Hazira unit at lower capacity since the gas supplied is yet to reach 65 per cent. Its Hazira unit produced 2.34 mt of urea in 2023-24, exceeding its capacity of over 2.1 mt.

Public sector National Fertilizers (NFL), which is operating four out of 5 plants, is utilising 65 per cent capacity, the sources said.

The urea plant at Nangal in Punjab is now under annual maintenance while four plants are likely to be closed either later this month or in April, the sources said.

Gas supplies to major fertilizer companies have increased to 65 per cent of the demand now. However, some companies are yet to get 65 per cent supply, though it has improved in the past week.



Source: Fertilizer Ministry

OTHER SOURCES

A New Delhi-based analyst said India could make up with gas supplies from Russia, the US, Brazil and Guyana. "We may have to pay more," he said.

Research agency BMI, a unit of Fitch Solutions, said India could increase natural gas imports from Russia to bridge the supply gap for fertilizer companies.

In the 2025 kharif season, urea demand was estimated at 18.54 million tonnes (mt), but sales rose 4 per cent to 19.32 mt. Government data show that the urea stock position was 6.15 mt as of March 10. If last year's kharif production of 14.48 mt can be met, it can ensure enough availability.

ALLOCATION HIKED

"Since April is a lean season for urea plants as kharif sowing commences with the arrival of monsoon in the mainland around June 1, with the current lower supply the production can be managed after some factories advanced their maintenance to March. The domestic urea production in 2025 March was 2.48 mt and in April 2.19 mt," said AK Singh, an agriculture scientist.

The analyst said the government would have to incur more towards fertilizer subsidy in the 2026-27 fiscal.

Urea subsidy for the 2026-27 fiscal has been pegged at ₹1,16,805 crore, 7.6 per cent lower than ₹1,26,475 crore in FY26. Within this, the subsidy for imported urea has been hiked by over 52 per cent.

The subsidy on imported urea was estimated at ₹2,100/bag (of 45 kg) and for domestically produced urea ₹1,397/bag during Q3FY2 since the crop nutrient is sold to farmers at ₹267/bag.

Also read p8

'$130 crude over 2-3 quarters can trim India's GDP growth by 100 bps'

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

If crude prices remain at $130 a barrel for 2-3 quarters, GDP growth could be impacted by 100 bps, Chief Economic Advisor V Anantha Nageswaran has told a parliamentary panel. India can sustain its growth momentum if the prices are around $90 a barrel, he added.

The CEA made these remarks when he appeared before the Standing Committee on Finance on March 2. The committee's report was tabled on Tuesday.

Giving details of his deposition, the report said the CEA was asked how the government plans to mitigate the "triple whammy" of surging crude prices, market volatility and maritime delays caused by the West Asia conflict. He was also quizzed about the government's strategy to protect domestic fuel prices.

SCENARIO ANALYSIS

The CEA presented multiple scenarios. He shared with committee members the results of a stress-test, simulating how the macroeconomy would react to oil at $90, $110 and $130 per barrel.

The CEA emphasised that the ultimate impact will depend on how long these prices remain relevant. If the shock is short-lived, then even if it surges to $130, it will not matter.


Chief Economic Advisor V Anantha Nageswaran

"By and large, the answers we get suggest that up to $90 per barrel, the macroeconomic assumptions for 2026-27 of achieving 7-7.4 per cent real GDP growth, inflation remaining at or around 2 per cent, a current account deficit of 1-1.2 per cent and a fiscal deficit of 4.3-4.4 per cent will be feasible," he said. In other words, up to $90, the macroeconomic impact is almost insignificant or not relevant.

MACRO HIT

"At $130 per barrel, if the price of oil remains at that level for about 2-3 quarters, then the macroeconomic impact will be fairly significant. CPI inflation will rise towards 5.5 per cent. Real GDP growth will decrease from 7.4 per cent to 6.4 per cent. The current account deficit will increase from 1.2 per cent, where we currently are, to around 3.2 per cent. The fiscal deficit may rise from 4.4 per cent to 5.6 per cent," he said.

GCC RISKS

Nageswaran also added that the analysis will be fine-tuned based on additional data and as clarity emerges regarding the war's objectives and its impact on oil prices. The Strait of Hormuz passage will not only be for oil but also for liquefied natural gas, LPG and other items.

He said there will be implications for remittances and other factors, considered in the current account deficit. For example, when oil reaches $130, the fact that the current account deficit could reach 3.2 per cent also takes into account the possibility of further disturbances and impact within the GCC countries, given Iran's current trend of attacking them, he added.

In its observation, the Standing Committee noted with serious concern the potential for a "triple whammy" of surging crude prices, market volatility and maritime delays arising from the West Asia conflict. Accordingly, it recommended that the Department of Economic Affairs develop a strategic energy mitigation framework to protect the economy from oil price shocks exceeding $90.

All 30 grounded legacy planes of Air India back in service

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

Air India has brought back into service all 30 grounded aircraft inherited at the time of its privatisation, raising its current fleet strength to 186 planes, industry sources told *businessline*.

With the return to service of Boeing 777-300ER VT-ALL, all the long-grounded aircraft, 19 narrowbody and 11 widebody, have been restored.

Sources said the development marked a significant milestone in Air India's transformation journey. At the time of privatisation, Air India had inherited a total of 110 legacy aircraft, of which as many as 30 were long-grounded.

Notably, the VT-ALL will now go for a comprehensive $400 million retrofit programme from 2027.

Sources said at the time of Air India's return to the Tata Group in 2022 that rebuilding the fleet and restoring operational capability were identified as a "key priority".

When contacted, Air India's Chief Operations Officer Captain Basil Kwauk acknowledged the development, stating that that Boeing 777-300ER VT-ALL is back in service.

Details p12

Iran's security chief Ali Larijani killed, says Israel

Reuters
Dubai/Jerusalem

Israeli Defence Minister Israel Katz said on Tuesday that Iran's security chief and the head of its Basij militia were killed in airstrikes overnight, even as Tehran kept up attacks against Gulf neighbours pushing up energy prices.

Katz said in a statement that he had been informed by the military that Iran's security chief Ali Larijani had been killed.

Iranian state media published a handwritten note by Larijani commemorating Iranian sailors killed in a US attack, whose funeral was expected on Tuesday, but there was no immediate comment by Tehran on Katz's remarks.

Larijani would be the senior most figure assassinated since Supreme Leader Ayatollah Khamenei was killed on the first day of Israeli-US airstrikes on February 28. Katz said Gholamreza Soleimani, the commander of Iran's Basij forces, had also been killed.

The Basij militia is a part-time paramilitary force under the control of the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps that is often used to quell protests inside Iran.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's office said in a statement that the Israeli leader had ordered "the elimination of senior officials of the Iranian regime".


Ali Larijani

The US-Israeli war on Iran is in its third week, with at least 2,000 people killed and no end in sight. The Strait of Hormuz remains largely closed and US allies have rebuffed US President Donald Trump's calls on them to help to reopen the vital waterway, through which about 20 per cent of global oil and liquefied natural gas flows.

There was no let-up in attacks by both sides early on Tuesday, with Iran launching missiles on Israel overnight, underscoring that Tehran retains the capacity to carry out long-range strikes despite more than two weeks of pounding by American and Israeli weapons.

The Israeli military said it was targeting "Iranian regime infrastructure" with a new wave of strikes across Tehran, as well as Hezbollah sites in Beirut, a day after saying it had drawn up detailed plans for at least three more weeks of war with Iran.

India in talks with Iran, US for Hormuz transit of LPG ships

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

India is in talks with Iran, the US and GCC countries for the safe passage of around 2.7 lakh tonnes (lt) of liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) across the Strait of Hormuz.

At present, six fully laden LPG carriers with a capacity of around 45,000 tonnes are stranded in the Persian Gulf west of the Strait, ready to deliver the critical commodity to India.

Asked about the volume of LPG in the ships, Rakesh Kumar Sinha, Special Secretary, Shipping Ministry, said on Tuesday: "I don't have their product volume details right now. However, each ship can carry around 45,000 tonnes of LPG."

Randhir Jaiswal, spokesperson in the Ministry of External Affairs, said the Ministry continues to closely monitor the evolving situation in West Asia and the Gulf region.

"Our objective is to continue the dialogue with Iran and other countries to get other ships stationed in the Persian Gulf to safely transit the Strait of Hormuz and reach India," he added, when asked about talks with Iran on the passage of stationed vessels.

Details p3

QUICKLY.

Andhra Petrochemicals suspends Vizag ops

Hyderabad: Andhra Petrochemcials has suspended operations at its Visakhapatnam plant after Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd (HPCL) halted the supply of a key raw material. Operations were suspended due to a disruption in the supply of propylene, after HPCL stopped it amid the ongoing Iran–US–Israel conflict. OUR BUREAU

VinFast extends free EV charging drive

Chennai: Building on the success of its current free electric vehicle charging programme, Vietnam's electric vehicle maker VinFast has announced an extension of free EV charging for customers purchasing EVs in three Asian markets - India, Indonesia and the Philippines, till March 2029. OUR BUREAU

CEAT to invest fresh ₹1,300 crore in radial tyre plant near Chennai

EXTRA MILE. Additional investment at the facility exceeds commitment of ₹4,000 crore

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

Tyre maker CEAT Ltd plans to invest a fresh ₹1,300 crore to expand passenger car radial (PCR) tyre capacity at its manufacturing facility in Sriperumbudur near Chennai, taking the cumulative investment at the plant to ₹4,800 crore, surpassing its original commitment of ₹4,000 crore.

The company has already invested about ₹3,500 crore in the facility.

The expansion will add around 35 lakh tyres annually, increasing total PCR capacity from 95 lakh units to about 1.3–1.4 crore tyres, depending on the product mix.

The enhanced capacity is expected to be operational by the first half of FY28.

Civil works are likely to begin in the coming months, with equipment orders already placed, said Jayasankar Kuruppal, Senior Vice-President (Manufacturing).

> The facility is a key export hub; nearly 40% of PCR output shipped to markets such as Europe, Middle East and Latin America
>
> JAYASANKAR KURUPPAL
> Senior V-P (Manufacturing)

Located in Kanchipuram district near Chennai, the 63.4-acre facility currently produces passenger car radial tyres, truck and bus radial (TBR) tyres and two-wheeler tyres.

TBR LINE

The plant commenced operations in February 2020 with PCR and two-wheeler tyre lines, and later added a TBR line in September 2024, expanding its product portfolio.

Alongside the PCR expansion, CEAT is also doubling TBR capacity from 5 lakh to 10 lakh tyres annually.

At present, the unit produces about 20,000–22,000 passenger car tyres per day and operates at 80–85 per cent capacity utilisation.

It employs around 1,500 people across three production lines, he said.

Kuruppal said that the facility has also emerged as a key export hub, with nearly 40 per cent of its PCR output shipped to markets such as Europe, the Middle East and Latin America.

The company is also expanding its presence in the US market.

CEAT began exports from the plant in 2017 with about 10,000 tyres per month, with volumes steadily rising since.

LOCATION FACTOR

The plant's location near major OEM hubs in southern India — home to companies such as Hyundai Motor Company, Renault-Nissan and Daimler AG, along with two-wheeler makers like Yamaha Motor Company, TVS Motor Company and Royal Enfield — was a key strategic factor.

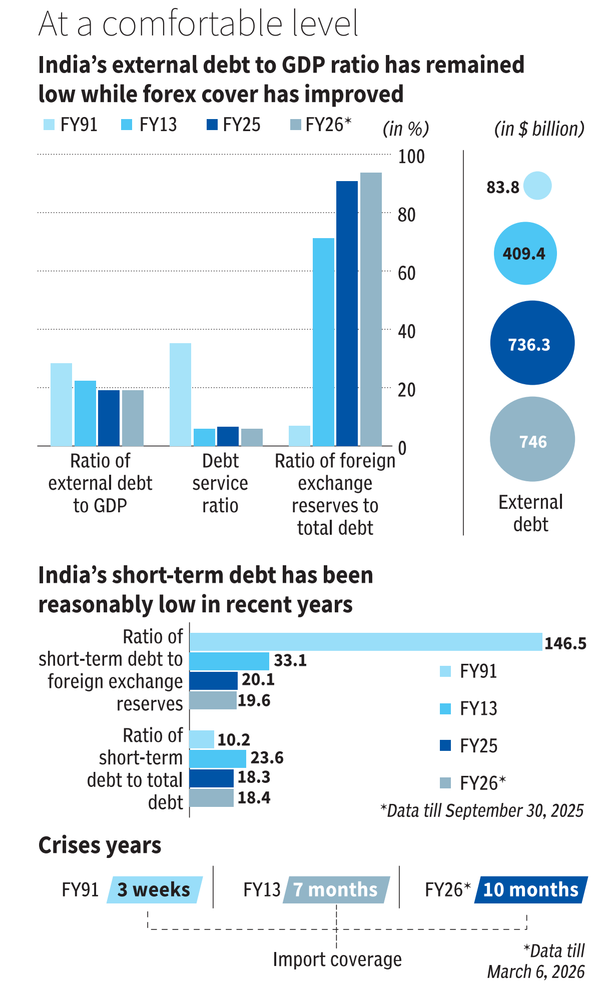
Productivity at the plant is about 30 per cent higher than some of its older plants, driven by newer machinery and Industry 4.0 technologies.

With the latest investment, CEAT expects the Sriperumbudur plant to play a larger role in its growth strategy, catering to both domestic demand and export markets, he said.

External debt manageable compared to previous balance of payments crises

Sourashis Banerjee
Chennai

The escalation of the West Asia conflict following the February 28 strikes on Iran and the subsequent disruption of the Strait of Hormuz has raised concerns about stress on our external account. With about 50 per cent of India's crude oil imports and 80-90 per cent of LPG imports passing through this route, the risks are real, as increased cost of imports and a weakening rupee can rapidly deplete our foreign exchange reserves.



DATA FOCUS.

To assess the situation, *businessline* compared current external sector indicators with those seen during the FY91 balance of payments crisis and the FY13 taper tantrum. We found that while pressures are building, India's fundamentals are stronger today.

Key indicators showed a more stable external position. India's external debt stood at $746 billion towards the end of September 2025, almost unchanged from the beginning of the fiscal year. While debt is almost 82 per cent higher than the level of $409 billion towards the end of FY13, the increase is in line with the increase in size of the economy. The external debt to GDP ratio, at 19 per cent currently, is significantly lower than in FY91 (28 per cent) and below FY13 levels of 22 per cent, indicating that the overall debt burden relative to the size of the economy is manageable.

REPAYMENT

The debt-service ratio, which measures how much of export earnings go toward repaying debt, remains in a comfortable range of only 6 per cent, suggesting that repayment obligations are not overwhelming. Although the debt-service ratio was 6 per cent only in FY13, the ratio of forex reserves to total debt was significantly lower (at 71 per cent) then, leaving little headroom for crisis financing. Presently, forex reserves to total debt stands at 94 per cent, covering a substantial portion of total debt, providing a strong liquidity buffer. Short-term debt, often a major risk during crises due to refinancing pressures, remains contained and within safe limits of about 20 per cent of forex reserves.

During FY13, this metric was at 33 per cent, and a mind-boggling 146.5 per cent in FY91. The measure for import cover shows how many months of imports can be financed using current forex reserves. Higher import cover means greater resilience during external shocks such as supply disruptions or oil price spikes. India's current import cover remains comfortably at 10 months and has not shown signs of drastic fall yet.

During the FY13 taper tantrum crisis, our import cover had suddenly fallen to seven months on the back of the rupee losing 15 per cent of its value against the US dollar, between May and August of that year. As for the crisis of FY91, according to Dr YV Reddy, the import cover hardly ever crossed 3-4 months in the pre-liberalisation era. In a 2002 address, he said: "In fact, it is often held that, between 1956 and 1992, India faced balance of payments constraints in all but six years."

However, the Gulf war (1990-91) and the ensuing oil price spike drastically increased our import bill. By June 1991, India's foreign exchange reserves had dwindled to $1.2 billion, enough to cover about 13-20 days of imports. Although we are nowhere near those levels, history has a tendency to repeat itself, fuelling fears.

Some early warning signs are emerging as well. Within just one week of the conflict, from February 27 to March 6, India's forex reserves declined by $12 billion, falling from $728 billion to $716 billion.

Tata Steel to invest $2 b in overseas arm

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Tata Steel will invest $2 billion (₹18,488 crore) in its Singapore-based wholly owned subsidiary T Steel Holdings Pte in tranches from FY27.

The proposed fund infusion will be used by TSHP to support the overseas subsidiaries for its business operations (including capex and restructuring costs), and for repayment of existing debt.

The board of directors of the company, that met here on Tuesday, also approved the proposal to merge its wholly owned subsidiary Neelachal Ispat Nigam with itself.

NINL operates an integrated steel plant at Kalinganagar in Odisha with a rated crude steel production capacity of 0.98 million tonnes per annum. It also holds a mining lease for a captive, fully mechanised open cast iron ore mine located in Sundergarh and Keonjhar districts, Odisha.

The amalgamation will result in operational efficiencies and business synergies besides resulting in simplified corporate holding structure and agility to business ecosystem of the merged entity, Tata Steel stated.

SINGLE ENTITY

The merger will consolidate long products assets under a single entity unlocking the opportunity for creating shareholder value. The proposed amalgamation will reduce administrative costs of maintaining separate companies, while reducing multiple legal and regulatory compliances. The proposed merger will bring down operational costs through pooling of orders, improved sales and production planning.

Iron ore sourced from the mines of both NINL and Tata Steel can be used appropriately which can enhance overall life of mines of the merged entity.

Consolidation and optimisation of stockyards will significantly reduce logistics and distribution costs for the merged entity.

Clubbing of cargoes may keep lower shipping costs, port terminal charges and ocean freight. The move will reduce inventory levels and release working capital from the system. Furthermore, efficiency in debt and cash management will improve cash flow.

Tata Steel will also acquire Medica TS Hospital which owns and operates a multi-speciality hospital in the Kalinganagar Industrial complex, Odisha, with a capacity of 100 beds. The company will pay ₹1.49 crore to Manipal Hospitals Eastern India to complete the deal. The transaction is expected to be completed in one month. The hospital is the only multi-speciality facility in Kalinganagar.

Maruti served ₹5,786 crore income-tax order

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Maruti Suzuki India (MSI) on Tuesday said it has received a draft assessment order worth ₹5,786.4 crore from the income tax authority and the company will challenge the order.

"The company has received a Draft Assessment Order for FY 2022 – 23 wherein certain additions/disallowances amounting to ₹57,864 crore with respect to returned income has been proposed," the carmaker said in a BSE filing. MSI will file its objections before the dispute resolution panel, it stated. There is no impact on financial, operation or other activities of the company due to this order, it added.

Hotel Leela acquires Coorg resort for ₹560 crore, forays into wellness space

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

Leela Palaces Hotels & Resorts has acquired a luxury resort in Coorg for ₹560 crore, marking its foray into nature-led and wellness-anchored business.

Hotel Leela said the Coorg resort has 71 villas spread over 76 acres. Additionally, 54 acres is available for expansion. In phase I, 19 villas will be added increasing the total inventory to 90 villas.

The resort is expected to generate a stabilised revenue of ₹165–175 crore with a margin profile similar to existing properties, the company said in a stock exchange notification. "This acquisition represents both a milestone and an evolution of the brand into nature-immersive, wellness-focused hospitality. We invest in destinations with cultural and ecological value, and Coorg strengthens our presence in South India while advancing our strategy of building a balanced portfolio across India's most iconic landscapes," CEO Anuraag Bhatnagar said.

15 PROPERTIES

With the addition of Coorg, The Leela portfolio now comprises 15 properties with over 4,160 keys across 13 cities. The chain has nine hotels in the pipeline and remains on track to expand to 24 properties over the next three years in high growth markets including Agra, Ayodhya, Bandhavgarh, Mumbai, Ranthambore, Sikkim, Srinagar and Jaisalmer. Hotel Leela is the second luxury brand entering wellness space in recent months. Last November, the Indian Hotels Company acquired Atmantan, a 96-key luxury centre in Mulshi near Pune.

"This property and this brand (Atmantan) is projected to generate a revenue of approximately ₹100 crore in FY27 with strong margin characteristics aligned to the premium wellness positioning," IHCL MD & CEO Puneet Chhatwal had said in the third quarter result conference call.

In the next three years, IHCL plans to grow the Atmantan brand with its founders in a hybrid fashion focusing on new projects in Kerala and the western States.

FTAs set to drive luxury car market: Audi India

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

German luxury carmaker Audi said with India signing free trade agreements (FTAs) with developed countries over the last few years, there would be more disposable income with people which may ultimately increase buying power and thereby help the luxury car market to grow in the country.

9 FTAs SIGNED

"India has signed nine FTAs in the last two years and most of these FTAs have been signed with countries where per capita income is much more than ours. This means we have signed the deals mostly with developed nations, which provides a lot of buying power. India has an opportunity to export a lot of 'Made in India' stuff that eventually means that our businesses will grow there and people will have much more disposable income with them, and if that happens, the industry will grow in the luxury space," Balbir Singh Dhillon, Brand Director, Audi India, told *businessline*. He added that the FTA between India and European Union wouldn't make a difference for companies like Audi as most products made here are for domestic consumption only.

FINE PRINT

"We don't need to limit ourselves to certain cars because 95 per cent of cars we make are sold in India, made in India... So let's see. It is important that we get to see the fine print because there is so much information in the market right now..., so we will wait for exact details," Dhillon said.

He said the luxury car market is expected to grow at 5-7 per cent this year and not in double digits because of several geopolitical and macro-economic issues, and one of the major challenges being currency fluctuation.

THE NEW SQ8

"Currency fluctuation has impacted us negatively. All the GST benefits that we got were passed on to customers; but you see, last year, between euro and rupee, the depreciation was about 19-20 per cent. Now the euro is hovering around ₹106-107. You can imagine, from January 2025, from about ₹90-odd, where it has reached now," he added.

Meanwhile, Audi launched the new SQ8 in India priced at ₹1,77,72,000 (ex-showroom). The SQ8 occupies a singular position in the Q8 line-up, blending commanding presence, exhilarating performance and everyday practicality in a single, highly versatile package, the company said.

Bajaj Electricals acquires IP, brand rights for Morphy Richards in India

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Bajaj Electricals Ltd on Tuesday said that it has signed a definitive agreement to acquire the intellectual property and brand rights of Morphy Richards in India and select South Asian markets for a consideration of ₹141.4 crore. This deal builds upon more than two decades of successful collaboration under licensing agreements and enables Bajaj Electricals to fully own and steer the Morphy Richards portfolio in India, Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka and the Maldives.

Morphy Richards, founded in the UK in 1936, is known globally for its premium, design-led home appliances and personal care products. In India, since 2002, Bajaj Electricals has sold the brand under licensing arrangements. In 2022, the parties extended their trademark licensing agreement for 15 years, reaffirming the long-term commitment.

GREATER VALUE

"With this acquisition, Bajaj Electricals will strengthen its multi-brand strategy, enabling deeper investments in innovation, design, and go-to-market execution. The company anticipates creating greater value for consumers, channel partners, and shareholders by owning full control of the brand in the regions," a statement said.

"This acquisition is a natural next step in our portfolio journey. Over the years, we have understood Indian consumers' evolving needs for convenience, design, and reliability. Acquiring Morphy Richards brand gives us the strategic flexibility to invest more consistently, innovate faster, and accelerate growth across premium consumer segments," said Sanjay Sachdeva, MD and CEO, Bajaj Electricals Ltd.

"We are pleased to entrust the Morphy Richards brand in India and neighbouring markets to Bajaj Electricals...," said Fergal Naughton, Executive Chairman, Glen Dimplex.

Renault ready with EV, but the Indian market isn't

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Renault India, the wholly owned subsidiary of French carmaker Renault Group, on Tuesday said it is ready for its first electric vehicle (EV), but will launch only when the market is right for consumers as EV penetration is still only 4 per cent of the overall car market.

CAUTIOUS APPROACH

"We have got the technology and we made a choice to bring a platform that is EV-ready. So, as soon as we see that there is a good natural demand coming for EV, we will get it. The decision is made, even the announcement is made. Now, the question is when, and I think we need to go step-by-step. In the last few years, we haven't been so present in the market, so let's go step by step. The first step for us is the Duster with hybrid, which was a must. Then there will be a few more products, and then... we will come up with an EV," Francisco Hidalgo, Vice-President – Sales & Marketing, Renault India, told *businessline* on the sidelines of the new Duster launch here.

Francisco Hidalgo, Vice-President – Sales & Marketing, Renault India

He said the decision has been made, but Renault wanted to make sure the company does not skip any steps, as it would not make sense for Renault right now.

GLOBAL EV TRENDS

"Today is not a time for us, but it's going to come in some, probably months, or years, but not too many... I think everybody is looking at the EV platform and most of the EV sales that are done, I would say, they are pushed by novelty. It's like a fashion product when there is a new car that comes, a lot of people buy it. But, then when you look at the life cycle, it goes up very high and then it goes down very high for most of the vehicles, and that's something that has been happening on the early stages everywhere in the world," he noted. However, he also added that in India, things can change very quickly, and the company should be ready to make certain decisions.

FLEXIBLE PLANS

"In India, what we see is that things can change very fast. So, I would say 4 per cent (EV penetration) is still not good enough for us to make that jump. But, now that we cannot wait to be late... we are ready," Hidalgo said, adding that the Bridger concept that is already being planned, with the production expected to start next year, and after that, the EV can also come because for Renault too, EV "is definitely a big part of the future". Meanwhile, Renault India launched the all-new Duster with a turbo-petrol engine, priced between ₹10.49 lakh and ₹18.49 lakh (ex-showroom, Delhi). The company first launched the Duster in 2012, but discontinued in 2022. The all-new Duster is built on the advanced Renault Group Modular Platform (RGMP) and has been developed with a clear focus on structural robustness, efficiency and future-readiness, the company said.

QUICKLY.

'War may push 45 m into acute hunger by June'

Geneva: Tens of millions more people will face acute hunger if the Iran war continues through to June, according to analysis from the World Food Programme. The US-Israeli attacks on Iran that began have choked up key humanitarian aid routes, delaying life-saving shipments to some of the world's worst crises. An extra 45 million are projected to be pushed into acute hunger because of rise in food, oil and shipping costs, said Carl Skautold, Deputy ED of World Food Programme. REUTERS

India in talks with Iran for safe passage of 2.7 lt of LPG

FOR THE PEOPLE. Sujata Sharma, Joint Secretary, Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas, said the govt is ensuring that supplies to households are not hit

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

India is in talks with Iran, the US and GCC countries for the safe passage of around 2.7 lakh tonnes (lt) of liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) across the Strait of Hormuz. At present, six fully laden LPG carriers with capacity of around 45,000 tonnes are idling in the Persian Gulf west of the Strait, ready to deliver the critical commodity to India.

Asked about the volume of LPG in stationed ships, Rakesh Kumar Sinha, Special Secretary at the Shipping Ministry, said on Tuesday: "I don't have their product volume details right now. However, each ship can carry around 45,000 tonnes of LPG."

Randhir Jaiswal, spokesperson for the Ministry of External Affairs, said the Ministry continues to closely monitor the evolving situation in West Asia and the Gulf region.

"Our objective is to continue the dialogue with Iran and other countries to get other ships stationed in the Persian Gulf to safely transit the Strait of Hormuz and reach India," he added, when asked about talks with Iran on the passage of stationed vessels.

DOMESTIC SUPPLIES

Sujata Sharma, Joint Secretary at the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas (MoPNG), said that despite the LPG situation being a "matter of concern", the Ministry has ensured that supplies to households are not affected. Priority sectors continue to receive protected gas supplies, including 100 per cent supply to PNG and CNG, while supplies to industrial and commercial consumers are being regulated at around 80 per cent, she added. Sharma noted that panic booking for LPG cylinders has come down. The peak of panic booking was on March 13 when bookings had hit around 89 lakh compared to the normal of around 50 lakh per day. "Today, it is 70 lakh, which indicates that panic booking is coming down as we are ensuring supplies," she added.

STEP ON THE GAS. India's daily average LPG production since March 5 has risen 38 per cent

> Six fully laden LPG carriers with capacity of around 45,000 tonnes are idling in the Persian Gulf west of the Strait, ready to deliver the critical commodity to India

India's daily average LPG production since March 5 has increased 38 per cent. India's average daily production in February (latest) was around 37,919 tonnes. Compared to February, average daily output may have increased to roughly 52,342 tonnes.

The Ministry also intensified enforcement actions to curb hoarding and black marketing with over 12,000 raids conducted and over 15,000 cylinders seized. Major actions were reported in Delhi, Goa, Uttar Pradesh, Jammu & Kashmir, Kerala and Madhya Pradesh, said Sharma.

Navy steps up vigil to escort oil tankers, unlikely to join American coalition to secure the Strait of Hormuz

Our Bureau
New Delhi

With the second LPG tanker *MT Nanda Devi* docking at a Gujarat port early on Tuesday after transiting the Strait of Hormuz, the Navy has stepped up efforts to secure energy shipments by deploying two naval task forces to assist and escort vessels carrying crude oil and gas through the sensitive corridor.

TASK FORCE

A task force means two groups of ships under orders for carrying out the task of escorting and supporting the movement of merchant vessels, Navy officials explained without getting into the details of the number of maritime platforms deployed for the safe passage of India-bound energy tankers.

According to US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent, Iran has only allowed some Indian and Chinese fuel tankers to pass through the Strait, which connects the Gulf of Oman with the Arabian Sea, while it has struck many others, driving up global oil prices.

India has managed to get initial breakthrough, benefiting from behind-the-scene diplomacy, but it's trying for safe passage for 22 stranded vessels to overcome energy shortage, including that of cooking gas.

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, in an interview with a foreign newspaper, clarified that Iran has not agreed to any "blanket arrangement" granting approval to all Indian flag-bearing ships to cross Strait of Hormuz. Instead, clearance is taking place ship by ship, according to the Minister.

NAVAL COALITION

However, India is unlikely to join a naval coalition sought by US President Donald Trump for deploying warships to secure the Strait, the route for one-fifth of global oil shipment, for safe passage of oil and gas tankers.

ON A MISSION. A task force means two groups of ships under orders for carrying out the task of escorting and supporting the movement of merchant vessels (FILE PHOTO)

The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) made it clear that no talks with the Trump administration or any other country have taken place so far on the Washington proposal for deployment of warships to escort vessels through the key energy route. Former Deputy National Security Advisor Pankaj Sharan seconded the MEA, and stated that "Trump has said that India, China and Japan are all victim countries because they import energy. I don't think we will let the Indian Navy work under any trans-national force."

ATTACKS BY HOUTHIS

Earlier, too, the Navy had refused to join a US-led coalition and preferred a "strategic autonomy", deploying at least a dozen warships at the peak of attacks on merchant vessels in the Red Sea by Houthis more than two years ago. Under Operation Sankalp, the Navy, through its robust presence in the Red Sea and Gulf of Aden since December 2023, has reportedly responded to over 25 incidents, probing over 250 vessels and ensuring the safety of 230 merchant ships.

Second LPG tanker reaches Gujarat via Strait of Hormuz

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

India received a fresh LPG shipment on the Gujarat coast for the second consecutive day as an Indian-flagged tanker *MT Nanda Devi* arrived near Vadinar, carrying 46,500 metric tonnes of LNG. This underscores steady inflows despite supply concerns linked to the war in West Asia.

At Vadinar, the cargo from *MT Nanda Devi* will be transferred via a ship-to-ship (STS) operation to another vessel, *MT BW Birch*, a move aimed at improving the turnaround time and reducing port congestion. The operation is being managed by the Deendayal Port Authority (DPA).

The vessel's arrival follows Monday's berthing of *MT Shivalik* at Mundra Port after transiting the Strait of Hormuz, bringing 46,000 MT of LPG cargo for Indian Oil Corporation. Port officials said STS transfers enable handling of large cargo volumes offshore, reducing the congestion at ports and lowering turnaround time.

SAFE EXIT. The Indian-flagged tanker *MT Nanda Devi* arrived near Vadinar carrying 46,500 metric tonnes of LNG

ENERGY IMPORTS

The operation at Vadinar underscores the role of Gujarat's ports in handling bulk energy imports and maintaining supply chain continuity.

DPA Chairman Sushil Kumar Singh visited the mother vessel and reviewed safety and operational preparedness for the transfer, the statement said.

The latest arrivals come close on the heels of another LPG vessel, *BW Pampero*, which had called at Kandla port last week and discharged 23,400 MT of cargo, although the origin of that shipment was not disclosed.

Exporters to benefit as CBIC now allows back-to-town clearance for diverted cargo

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

In a major relief to exporters hit by disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz, the Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC) has clarified that containers loaded at one Indian port but off-loaded at another on return can be cleared under the back-to-town (BTT) procedure.

The move resolves confusion that emerged over the past week after Customs authorities at the port of discharge were reluctant to clear containers originally shipped from another port, citing jurisdictional issues.

UNIFORM PROCEDURE

Issuing directions on Tuesday, CBIC asked all Custom Houses to adopt a uniform procedure to ensure faster handling of export cargo brought back to Indian ports due to the closure of the Strait of Hormuz or similar disruptions.

SMOOTH SAILING. CBIC has asked all Custom Houses to adopt a uniform procedure to ensure faster handling of cargo

The clarification comes as relief to exporters such as Venkata Ramarao Pothina, CEO of the Vijayawada-based Venspra Impex, who has been struggling to retrieve 21 containers from Mundra; they were originally loaded at Chennai. Over the past week, Pothina has been travelling between Chennai and Mundra to secure the release of his shipment bound for Jebel Ali.

To address such cases, CBIC said representations had been received on procedures for transhipment and BTT when vessels return to a different port than the original port of departure.

The directive is expected to streamline cargo handling and reduce delays for exporters impacted by geopolitical disruptions affecting key shipping routes.

HAILS MOVE

Welcoming CBIC's direction, Dushyant Mulani, immediate past Chairman of the Freight Forwarders Association in India, said the industry body had represented to CBIC seeking a uniform practice across all ports, including inland container depots and container freight stations for export consignments stranded after Customs clearance.

However, he pointed out that non-vessel operating common carriers, shipping lines and custodians were yet to agree on reducing costs such as detention charges and ground rent.

He said that refraining from imposing higher charges will help Indian trade and industry.

US National Counterterrorism Centre head resigns over war

Reuters

The head of the National Counterterrorism Centre resigned on Tuesday, becoming the first and most senior member of US President Donald Trump's administration to resign over the war in Iran, saying Tehran posed no imminent threat to the US.

"I cannot in good conscience support the ongoing war in Iran. Iran posed no imminent threat to our nation, and it is clear that we started this war due to pressure from Israel and its powerful lobby," Joseph Kent wrote in a letter to Trump posted on X.

Some experts have said an imminent threat would be required for the US to launch a war under current law. The White House did not immediately respond to a request for comment. The Office of the Director of National Intelligence also did not immediately respond.

Intelligence officials were caught off guard by the news. Kent is close with Director of National Intelligence Tulsi Gabbard, who has kept a low profile since the Iran war began.

Gabbard has not issued any public statements and has only appeared in public during the dignified transfer of American soldiers killed earlier this month during the conflict with Iran.

Restaurant, hotel players say several States have not announced commercial LPG allocations for industry

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Despite the Centre's directive to allocate a portion of commercial LPG to restaurants, hotels and eateries, players and industry bodies say that not all States have yet made such allocations. In fact, players and industry bodies said that the supply constraint situation has not yet improved on the ground.

Pranav Rungta, Vice-President, National Restaurant Association of India, said: "While States such as Delhi and Rajasthan have announced some allocations of commercial LPG for restaurants in line with Centre's direction, many other States such as Maharashtra have not made any such allocations. The situation on the ground in terms of supplies of commercial LPG has not improved. While standalone hotels, which rely heavily on LPG have been hit hard, even some large QSR chains have either curtailed menu items or even shortened operational hours for some outlets."

Echoing a similar sentiment, Pradeep Shetty, V-P, Federation of Hotel and Restaurant Associations of India (FHRAI), said: "Some States have not given priority to restaurants and hotels for allocation of commercial LPG as they don't have enough stocks and, hence, the situation has worsened. We fear it will worsen in the coming days. Players, which have access to alternatives to LPG, are the only ones that are able to keep their head above the ground. But even that is not sustainable after a point. We are now talking to various States to release stocks for the hospitality industry. We have also requested authorities for a relief package for the sector to tide over this crisis."

FACES CLOSURE

Reports of temporary closure of some iconic standalone restaurants in key cities have emerged due to shortage of supply of commercial LPG, industry executives pointed out.

Analysts pointed out that food delivery platforms are expected to see an impact of the LPG crisis in order volumes in the March quarter. Karan Taurani, EVP, Elara Securities, noted that India's food service industry comprises about four million outlets, of which about 0.6 outlets are organised while 3.4 million are unorganised. He added that nearly 80 per cent of the four million restaurants in the country rely on LPG as their primary cooking fuel.

"Food delivery platforms are more exposed to LPG disruptions as large order volume share originates from non-chain restaurants, which are more vulnerable to shortages. Per the worst case, shutting down 10-15 per cent of restaurants may temporarily reduce platform order volume by a comparable magnitude. As per NRAI, up to 5 per cent of organised restaurants have shut operations," Taurani stated in a report.

thehindubusinessline.
WEDNESDAY - MARCH 18, 2026

Scenario planning

Centre faces massive challenge if war doesn't end soon

The Centre's move to carve out a ₹1 lakh crore Economic Stabilisation Fund from current year's Budget is timely. The Finance Ministry has also done well to draw up various scenarios on the impact of the war, now in its third week, and place these before Parliament. As for the first, the Fund will be created out of cash inflows as well as unspent allocations (or savings) of ministries, as FY26 draws to a close in a couple of weeks.

The Fund forms part of the ₹2.8 lakh crore supplementary demand for grants passed by the Lok Sabha a few days ago. The additional ₹1.8 lakh crore is directed towards increasing subsidy on food (by ₹23,641 crore under PM Garib Kalyan Yojana) and fertilizer (by ₹19,230 crore), besides defence outlay. The additional outlay for fertilizer subsidy is likely meant to absorb a war-induced increase in prices, while food subsidy might have been beefed up to deal with any livelihood distress and inflation — a recognition that the war could hit the economy in unexpected ways.

In an exercise in realistic stocktaking, Chief Economic Advisor V Anantha Nageswaran has laid out possibilities before the Standing Committee on Finance, whose report was tabled in Parliament on Tuesday. He has said that if price of oil stays at $130 a barrel for two or three quarters, retail inflation will rise to 5.5 per cent and real GDP growth will be down to 6.4 per cent in FY27, against 7.4 per cent this fiscal. Significantly, the current account deficit (CAD) will rise from the present level of 1.2 per cent to 3.2 per cent of GDP and the fiscal deficit from 4.4 per cent to 5.6 per cent. At $90 a barrel for a sustained period, however, the current projections of 7-7.4 per cent growth, 2 per cent inflation, a CAD of 1-1.2 per cent of GDP and a fiscal deficit of 4.4 per cent are likely to hold. A spike in CAD will pose major challenges to monetary authorities as well. It could occur on account of an impact on remittances, investments and exports, even as imports rise. But it appears that the Centre is in a position to absorb crude price increase up to $90 a barrel without passing it on to the consumer, the Fund working as a cushion.

The war will have stagflationary impact. Besides higher commodity prices for industrial oil and gas users, inputs and intermediates will turn costly. Exporters and MSMEs, generally speaking, can be hit by global headwinds and disruption of supply chains and working capital finance. Apart from controlling energy prices, the Centre can take a leaf out of the Covid playbook and roll out an emergency credit guarantee scheme. The Fund's corpus can be enhanced if required, to stabilise prices and provide credit support. Monetary policy will have to be accommodative to the extent possible. With good macros and reserves, there is every reason to believe that the worst-case scenario may not come true, even if one is prepared for it.

OTHER VOICES.

The Guardian

If the US is winning, why ask Nato for help?

Donald Trump would like you to know that he is winning the war with Iran. So comprehensively, in fact, that he now needs Nato's help. The western alliance, he warns, will have a "very bad" future if its members refuse. Germany's defence minister had a brisk reply: this is not our war. Meanwhile, tankers pile up outside the strait of Hormuz as Britain promises, in an understated way, to keep "looking" at its options. Mr Trump has found out that starting a war without a coalition of the willing is easier than finishing one with it. He is signalling that things will get worse unless Tehran negotiates. Bad things have already happened. On the charge sheet is the sinking of an Iranian frigate in international waters and the bombing of a school that reportedly killed 168 people, mostly young girls. (LONDON, MARCH 16)

GLOBAL TIMES

China's 'intrinsic stability' wins global trust

"The 21st century is more likely to belong to Beijing than to Washington." A joint poll released on March 15 by the US outlet Politico and the UK polling firm Public First shows that citizens of US' "big four staunch allies" — Canada, the UK, France, and Germany — consider that "it is better to depend on China than the US," with younger generations holding particularly positive views. In recent days, several US media outlets also discussed the phenomenon of "Chinamaxxing", even suggesting that this trend could bring about deeper transformations in the modern American workplace. Together, these pieces of information make the puzzle of shifting Western perceptions clearer. This multinational survey is regarded as "highly accurate".(BEIJING, MARCH 17)

AJAY SRIVASTAVA

PERIASAMY M

How to get a bigger pie of the EU garment market

MEASURING UP. Zero tariffs apart, focus on quality and synthetics and strengthening the weaving and processing sector will help

Indian industry has long argued that the EU's average tariffs of about 12 per cent put Indian products at a disadvantage, especially when key competitors enjoyed duty-free access — Bangladesh under the EU's Generalised Scheme of Preferences and Vietnam under its free-trade agreement with the EU. With the EU now agreeing to eliminate tariffs for this sector, the question is whether India's exports to the EU will surge.

The honest answer is: exports will rise as tariffs fall, but not dramatically on their own. The EU is a demanding and complex market, and achieving strong, sustained growth will require several additional actions. Let us understand with the example of Japan.

The India-Japan FTA shows why tariff cuts by partner countries alone do not guarantee export growth. Japan, like the EU, is a developed economy that imports most of its garment requirements. When the India-Japan FTA came into force on August 1, 2011, Japan eliminated its 10 per cent duty on apparel from day one at India's request, raising hopes of a sharp rise in Indian garment exports. That surge never came.

Japan imported about $327 million worth of garments and made-ups from India in 2011. By 2024, imports had fallen to around $302 million, leaving India with barely a 1.1 per cent share of Japan's garment imports. The problem was not tariffs, but readiness. Many Indian suppliers were unable to meet Japan's demanding standards on quality, process discipline, and consistent, large-scale production.

The European Union is a key market for India's textile and apparel exports. In FY2025, India exported $37 billion worth of textiles, garments and made-ups globally, of which the EU accounted for $7.3 billion, or 19.8 per cent. The EU is especially important for garments, taking 28.4 per cent ($4.6 billion) of India's exports in this segment. To increase exports, we need to focus on the following actions.

FIRM-LEVEL INITIATIVES

Exporters to the EU know that producing a good-quality garment alone is not enough to access the market. European buyers require production in factories that follow strict, auditable processes and comply with multiple regulatory and buyer standards. These include EU textile labelling rules, REACH chemical regulations, emerging sustainability and traceability requirements, and buyer-mandated certifications such as ISO, SA8000, GOTS/GRS, and OEKO-TEX®.

Meeting these requirements — through audits, testing, traceability systems, REX registration, and worker training — typically costs ₹10-30 lakh in the first year. While organised exporters can manage this, it remains a barrier for smaller units.

Winning the speed game: For best results, Indian factories must also upgrade to become fast-fashion-industry (FFI) compliant, where most global sourcing now occurs. India has about 1,200 FFI-compliant factories, mainly in cotton, with far fewer in synthetics. Nearly 80 per cent of exporters still miss efficiency benchmarks such as Standard Allowed Minutes (SAM), limiting scale and speed. Expanding FFI-compliant capacity — especially in synthetics — is critical to winning orders from major buyers like Walmart, Zara, H&M, Gap, and online retailers such as Amazon and Zalando.

From cotton comfort to synthetic competitiveness: Synthetic and winter-wear products — such as sportswear, athleisure, fast fashion, and cold-weather clothing — now make up nearly 70 per cent of global garment demand. India missed this shift by staying largely cotton-focused, leaving factories underused outside the spring-summer season.

The result is a wide gap: while China exported about $113 billion of garments last year, Bangladesh $51 billion, and Vietnam $39 billion, India exported only around $16 billion. Limited focus on synthetics and winter-wear is a key reason.

The government has now removed a major constraint by abolishing Quality Control Orders (QCOs) on more than 20 key synthetic inputs such as polyester and viscose fibres and yarns, reducing costs and improving access to global raw materials. With zero-tariff access under the FTA, industry must expand into synthetic, blended, and winter-wear segments to achieve meaningful export growth.

> **Setting up design studios in Europe to co-create collections and respond quickly to trends can further strengthen competitiveness**

From contract manufacturing to brand power: Even India's largest garment exporters, including billion-dollar firms, mostly operate as low-margin suppliers to global brands. This limits profits, bargaining power, and forces them into constant price competition. It is time for India's leading garment makers to move up the value chain by building their own designs, brands, and retail identities. By investing in in-house design teams, trend analysis, fast sampling, and small-batch production, firms can earn higher margins and reduce dependence on a few large buyers.

Setting up design studios in Europe to co-create collections and respond quickly to trends can further strengthen competitiveness. Competing on design and speed — not tariffs alone — is the key to long-term success.

GOVERNMENT LEVEL INITIATIVES

Over the past year, the government has fixed key weaknesses by removing QCOs on major synthetic inputs, easing labour rules to allow factory expansion and year-round operations, and correcting the inverted GST structure. Together, these reforms finally give India's synthetic garment industry a real shot at global competitiveness. However, to fully use the India-EU FTA opportunity, the following additional action is needed.

Strengthen weaving and processing sector — the weakest links in the textile value chain: India is a major yarn exporter but accounts for only 6 per cent of global fabric trade because its weaving and processing units remain small, informal, and outdated. Invest in large, modern, integrated weaving and processing parks to convert its yarn strength into true global fabric competitiveness. China's textile revolution started with this.

Do not incentivise the export of fibre or yarn: Current export rebates push India to ship fibre and yarn abroad at lower prices, starving domestic garment makers of affordable inputs. India should prioritise value-added exports, not raw materials.

Overhaul procedures: Advance authorisation allows exporters to import inputs duty-free, but rigid rules — such as matching fabric type, shade, and consumption with extreme precision — make it cumbersome. Bangladesh solved this by using value-based import entitlements, letting firms import inputs up to a fixed share of export value. India should adopt a similar approach.

Finally, extend the RoSCTL (Rebate of State and Central Taxes and Levies) scheme for garments and made-ups for at least five years to provide stability and confidence for long-term investment, as exporters need predictable policy support to plan capacity expansion, technology upgrades, and new product lines aligned with global demand.

The aforesaid action plan applies not only to boosting India's garment exports to the EU, but also to all labour-intensive exports to developed markets.

We have discussed for decades about upgrading garment and other labour intensive sectors, yet on the ground India continues to lose market share to smaller competitors such as Vietnam and Bangladesh — late entrants that moved faster with clearer strategies, compliance readiness, and supply-chain efficiency. If India is to reclaim its position in global trade, there may never be a better time to seize the opportunity.

The writer is Founder, GTRI

Will foreign banks exiting UAE home in on India?

India has seldom been favoured as a regional headquarters. Better urban governance, currency convertibility could change this

Brijeshwar Singh

Energy shocks and a fall of remittance from the Gulf might occupy the energies of our policymakers for much of this year. These large issues, however, could lead us to overlook the banking shock in the UAE.

The UAE has more than a trillion dollars in banking assets, which are double the size of its GDP. India's GDP, at nearly $4 trillion, is eight times the UAE's but our banking assets (at less than $4 trillion) are only about three times the UAE's. The deep financialisation of the UAE is largely because it is an open economy that operates as a regional financial centre. The leading names operating in the region include Citibank , JP Morgan, HSBC, Credit Agricole, BNP Paribas and our own Bank of Baroda.

With oil, hospitality and tourism, trade and real estate sectors facing difficult times, the UAE banking sector will take a massive hit. International banks have largely shut down and pulled out their staff. They are seeking safe havens — for a change this means physical safety and not tax-free status.

While GIFT City may beckon these banks, it is unlikely they would move there. GIFT City is designed for the local investor seeking to invest in foreign assets, which is quite a different role. Also its location, in Gandhinagar, is not too attractive a place to live in and there are problems of talent attrition as well. It's more likely that these banks will prefer established financial centres like Mumbai or Chennai, if given some incentives.

India is not going to be a first choice for a Middle East headquarters. Even as a headquarters of an Asia level regional office India lags; WHO is one of the few international organisations to have a regional office here.

INDIA BYPASSED

It is somewhat surprising that the practice of bypassing India for a regional office has hardly changed in half a century. New excuses are found for the avoidance, such as Bengaluru's terrible traffic, Mumbai's overcrowding, Kolkata's dilapidated state and Delhi's life-threatening pollution. These are a reflection of poor urban governance more than anything else.

It is sometimes said in jest that the Minto-Morley reforms were our last serious look at urban governance. Municipal bodies (and district boards) then had the power to hire and fire staff rather freely — a much curtailed power a century later. In practice, few municipal politicians graduate to higher levels.

WELL STACKED. The UAE has more than a trillion dollars in banking assets

However, it is noteworthy that Chandigarh, which is a Union Territory, has escaped many urban problems. While there is no space for federally administered cities in our Constitution, Mumbai has expanded up to the Gujarat border near Dahanu. The Ahmedabad-Mumbai-Pune coast is turning into a giant megalopolis, with acutely divided political-authority and no overarching planning body. Foreign capital and foreign banks alike prefer stable, low risk urban environments. And federally administered cities could be a possible solution. Any relocation of banks from the UAE will become attractive only if our policymakers address the issues of currency convertibility and lowering of import tariffs. What is striking is that while the earliest concept papers on Bombay as a financial centre (like the Lovraj Kumar note) argued for trade liberalisation, tax incentives and limited currency convertibility, subsequent policy took the silo path. Each component was considered in isolation without any synergy. Our SEZs have no significant tax advantage since the introduction of MAT and the weakening of Section 10AA. GIFT City is not linked to a free port and it has no tariff advantages.

China used a dual currency system of both the Yuan and the Renminbi to gradually advance currency convertibility, and in the interim it used the tax haven of Hong Kong to access foreign capital. This path may not be feasible for us.

However, it is never too late to begin planning for a regional financial centre when our metropolises are mutating into megalopolises and our SEZs still have land to spare.

The writer is an economist who was formerly additional chief secretary of Tamil Nadu

LETTERS TO EDITOR

Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Hurdles to natural farming

Apropos 'Why a transition to natural farming is a necessity' (March 17), while it is essential to move over to natural farming from the current fertilizer and pesticide intensive cultivation, there are several hurdles that confront this transition.

Farmers need to be assured and convinced about the long term benefits that the shift would bring, as the natural farming is more labour intensive, but yields also could dip in the initial years when bio-inputs replace the chemical inputs. A few farmers may be chosen in each and every village in the country and convinced to take up natural farming by making them aware of the advantages of natural farming and providing incentives, extension services and market access after harvesting.

In the initial years the government may procure the entire organic produce so as to build trust among farmers about natural farming. The success of these few farmers will inspire other farmers to take up natural farming.

Kosaraju Chandramouli
Hyderabad

The price of war

Apropos 'Nervous Republicans' (March 17), the war on Iran has caused disruption across the globe in all spheres of activities. Oil and gas continue to be critical energy sources for everyday life despite availability of other renewable energy sources. It appears that both Israel and the US failed to gauge the impact the conflict would have on non-participating countries. Many nations such as Japan and Australia have expressed disinterest in sending their forces to support US actions in weakening Tehran's stronghold in Hormuz Strait. It is time all countries appeal en masse to the warring nations to end the conflict.

RV Baskaran
Pune

Towards electric cooking

Apropos 'Electric kitchens' (March 17), the LPG squeeze is a timely reminder that a basic household necessity still rides on volatile imports and distant conflicts. The current disruption should be used to accelerate efficient electric cooking, not merely to patch supply lines. Induction and other e-stoves convert more input energy into usable heat, and when priced sensibly they can reduce the recurring burden of cylinder subsidies. A pragmatic transition needs three guardrails: time-bound support for quality, efficient stoves; clear standards to keep unsafe, low-grade appliances out; and planning for peak electricity demand through time-of-use tariffs, rooftop solar pairing, and storage where feasible. Crisis-driven substitutions should become deliberate resilience.

Veda Chidanand
Bengaluru

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Futility of cabotage law

Protection for Indian shipping is not beneficial

Jose Paul

INDIAN SHIPPING. In the clutches of protection PTI

The English word "cabotage", which has a Spanish origin, means trade or navigation in coastal waters and the right of a country to operate exclusively in coastal trade.

Such protection of national shipping under cabotage is designed to promote and protect domestic shipping and like India, the US, the UK, Japan, Australia, China and many other countries have reserved their coastal shipping to domestic services.

However, the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, on January 21, 2026, scrapped three general orders issued in 2018 which had permitted foreign flag vessels to carry export/import containers meant for transshipment, empty containers for repositioning and select commodities on coastal routes without obtaining a licence from the Directorate General of Shipping.

For the last eight years foreign container shipping lines have availed themselves of this facility, and from April 21 this relaxation will cease to exist.

The government decided in 2018 to grant relaxation of cabotage law to foreign flagged ships only for container trade and that too for transshipment trade. The share of container traffic in the total cargo handled at Indian ports comes to about 22 per cent (352 million tonnes out of a total of 1.603 million tonnes).

Of this only about 25 per cent constitute transshipment trade, and, therefore, in actual practice the relaxation of cabotage law benefitted only to less than 8 per cent of India's total port traffic. Rolling back the relaxation of cabotage law for transshipment trade could result in diversion of Indian origin cargo to established regional hubs such as Port of Colombo, Port Klang, Tanjung Pelepas, Jebel Ali, Singapore which already handle a large part of India's transshipment volumes.

Does India have enough container vessels to serve the coastal transshipment trade?

India has about 30 feeder container ships with a total carrying capacity of about 56,000 TEUs. India has a coastline of 7,500 km with 12 major ports and at least about 20 commercially significant non-major ports. Indian container ship fleet is inadequate to service the requirements of Indian shippers efficiently and cost effectively.

Domestic container lines, under cargo reservation, tend to keep freight rates high. A liberalised environment, which fosters greater competition, results in lower freight rates.

The government is pinning it hopes on the recently established "Bharat Container Lines" to make an impact in the global container shipping market.

This is unlikely to happen in the near future due to the formidable entry barriers to the market.

The seven global giants in container shipping — Mediterranean Shipping Company, Maersk Lines, CMA CGM, COSCO Shipping Line, Hapag Lloyd, Ocean Network Express and Evergreen Marine have a huge fleet strength and control almost 78 per cent of the global container shipping market.

REFORMS IN CABOTAGE LAW

In the UK foreign flag ships are engaged in domestic shipping. Australia which relies on shipping for transport of 99 per cent of international trade maintains cabotage rule but foreign lines can apply for license to move domestic cargo. Indonesia has relaxed cabotage law for foreign flagged vessels that are serving Indonesia's oil and gas sectors.

In 2009 Malaysia relaxed its cabotage laws to permit foreign lines to carry domestic cargo. New Zealand deregularised coastal shipping and despite repeated efforts to reintroduce cabotage law such efforts have not succeeded. Economic logic suggests that restrictive practices stifle growth resulting often in unfulfilled potential.

Indian container shipping lines cannot afford to remain always under the umbrella of statutory protection and in the comfort of cargo reservation.

They should be able to compete with foreign shipping lines on service quality, pricing and operational performance.

The writer is a former Chairman of Mormugao Port Trust and an Adjunct Professor of Indian Maritime University, Chennai

A VASUDEVAN

GETTY IMAGES

Policy action in times of geopolitical crises

CRISIS MANAGEMENT. It is time to think of an inventory policy to stock up critical goods in times of supply disruptions, arising out of political factors

The Middle East crisis that emerged at the end of February has added an uncertainty that is far more severe than any other event in the recent past. No one knows how long it will last — days, weeks or months, even after the completion of a fortnight since the eruption of the crisis. India's economic and political diplomacy and commitment to the ideology of peace with dignity, referred to often as multi-pluralism, is under severe threat.

One of the major consequences of the crisis is that prices of oil will go up and trigger inflation and the expectations thereof. This should worry India since it could disrupt the projections made in February of growth and inflation for the fiscal 2026-27.

Should India merely reset the economic projections or wait for some more time? The best option available is to wait and watch for the oft-mentioned price of oil to spike to $100 and over to even $150 per barrel. This is not something that the world has not experienced earlier.

In fact, the world has seen $100 per barrel and over of the marker oil, the Brent Crude, in at least seven calendar years since the global financial crisis of 2008. In a majority of these years, the main cause of such spikes involved Iran and China.

SUPPLY DISRUPTIONS

India should be more worried about the supply disruptions in respect of oil as well as critical minerals, and other goods including steel, electronic goods, chips, batteries, and edible oils as well as pulses. Identification of these commodities is not a serious challenge, though. What would be more worrisome is about how to build up inventories of these commodities, in case the crisis stretches for three to six months from now.

Superimposed on this is the need for building up inventories of defence equipment, including radars, missiles and more importantly drones in case the crisis triggers hostile activities from those not well disposed to the country.

India does not have, from most accounts, a sound well-tested inventory policy to take care of such an uncertainty. Trade deals concluded with some of the countries and a cluster of the European Union countries (EU) could help procure the commodities in question to a significant extent.

Will this be enough to take care of inventory costs? And who will bear such costs? Should we construct first a base scenario of maintaining inventories that would last for at least six months and build up more scenarios, if need be, as new developments emerge? As of now, there are no clear answers to these questions. And the opportunity costs could be high if the decisions about the inventory policy and inventory dynamics are not taken expeditiously.

> **Apart from oil, building up an inventory of critical minerals, and other goods including steel, electronic** goods, chips, batteries, and edible oils as well as pulses is the challenge, especially if the war prolongs

The Indian authorities should not treat the crisis lightly and tinker with the overall situation of supply of goods and services in an ad hoc manner. They should also not hurry to reset the projections of February 2026 for the next fiscal year. Instead, they need to work out fiscal, monetary and governance strategies that necessarily involve a reform agenda, to achieve the projected numbers. This is the only way expectations of economic units (households, corporates, small and informal enterprises and government entities) about India's economic prospects could be influenced towards achieving the set goals.

MACRO POLICIES

This does not mean that there will be no volatilities in our interest rates, liquidity situation, exchange rates of most major currencies, gold and other precious goods, stocks, and fiscal receipts. After all, the uncertainties at the global level are so sharp that none of the economic variables are or can be pre-determinable.

Volatilities have to be managed through coordinated strategies for policy action. And what is important is to ensure that all the tiers of government at the Centre and States are committed to the tasks that lie ahead. The Centre should take the initiative right away.

Hopefully, issues such as the scarcity of cooking gas and fertilizers that are presently the major concerns of commercial kitchens, households and farmers would not overwhelm the governance mechanisms at all tiers of the government and disrupt the commitment to the pursuit of the current macro policy framework.

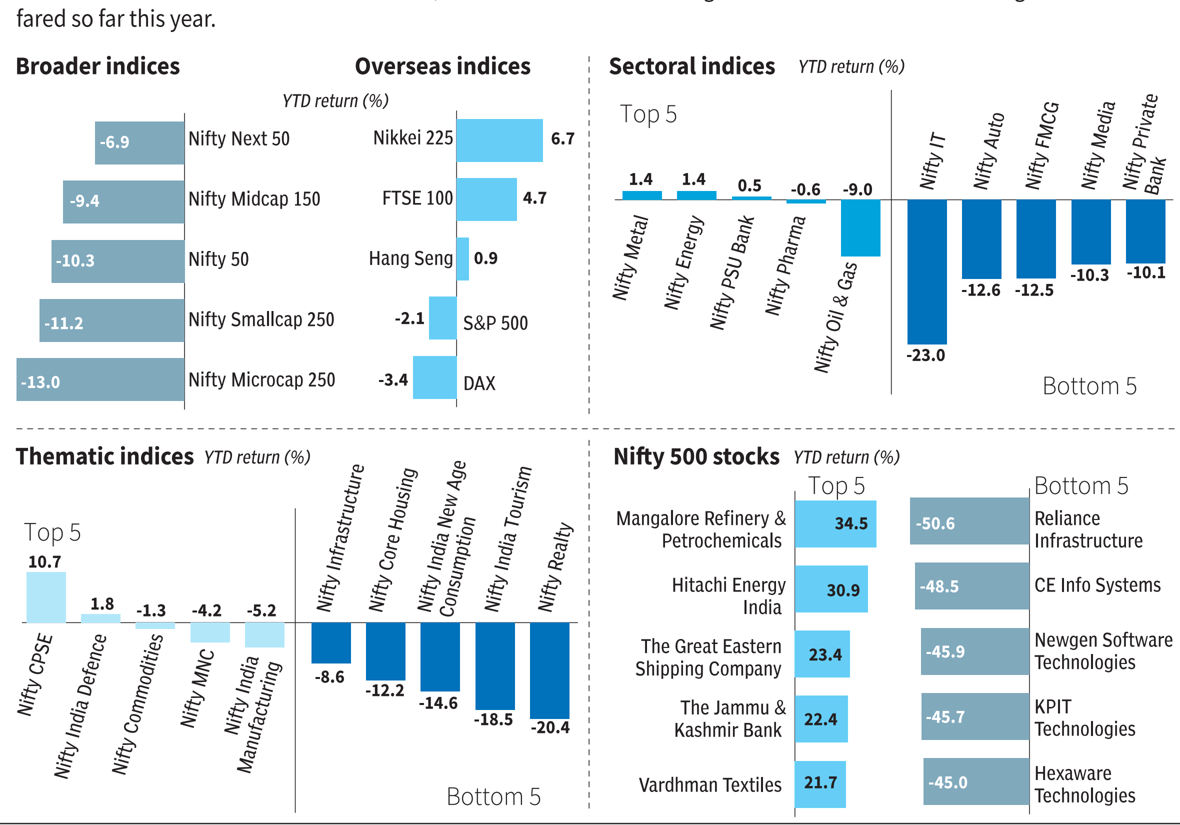
The writer is a former Executive Director of the RBI and currently an independent economic analyst. (Through The Billion Press)

STATISTALK.

Compiled **Dhuraivel Gunasekaran** | Graphic **Visveswaran V**

Inside India's equity market rout in 2026

Domestic equity markets have been in correction mode since the start of 2026, driven by a confluence of global shocks and domestic pressures. Year-to-date, as of March 16, 2026, the Nifty 50 TRI has declined 10%, while the Nifty Midcap 150 TRI and Nifty Smallcap 250 TRI have fallen 9% and 11%, respectively. Indian equities remain under pressure due to stretched valuations and persistent FII outflows. US tariffs, a weak rupee, IT sector underperformance, and geopolitical tensions have added to the strain. However, SIP flows offer a silver lining. Here is how various market segments have fared so far this year.



Source: ACEMF YTD as of March 16, 2026 Total return variant is considered

On businessline.in

Has flexible inflation targeting worked?

The FIT framework has had less influence on limiting food inflation and its volatility, point out **Abhiman Das** and **Smita Roy Trivedi**

https://tinyurl.com/3rswkkjf

Petroyuan is a geopolitical signal, not a monetary system

The yuan is constrained by lack of capital account convertibility and PBOC control on exchange rate. So the dollar's domination is set to continue, says **Ram Singh**

https://tinyurl.com/486mv4u9

Press Note 3 tweak: A significant FDI policy reset in five years

The amendment is a boon for global funds as it lends predictability in the foreign investment regime, say **Vivaik Sharma** and **Mudit Burad**

https://tinyurl.com/va6b5ejs

thehindu businessline.

TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

March 18, 2006

Suzlon to buy Belgian co Hansen for Rs 2,511 cr

Wind energy major Suzlon Energy Ltd has agreed to buy Hansen Transmissions International NV, a leading wind turbine gearbox manufacturer in Belgium for euro 465 million (Rs 2,511 crore) in an all-cash deal.

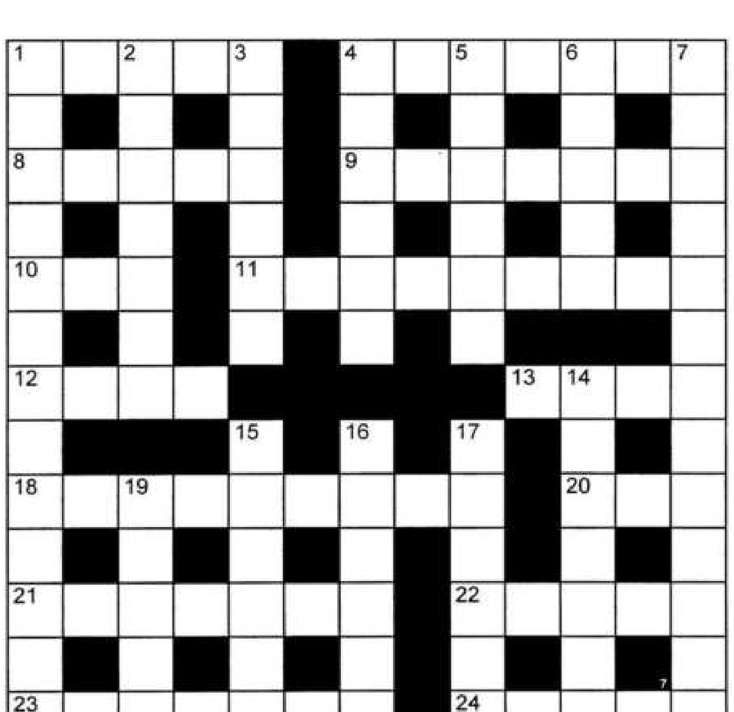
VisualSoft, Applabs, eSolutions merger plan falls through

The proposed amalgamation of IT services company Visual Soft Technologies Ltd with Applabs Technologies, a software testing solutions provider, and eSolutions, has fallen through. The scheme of amalgamation charted out by the board of directors, at a meeting held on October 27, 2005, has failed to materialise and the companies have decided to pursue their interests independently.

NTPC plans to bid for gas blocks under NELP-VI

Having bagged its first oil and gas block in the fifth round of bidding under the New Exploration Licensing Policy, NTPC Ltd plans to take forward its diversification into the oil and gas exploration business with aggressive plans to bid for more acreage in the sixth round of bidding under NELP-VI.

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2638



EASY

ACROSS

01. Leaves car (5)
04. Withstands (7)
08. Lid (5)
09. Anguish (7)
10. Samovar (3)
11. Aardvark; woodchuck (6-3)
12. Fencing sword (4)
13. Supreme; roguish (4)
18. Holds back, checks (9)
20. Animal mother (3)
21. Counterpart to tenon (7)
22. Habituate; burn in (5)
23. Think guilty (7)
24. Old pear-shaped instruments (5)

DOWN

01. Surroundings for paintings (7,6)
02. Inflict injury in retaliation (7)
03. Spray-like ornaments (6)
04. Food allowance (6)
05. Bound (6)
06. Cardinal point (5)
07. Large, heavy knocking implements (6-7)
14. Inner, last retreat (7)
15. Laud (6)
16. Not speaking (6)
17. Act of watching, observation (6)
19. Boils, ulcers (5)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

01. Leaves vehicle for Hyde and St James's (5)
04. Doesn't give in but is involved in relaxation periods (7)
08. Such the spy's story that newsman will report on (5)
09. Infliction of pain, wrong at law, is certain not to start (7)
10. One is told one will deservedly get such a repository (3)
11. The aardvark goes to earth, the pig! (6-3)
12. Keep enemy turning to reveal the sword he wields (4)
13. Keystone feature every building designer begins with (4)
18. Checks precipitation in the times between notes (9)
20. Maternal equine will keep it back using bank (3)
21. It's misplaced in additional quantity needed for lock (7)
22. Harden one that is about to run back (5)
23. One will think him guilty if he sets cup rattling (7)
24. Cements instruments with strings (5)

DOWN

01. See me far gone in films, such being the surroundings (7,6)
02. Retaliation taken by the right even, for example, giving up (7)
03. Pieces of mint one grips awkwardly with top of scissors (6)
04. Allowance out the proportion to the North (6)
05. Season when mast will crack (6)
06. Some States of the US, hot and bothered (5)
07. Giant nutcrackers found on shelf among those who pretend (6-7)
14. Field-work the Sappers will do, but get wrong (7)
15. Be complimentary if one can aspire to it (6)
16. Posted the Italian inside without saying anything (6)
17. Observation made as pile is crumbling (6)
19. Nasty places seen thus, repose being inconclusive (5)

SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2637

ACROSS 1. Socle 4. Deserve 8. Imperceptible 10. Niger 11. Lead 12. Wing 16. Piece 17. Infallibility 19. Galloon 20. Minor

DOWN 1. Scintillating 2. Cop 3. Errand 4. Dredge 5. Satire 6. Rebellion 7. Evening prayer 9. Beautiful 13. Apollo 14. Legion 15. Tedium 18. Inn

QUICKLY.

Innovision IPO subscribed over 3x on final day

Bengaluru: The IPO of toll plaza management services provider Innovision received an overall subscription of 3.32 times, supported largely by strong institutional demand. According to exchange data, the QIB portion was booked 13.75 times, while the non-institutional investors category saw 8.26 times subscription. The retail segment was subscribed only 0.58 times, reflecting cautious investor sentiment. The IPO had received a lukewarm response earlier, prompting the company to extend the issue closing date to March 17 from March 12 and revise its price band. The price band has been cut to ₹494-519 per share, compared with ₹521-548 per share earlier. OUR BUREAU

SEBI proposes nomination rule changes for demat, MF accounts

SIMPLIFYING THE PROCESS. It looks to ease onboarding and cut compliance burden

Our Bureau
Mumbai

SEBI on Tuesday proposed changes to simplify nomination norms for demat accounts and mutual fund folios, aiming to reduce onboarding friction and improve compliance.

The regulator has suggested making nomination the default option for new accounts, with investors required to explicitly opt out if they do not wish to appoint a nominee.

The move is part of a broader effort to streamline processes following operational challenges flagged by market participants under the current framework.

It has proposed limiting mandatory nominee details to just the name and relationship with the investor. Other information, including contact details and percentage share, will be optional. "Feedback was received from the industry that the process of furnishing so many details of the nominee is onerous for investors and as a result many investors are dropping off, on-boarding," SEBI said. If the share of nominees is not specified, assets will be divided equally among them.

NEW NORMS

- Nomination is the default option for new accounts
- Investors have to explicitly opt out if there is no nominee
- Number of nominees to be capped at four

CAP ON NOMINEES

The regulator has also proposed capping the number of nominees at four, replacing the earlier proposal to allow up to 10, citing operational constraints and low usage of multiple nominees. It has been suggested that provisions allowing nominees to operate accounts in the event of an investor's incapacitation be removed. Instead, it has proposed continuing with the existing power of attorney route. "Conventionally, a nominee becomes trustee of the assets only upon the demise of the investor... a nominee coming to the fore even when the investor is alive, causes confusion," it said.

The proposals include nudges such as periodic reminders to investors without nominations, as well as pop-up prompts highlighting the benefits of nomination. Public comments on the proposals are open till April 7. SEBI said the changes are aimed at aligning nomination practices with banking norms, reducing the compliance burden, and preventing the build-up of unclaimed assets.

Indices gain, but investors cautious

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

Equity benchmarks closed higher for the second consecutive session on Tuesday, with the Nifty 50 gaining 172.35 points to settle at 23,581.15 and the Sensex going up 567.99 points to 76,070.84. Despite the headline gains, market breadth told a more cautious story — 440 stocks on the BSE hit fresh 52-week lows against only 56 at 52-week highs.

The Nifty opened at 23,493.20, dipped to an intra-day low of 23,346.60 in the first half before buyers emerged, driving the index to a high of 23,656.80. The Sensex opened at 75,826.68 and climbed steadily through the session.

Eternal led Nifty gainers, surging 5.59 per cent, followed by Tata Steel (4.42 per cent), Mahindra & Mahindra (2.85 per cent), HDFC Life (2.70 per cent) and BEL (2.67 per cent). On the losing side, Wipro fell 2.06 per cent, Cipla (-1.51 per cent), Tata Consumer Products (-1.39 per cent), Infosys (-1.26 per cent) and ITC (-1.23 per cent).

Eternal led the Nifty gainers, surging 5.59 per cent

Sectorally, metal, auto and realty led gains, each rising 1-2 per cent, while Nifty IT fell over 2 per cent, hovering near multi-year lows, and Nifty FMCG ended 0.7 per cent down. The Nifty Midcap 100 rose 1 per cent and the Nifty Smallcap 100 gained 0.65 per cent. The BSE advance-decline ratio improved to 1.25, turning positive after four sessions.

VIX DROPS

A key positive on the day was India VIX, the volatility index, which dropped 8.39 per cent to close at 19.79.

"The sharp decline in India VIX accelerated theta decay and reduced the risk premium in options, allowing markets to stabilise after recent turbulence," said Hariprasad K, SEBI-registered Research Analyst and Founder, Livelong Wealth.

Analysts remained divided on whether the two-day recovery signals a sustained reversal. "It is premature to conclude that this reversal is sustainable in the short term, as war-related uncertainties persist," cautioned Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments, though he noted that "from a long-term perspective, deploying funds appears reasonable, given the correction in India's premium valuations." Ajit Mishra of Religare Broking described the move as "a mean-reversion move following the sharp decline," citing elevated crude and persistent FII outflows as overhangs.

IPO rush hits pause as macro volatility delays listings

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru

India's much-anticipated IPO wave is showing signs of delay, as global macroeconomic volatility, geopolitical tensions and valuation mismatches prompt start-ups and investors to reassess listing timelines.

Fintech major PhonePe recently put its IPO plans on hold, underscoring how even well-prepared, market-leading companies are choosing to wait for more favourable conditions. The move comes at a time when several new-age firms, including Zepto, OYO, Acko and Turtlemint, were gearing up to tap public markets in what was expected to be a blockbuster year for listings. "Global macro-volatility is directly impacting IPO timing more than IPO intent," said Ujwal Sutaria, Founder and General Partner, TDV Partners. He added that IPO timelines are increasingly becoming "market-driven rather than milestone-driven," with founders recognising that timing is as critical as business readiness.

VALUATION RESET

"We're seeing a clear disconnect between what founders expect and what public market investors are willing to pay," Sutaria said, attributing it to lingering expectations from the 2021-22 funding boom, even as public investors shift focus to profitability and cash flows.

The case of PhonePe highlights this divergence, with investor appetite reportedly pegging its valuation significantly below prior private market estimates.

Shyam Menon, Co-Founder, Bharat Innovation Fund, said macro headwinds have created "an environment with zero tolerance for unpredictable cash burn," forcing start-ups to recalibrate. "IPO readiness is no longer just about scale; it is about profitability," he said. Companies are cutting costs and tightening unit economics to present stronger financials before listing, he added.

He noted that founders are beginning to accept that "pricing an IPO to leave some money on the table for retail investors is a better long-term strategy" than chasing peak valuations and risking weak listings.

ALTERNATIVE EXITS

Industry executives expect IPO delays to become more common over the next 12-18 months.

Rajeev Kalambi, General Partner, Cactus Partners, said, "We expect several IPOs to be deferred... merchant bankers would be keeping their eyes peeled to identify a window of opportunity." At the same time, start-ups are increasingly exploring alternative liquidity options. "If IPO markets are not attractive, companies tend to explore a combination of primary fundraising and secondary sales," he added.

Sutaria echoed this trend, noting that secondary transactions, pre-IPO rounds and strategic sales are gaining traction as firms seek flexibility amid tighter capital conditions. "The companies that will succeed in the next IPO cycle won't just be the fastest-growing," he said. "They'll be profitable, capital-efficient and just as thoughtful about timing the market as they are about building their business."

Actively-managed funds see mixed bag in 2025

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Actively-managed mutual funds had a mixed experience in beating the benchmark indices in 2025. While many of the actively-managed large-cap and equity-linked saving schemes funds struggled to beat their benchmarks, actively-managed mid- and small-cap funds delivered a better out-performance, marking their best relative results since 2014, according to the SPIVA India report prepared by S&P Dow Jones Indices.

Nearly 75 per cent of the actively-managed large-cap funds underperformed their benchmark indices in the last one year. Over three, five and 10 years, the underperformance was 74 per cent, 84 per cent and 76 per cent, respectively. The S&P India Large MidCap climbed 8.9 per cent in 2025, while Indian Equity Large-Cap funds gained 7.3 per cent. In the same period, Nifty 50 delivered 10 per cent returns.

However, the underperformance rate of the actively-managed mid- and small-cap funds was just 12 per cent over the one-year period. Over three-, five- and 10-year period, the underperformance was 41 per cent, 46 per cent and 79 per cent. The S&P India SmallCap plunged 8 per cent in 2025, while equity mid- and small-cap funds dropped 0.7 per cent in the same period. The Nifty Smallcap 100 index declined 9 per cent, while the Nifty Midcap 150 jumped 5 per cent.

ALPHA GENERATION

Chirag Muni, Executive Director, Anand Rathi Wealth, said nearly 48 per cent of large-cap funds have outperformed Nifty 50 between 2018 and 2025, and the funds that did outperform generated an average alpha of about 3.35 per cent. This suggests that while benchmark outperformance has not been very strong, there is still potential for alpha generation in large-caps, he said.

Investors are already shifting to passive strategies which replicate an index and do not have the ability to generate alpha, he added.

Market corrections during global conflicts create long-term opportunities

Madhu Balaji
Bengaluru

Even as geopolitical tensions continued to weigh on market sentiment, experts suggest that history offers a reassuring message for investors: while conflicts trigger short-term volatility, long-term equity returns have remained resilient — and often rewarding.

According to a recent market outlook by PL Capital, the resurgence of geopolitical risks, particularly in West Asia, has led to heightened volatility driven by rising crude oil prices, inflation concerns and currency pressures. Equity benchmarks have corrected 7-8 per cent since the war began and were down close to 5 per cent last week, according to a Bonanza analyst.

According to the PL Capital report, India's structural growth drivers — domestic consumption, infrastructure spending and improving corporate balance sheets — remain intact. This underlying strength provides a solid foundation for long-term equity performance despite external shocks, it said.

POST-WAR RECOVERIES

Looking at past wartime corrections, Balaji Rao Mudili, Research Analyst at Bonanza, noted that the BSE Sensex has typically fallen around 10 per cent during conflict periods, but recoveries have taken an average of just 38 days.

Tata AIA Life Insurance reinforces this perspective through historical analysis. Examining past global and domestic conflicts—from the Gulf War (1990) and the Iraq War (2003) to more recent events like the Russia-Ukraine conflict (2022), a Tata AIA report finds that in many cases, returns over a one- to five-year horizon were significantly positive.

During episodes of domestic uncertainty, such as the Kargil War in 1999, the Mumbai 26/11 attacks, the Uri and Pulwama attacks, markets have historically rebounded strongly after the initial decline, delivering gains of about 35 per cent within a year and more than doubling over the following two-three years.

Recoveries have not always been swift, and in several instances, investors needed to remain patient for longer periods before markets regained momentum.

Similarly, during the Gulf War in 1990, Indian equities delivered returns of around 50 per cent one year after the event and nearly 200 per cent over five years. Similarly, post the Iraq War (March 2003), markets rose about 68 per cent within a year and over 300 per cent across five years.

"In fact, some of the most rewarding investment opportunities arise during these periods of stress," the Tata AIA note said.

Weak markets provide discounted entries, amplifying compounding returns for holders, said Akshat Garg, Head-Research & Product at Choice Wealth.

Mudili of Bonanza said that over the past 30 years, the Nifty 50 has delivered annual returns of about 12-14 per cent, translating into a compounded growth of roughly 35-37 times. However, if an investor attempted to time entries and exits and missed the best 30 trading days, returns would fall sharply to just 5-6 times the initial investment, he added.

Periods of crisis often see panic selling, reduced participation and triggered stop-losses, leading to sharp but temporary declines in asset prices. Yet, disciplined investors who remain invested — or gradually deploy capital during corrections — have historically benefited from subsequent recoveries.

Speciality Meds plans ₹29-crore BSE SME IPO

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Speciality Medicines plans to raise ₹29 crore through an IPO on the BSE SME platform. It will issue 23.5 lakh shares in the price band of ₹117-124.

The issue opens on March 20. The net proceeds from the IPO will be used to set up of an R&D centre, funding for marketing and promotional activities, to meet working capital requirements and general corporate purposes.

Sai Parenteral's ₹285-crore IPO to open on March 24

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Sai Parenteral's (SPL), a diversified pharmaceutical formulation company, has filed its Red Herring Prospectus (RHP) with SEBI for its proposed initial public offering (IPO). The IPO comprises a fresh issue of up to ₹285 crore and an offer-for-sale of up to 3,157,880 shares.

The price band was fixed at ₹372-392 per share. It will open on March 24. "The proposed IPO represents an important milestone in SAI's growth journey. It reflects the progress we have made as an organisation and provides us with an opportunity to further accelerate our strategic objectives," Anil KK, Chairman and Managing Director, SPL, said in a release.

"The proceeds from the IPO will support the next phase of our expansion, particularly in strengthening our global formulations business and expanding our Contract Development and Manufacturing Organisation capabilities across both injectable products and oral solid dosage formulations," he added.

BROKER'S CALL.

Systematix Institutional Equities

PATANJALI FOODS (BUY)
Target: ₹660
CMP: ₹486.95

The management of Patanjali Foods (PFL) issued a cautiously optimistic commentary during our recent visit to its facility at Haridwar. It emphasised that the ongoing conflict in West Asia has not impacted spot prices of edible oils (c.70 per cent of revenue) so far. However, futures' prices in Chicago vegetable oils have increased — the management indicated high correlation between crude oil (c.+12 per cent quarter on quarter in Q4FY26 so far) and edible oils. We believe prices of edible oils and biscuits (containing refined palm oil) are likely to move higher on the back of these trends. Cost-inflation in edible oils is largely pass-through.

While costs have started looking up, PFL has leveraged its pricing power and brand equity in maintaining double-digit sales growth despite sharp pricing in the earlier cost-upcycle. The favourable turn in foods' growth across biscuits, staples and ethnic foods is a key positive; we believe growth is being driven by PFL's expanding distribution network and the launch of premium variants – we expect FY25-28E sales' CAGR of 7.5 per cent.

While near-term margin outcomes remains a monitorable, with the revenue contribution of FMCG products estimated to expand from 7 per cent in FY22 to c.32 per cent in FY28E, we expect PFL to garner superior blended margins over FY26E-28E.

We maintain our BUY rating with TP of ₹660, valuing the stock at P/E of 36x on December-2027E EPS (at a c.15 per cent discount to FMCG peers' FY28E average).

HDFC Securities

FSN E-COMMERCE VENTURES (SELL)
Target: ₹205
CMP: ₹240.10

Nykaa's FY26 customer acquisition drive, especially in BPC (priced-in), is certainly encouraging. However, we suspect that in the medium term, the ask from BPC growth remains high. In 9MFY26 (HSIE estimates), if one strips out own brands' sales and eB2B, core BPC is estimated to have grown at sub-20 per cent.

While own brands (BPC) grew about 69 per cent year on year in 9MFY26, own channel sales grew 47 per cent. Core BPC margins do not offer operating levers as ad income (as percentage of NSV) naturally drops with increase in own brand salience and rise in investments in rapid fulfilment options. In 9MFY26, Nykaa Fashion has done a commendable job of balancing growth and cutting back its burn (improved EBITDAM). Most of these gains have come from cutting back on marketing spends and employee/other expenses (below CM-level expenses). Getting to positive unit economics from here may have to be done cutting down on customer acquisition spends, which could, in turn, have growth implications.

Nykaa remains an efficient online business, especially for BPC. Fashion remains a WIP. Valuations at about 66x EV/EBITDA remain heady. We maintain our FY27/28 EBITDA estimates and our SELL rating with a TP of ₹205/share (implying 58x FY28 pre-IND AS EV/EBITDA).

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

TODAY'S PICK.

Linde India (₹7,321.20): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

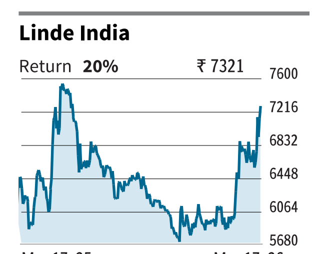
The short-term outlook is bullish for Linde India. The stock has been gradually moving up over the last couple of weeks.

Key supports are at ₹6,940, ₹6,820 and ₹6,680. We see a high chance of the stock sustaining above ₹6,940. The 55-Day Moving Average (DMA) is on the verge of making a bullish crossover above the 200-DMA.

This also strengthens the bullish case.

Linde India's share price can rise to ₹7,700 in the coming weeks. Traders can buy Linde India shares now at ₹7,321.

Accumulate on dips at ₹7,060. Keep the stop-loss at ₹6,940 initially. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹7,380 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹7,460. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹7,490 and ₹7,580 when the share price touches ₹7,540 and ₹7,630, respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹7,680.



Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

23613 » **Nifty 50 Futures**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
23540	23380	23700	23820	Go long on a break above 23700 with a stop-loss at 23670

₹843 » **HDFC Bank**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
838	832	850	857	Take fresh longs above 850. Keep the stop-loss at 848

₹1234 » **Infosys**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1218	1180	1245	1260	Can go either way from here. Avoid trading the stock

₹304 » **ITC**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
300	295	307	310	Go short now and at 306. Stop-loss can be kept at 308

₹265 » **ONGC**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
262	259	269	272	Go long now and at 263. Stop-loss can be placed at 261

₹1394 » **Reliance Ind.**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1385	1360	1410	1425	Go long only above 1410. Stop-loss can be kept at 1405

₹1064 » **SBI**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1055	1040	1080	1090	Go long on dips at 1060. Keep the stop-loss at 1050

₹2390 » **TCS**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2360	2320	2410	2430	Go long on a break above 2410. Keep the stop-loss at 2405

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers ▲ 172.35 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
ICICI Bank	1288.70	24.76	16.28	8.56
Bharti Airtel	1827.00	23.35	28.12	4.74
Eternal Ltd.	234.63	19.84	980.20	1.57
L&T	3542.80	18.91	25.68	3.87
M&M	3128.90	18.17	23.02	2.60
HDFC Bank	845.35	15.94	16.80	12.03
Tata Steel	195.43	15.39	26.75	1.50
Axis Bank	1228.10	8.43	14.43	3.27
Bharat Elec	439.35	7.74	53.86	1.46
Kotak Bank	374.20	7.02	19.80	2.56
Maruti Suzuki	12972.00	6.19	27.31	1.58
Hindalco	936.65	4.92	13.09	1.26
JSW Steel	1167.20	4.45	36.75	1.02
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1004.60	3.87	20.66	1.31
HDFC Life	642.30	3.84	73.32	0.64
Reliance Ind	1397.60	3.70	19.34	8.78
ONGC	264.75	3.66	7.41	0.96
IntGlobeAvi	4287.90	3.26	51.63	0.90
Sun Pharma	1794.40	2.60	39.31	1.77
Eicher Motors	6910.00	2.49	35.38	0.88
Grasim Ind	2683.30	2.42	19.28	0.95
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	237.60	2.34	94.06	0.72
SBI Life	1932.10	2.26	78.15	0.81
Tata Motors PV	319.20	2.20	43.41	0.62
Asian Paints	2238.20	2.03	54.91	0.94
Trent Ltd.	3634.50	1.87	79.76	0.75
NTPC	383.35	0.99	14.97	1.69
Coal India	462.25	0.97	9.57	0.98
Max Healthcare	976.40	0.95	66.93	0.68
Dr Reddys Lab	1283.80	0.92	19.40	0.73
Bajaj Auto	9110.00	0.90	28.64	0.94
PowerGrid Corp	298.50	0.75	17.88	1.26
UltraTech Cement	11116.00	0.44	42.75	1.23
Tech Mahindra	1341.80	0.32	28.63	0.79
Apollo Hosp	7500.00	0.23	57.80	0.72
Bajaj Finserv	1774.70	0.10	14.77	0.94
Titan	4090.50	-0.03	76.20	1.57
Adani Enter	1975.40	-0.15	16.13	0.48
NestleIndia	1206.90	-1.02	71.35	0.81
Adani Ports	1365.50	-1.36	25.17	0.94
HCL Tech	1321.10	-1.74	21.77	1.30
State Bank	1064.70	-1.82	11.36	4.11
TataConsumerProduct	1078.00	-2.10	72.49	0.65
Cipla	1281.90	-2.23	22.84	0.67
Wipro	191.32	-2.37	15.05	0.51
Hind Unilever	2158.20	-3.41	50.43	1.78
TCS	2391.70	-3.92	18.04	2.27
Bajaj Finance	868.60	-5.56	29.49	2.15
ITC	304.85	-7.19	18.45	2.73
Infosys	1232.90	-12.99	17.85	4.02

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers ▲ 559.30 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
Tvs Motor Cmp .	3492.00	82.56	54.33	3.78
Vedanta	699.35	69.98	16.51	5.47
Tata Power	400.85	51.89	25.58	3.11
Power Finance	418.05	51.55	4.13	2.81
Dlf	547.80	33.59	30.62	1.62
Samvardmothersoninternatl	115.83	33.45	33.59	2.37
Hindustanaeronautics	3963.10	28.46	29.79	3.47
Jindal Steel	1157.30	27.24	58.56	2.00
Indian Hotels Co. .	622.05	22.93	40.91	2.52
Canara Bank	136.58	20.94	6.73	2.12
Cg Power & Ind Sol	708.40	20.09	100.55	2.24
Rural Elec	337.70	19.67	5.16	1.95
Bank Of Baroda	283.25	18.37	7.46	2.42
Adani Power .	155.60	18.23	26.56	2.83
Hindus Zinc	546.35	16.26	19.56	1.09
Info Edge I	963.10	15.74	37.06	1.73
Havells	1317.10	14.98	55.71	1.53
Abb India	6310.50	14.55	79.30	1.53
Shree Cement	23675.00	14.44	47.56	1.46
Gail (India)	147.71	13.35	11.29	1.84
Torrent Pharma	4305.50	12.21	64.14	2.08
Punjab Natl Bank	112.00	10.66	7.20	1.78
Ambuja Cements	434.20	9.51	21.81	1.22
Bosch	30645.00	7.55	32.79	1.23
Mazagoan Dock	2362.30	6.95	39.59	0.83
Siemens	3173.50	6.34	71.28	1.29
Divis Lab	6086.50	5.91	65.18	3.57
Britannia Ind	5857.50	5.48	58.39	3.19
Adani Energy Solutions .	1000.60	4.27	50.42	1.60
Bajaj Holdings	9663.00	4.16	12.00	1.93
Pidilitind	1357.00	3.17	59.68	1.94
Hyundai Motor India .	1971.20	3.12	27.66	1.30
Cholamandalamin&Fin	1529.00	2.41	26.62	2.98
Zyduslifesciences	889.80	2.18	17.81	1.03
Indian Railway Finance Corp	96.74	1.61	18.04	0.80
Adanigreenenergy	868.65	1.56	77.09	1.23
Jsw Energy .	505.80	1.05	33.96	1.25
Lic	777.75	0.27	9.28	0.80
Godrej Consumer	1041.10	0.00	58.48	1.93
Bajaj Housing Finance .	81.30	-0.03	27.34	0.35
Varun Beverages .	406.35	-3.28	44.88	2.57
Solar Industries	14034.00	-3.51	83.18	1.58
Ltimindtree	4189.20	-4.98	26.29	1.79
Siemens Energy India .	2768.90	-4.99	83.47	1.13
Macrotech Developers .	842.20	-5.53	25.14	1.09
Icici Lombard Gic	1835.80	-10.68	33.43	2.05
United Spirits .	1301.40	-14.18	55.03	1.77
Avenuesuper	3781.40	-16.13	85.91	2.57
Indian Oilcorp	146.68	-25.56	5.62	2.53
Bpcl	300.05	-28.50	5.29	2.68

Pts: Impact on index movement

QUICKLY.

Jio introduces UPI-based cash withdrawal services

New Delhi: Jio Payments Bank, a wholly-owned subsidiary of Jio Financial Services (JFSL), has introduced UPI-based cash withdrawal through its business correspondent touchpoints. The feature enables customers to withdraw cash by simply scanning a UPI QR code and authorising the transaction through their UPI application, JFSL said in a statement on Tuesday. PTI

NPCI expands UPI acceptance in Sri Lanka

New Delhi: NPCI International Payments Ltd, has reaffirmed its commitment to expanding UPI merchant acceptance in Sri Lanka. The initiative aims to enhance cross-border payment experiences for Indian tourists, support Sri Lanka's growing digital economy, and strengthen deep economic ties between India and Sri Lanka, NIPL said on Tuesday. PTI

India Inc's ECB mop-up crosses $5 b mark for the first time in current fiscal

CORE DRIVERS. With domestic corporate bond yields rising, firms ventured overseas for cheaper funding

Our Bureau
Mumbai

OFFSHORE DEBT. ECBs are commercial loans raised by eligible resident entities from recognised non-resident entities

Funds mobilised by India Inc via the external commercial borrowing (ECB) route vaulted over the $5 billion mark for the first time in the current financial year in January 2026 amid marginal cost of funds-based lending rate (MCLR) and hardening domestic bond yields.

Indian companies mopped up $5.336 billion in January 2026 against $4.435 billion in December 2025, per RBI data.

With domestic corporate bond yields rising, corporates ventured overseas for relatively cheaper funding.

For example, during the January 16-February 16 period, interest rate of one-year and three-year 'AAA' rated corporate bond rose to 7.53 per cent from 7.12 per cent during the December 16, 2025-January 14, 2026 period. ECBs are commercial loans raised by eligible resident entities from recognised non-resident entities. These borrowings have conformed to parameters such as minimum maturity, permitted and non-permitted end-uses, maximum all-in-cost ceiling, etc.

The companies that mopped up big-ticket funds under the ECB-automatic route included Microsoft Corporation (India) Pvt Ltd ($726.87 million), Muthoot Finance and ONGC Videsh ($600 million each), Housing And Urban Development Corporation ($446.24 million), Piramal Finance ($350 million), Ampin Energy Green Sixteen Pvt Ltd ($195.72 million), VEH Green Energy ($174 million), Cholamandalam Investment And Finance Company ($150 million), HDB Financial Services and PNB Housing Finance ($100 million each).

REVISED GUIDELINES

Further, two companies that raised funds under the ECB-approval route are —Export-Import Bank of India ($1 billion) and NTPC ($152.15 million).

The RBI, last month, issued liberalised ECB guidelines, whereby India Inc can benefit from a higher borrowing limit at prevailing market-related conditions, change the currency of an ECB and convert the ECB into a non-debt instrument, among others.

Further, a borrower under a restructuring scheme or corporate insolvency resolution process can tap this route to raise funds.

This move has come at a time when the Indian financial markets are seeing outflows amid geopolitical uncertainties and fragmentation in global trade.

This, in turn, is weakening the rupee. But the liberalised ECB norms may prompt India Inc to tap overseas markets and bring in dollars, helping stabilise the rupee.

'Wrongdoing by insurance cos will not go unnoticed'

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Tuesday assured that wrongdoing by insurance companies will not go unnoticed. She also informed the Rajya Sabha that 25,000 gram panchayats will be covered under insurance inclusion.

Responding to a question, Sitharaman, in her oral reply, emphasised that all companies are regulated very systematically and methodically by the insurance regulator. "If there are any wrongdoings by insurance companies, the regulator acts upon them," she said while giving details of action taken during last three years.

"If there is undue influence by insurance companies using their dominant position, or when they make false and misleading claims, misrepresent facts, omit key features while selling insurance, or fail to ensure suitability of the policy, all such acts of omission and commission are acted upon," she said.

PENALTIES LEVIED

For instance, in 2023–24, a penalty of ₹2 crore was levied on Reliance General Insurance Company for unfair business practices. Similarly, penalties have been imposed on other companies including Bajaj Finance Ltd (₹2 crore), HDFC Life Insurance(₹2 crore), SBI Life Insurance (₹1 crore), and Royal Sundaram General Insurance (₹1 crore).

"If insurance cover is extended without obtaining the consent of the insured, penalties are levied. Likewise, erroneous allocation of premiums, delays in settlement of maturity claims or survival benefits and non-payment of interest are all investigated and penalised," she said while urging people to complaint directly to the regulator or use the CP-GRAMS portal.

On the issue of health insurance for more people, she said that 100 per cent FDI in the insurance sector primarily aims to bring greater penetration and deepen the insurance market.

GRAM PANCHAYAT

She said IRDAI has notified Insurance Regulatory Development Authority Rules for the rural social sector and motor third-party obligations in 2024, whereby gram panchayat level inclusion happens for insurance.

"The way in which it is going to be organised is that the unit of measurement for coverage and for rural obligation will be the gram panchayat. I would like to inform that 25,000 gram panchayats will be covered this time," she said.

Later in a written reply, the Minister said in according to FY25 IRDAI data, there are 251.85 lakh individual health insurance policies, which include family members as well, covering 6.01 crore people. Further, there are 13.05 lakh group health insurance policies, covering 27.51 crore members.

At the same time, as on February 28, 2026, a total of 43.52 crore Ayushman cards have been created across the country. For FY25, 3.84 crore number of insured persons and 14.91 crore number of beneficiaries are covered in Employees' State Insurance Corporation. Also, 20.35 lakh serving beneficiaries and 23.32 lakh pensioner beneficiaries are covered under Central Government Health Scheme (CGHS).

NCLT approves Adani's resolution plan for JAL

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

The Allahabad bench of the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) on Tuesday approved the resolution plan by Adani Enterprises for Jaiprakash Associates, directing the company's delisting from stock exchanges and the full cancellation of all existing shares and other securities held before the insolvency process, with current shareholders to receive nil consideration.

The approved plan, originally submitted on October 14, 2025, with clarifications on November 5, 2025, provides a roadmap for Adani Enterprises to take control and restructure the company. The committee of creditors had earlier approved Adani group's ₹14,535 crore bid to acquire JAL.

LIQUIDATION VALUE

Under the approved plan, all existing shares, preference shares, unissued capital, convertible instruments, rights, warrants, and other pre-insolvency interests will be fully cancelled on the Effective Date, which will occur within 90 days of NCLT approval.

The plan also notes that the liquidation value of the company is insufficient to satisfy secured creditors, leaving shareholders with no payout (as stated in the regulatory filing of Jaiprakash Associates).

'India to remain 5th largest economy in FY27'

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

Chief Economic Advisor V Anantha Nageswaran

Chief Economic Advisor V Anantha Nageswaran told a Parliamentary panel that India will continue to be the fifth largest economy in FY27, mainly on account of base-year revision and exchange rate.

The panel, Standing Committee on Finance, tabled its report on Tuesday.

$500 B GAP WITH JAPAN

According to the report, in his oral evidence on March 2, Nageswaran said: "Japan's economy is estimated to be at $4.4 trillion by the end of December 2025. Hence, we will have a gap of at least $500 billion compared to Japan. Therefore, becoming the fourth largest economy in 2026- 2027 is not going to be easy. We will still be the fifth largest economy in 2026-2027."

However, in 2027-2028, "we may have a chance to become the fourth largest, as much will depend on the exchange rate as to how we are able to overtake Japan," he said.

According to Nageswaran, due to base year revision (from 2011-12 to 2022-23), India's nominal GDP is lower by approximately ₹12 lakh crore as of 2025-2026. "We initially expected ₹357.1 lakh crore as of March 2026. The new revisions may leave us with ₹345.4 lakh crore. This, divided by the average exchange rate for 2025-2026, places us at $3.9 trillion. We were at $3.9 trillion by March 2025, but due to the revision and the rupee's exchange rate depreciation, we are still at $3.9 trillion," he said, adding that last year got revised downwards to $3.75 trillion. Therefore, "we will be a $3.9 trillion economy as of March 2026," he said.

On the issue of India overtaking Germany and becoming the third largest economy, he put up a guarded view. "Given the current trends of India's real GDP growth, which we expect to be at least 7 per cent and possibly 10 to 11 per cent in nominal terms, if capital flows recover and India's macroeconomic stability is well recognised by investors, both direct and portfolio, it is plausible that by the end of the decade, we will be positioned to become the third largest economy in dollar terms," he said.

Outflows, strong dollar weigh on the rupee

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

The rupee remained under pressure last week and slipped to a fresh lifetime low of 92.48 on Friday. Although the domestic currency recovered marginally thereafter, it closed at 92.38 on Tuesday, indicating that the broader weakness persists.

WEEKLY RUPEE VIEW.

A major factor weighing on the rupee has been capital outflows. According to NSDL data, foreign portfolio investors' net outflow so far in March is $9 billion compared with a net inflow of $4.2 billion in February.

External sector data has also turned less supportive. India's merchandise trade deficit widened to $27.1 billion in February, nearly doubling from $14.1 billion a year ago, driven by a 25 per cent rise in imports. Though the figure came slightly below market expectations of $28 billion, it still indicates elevated demand for dollars.

Globally, the dollar index continues to hold firm around the 100 mark, supported by safe-haven demand. Markets are closely watching the upcoming Federal Reserve policy decision on Wednesday. While rates are widely expected to remain unchanged, investors will focus on the central bank's guidance, particularly how it views rising oil prices and the potential implications for inflation.

The dollar has also been drawing strength from the perception that the US economy is better positioned to withstand an energy shock, given its greater energy independence. For India, however, the combination of a strong dollar and elevated oil prices adds pressure on the rupee due to the country's heavy dependence on energy imports.

Reflecting these pressures, India's foreign exchange reserves fell to $716.81 billion for the week ended March 6, down from $728.49 billion by the end of preceding week, suggesting that the RBI likely intervened in the market to smoothen the volatility.

The price action of the rupee shows a clear bearish bias, more so until the support-turned-resistance of 92 holds. Another leg of downtrend from the current level can drag the local currency to 92.50 and then possibly to 92.75. However, if the rupee gains strength and surpasses the nearest barrier at 92, the upswing can extend to 91.70. Immediate resistance above 91.70 is at 91.55 – the 21-day moving average.

But the next trend largely depends on how the dollar behaves. If the dollar index, currently at 99.75, resumes the uptrend, it can touch 100.50. A breakout of this can take it higher to 100.80. In this scenario, the rupee can decline to 92.50 or 92.75.

On the other hand, if the dollar index falls from the current level, it can dip to 99.40 or to 99.20. Such a correction can help the rupee gain to 91.70 and 91.55. That said, one should be wary that the broader trend for the dollar is bullish and so, any recovery in the Indian currency is likely to be temporary.

OUTLOOK

Overall, the bias remains negative for the rupee as long as it trades below 92. A move towards 92.50–92.75 is likely if the dollar index resumes its rally. However, the next directional cue could come from the Federal Reserve's policy guidance. Any softness in the dollar following the meeting may allow the rupee to recover towards 91.70–91.55, though such gains may be limited and short-lived.

RBI injects ₹48,014 cr into banking system

Press Trust of India
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Tuesday injected ₹48,014 crore in transient liquidity into the banking system through a seven-day variable rate repo (VRR) auction. These funds were infused at a cut-off rate of 5.25 and weighted average rate of 5.26 per cent, according to the RBI's release.

The liquidity injected was much lower than the notified amount of ₹1.50 lakh crore, despite the sharp drop in the surplus liquidity in the banking system on account of advance tax payments.

Under the VRR auction, the central bank auctions funds at variable interest rates for a short period, allowing banks to bid for a certain amount.

Liquidity in the banking system is expected to tighten further after the outflows towards payment of GST, scheduled later this week.

SBI raises ₹6,051 crore via Basel III compliant tier 2 bonds

Our Bureau
Mumbai

State Bank of India (SBI) on Tuesday raised ₹6,051 crore at a coupon rate of 7.05 per cent via its second Basel III compliant tier 2 bond issuance in the current financial year.

The bonds are issued for a tenor of 10 years, with call option after 5 years and each anniversary date thereafter, India's largest bank said in a regulatory filing.

ROBUST RESPONSE

The bonds, which are rated "AAA with stable outlook" by CRISIL Ratings and India Ratings and Research, attracted robust response from investors with bids of approximately 2 times against the base issue size of ₹5,000 crore, per the filing.

The total number of bids received was 47 indicating participation from diverse set of qualified institutional bidders, the bank said. The investors were across provident funds, pension funds, mutual funds, banks etc.

The bonds are issued for a tenor of 10 years, with call option after 5 years and each anniversary date thereafter

C S Setty, Chairman, SBI said the wider participation and heterogeneity of bids demonstrated the trust investors place in the Bank.

Standard Chartered Bank settles FPI rules violation case with SEBI

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Standard Chartered Bank settled with SEBI a case alleging violations of FPI rules and other regulatory norms after paying ₹57.20 lakh towards settlement charges.

After receipt of the settlement amount by SEBI, the instant adjudication proceedings initiated against Standard Chartered Bank vide Show Cause Notice (SCN) dated June 17, 2025, are hereby disposed of in terms of settlement regulations, the regulator said in its order passed on Tuesday.

In its show cause notice, SEBI alleged that Standard Chartered Bank (noticee) acted as a designated depository participant (DDP), and failed to report to SEBI instances of delay exceeding six months in the intimation of material changes relating to beneficial ownership in respect of certain Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs).

RBI fixes SGB redemption price at ₹15,814 per unit

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The RBI has fixed a redemption price of ₹15,814 per unit for premature redemption of Sovereign Gold Bond issued on September 17, 2019.

Accordingly, the redemption price for premature redemption is due on March 17. The SGB 2019-20 Series IV was issued at ₹3,890 per gram for offline buyers and ₹3,840 per gram for online buyers. Consequently, investors who are opting for premature redemption now will get a return of over four times.

TAX RULE CHANGE

From April 1, SGB capital gains tax rules will change, allowing tax-free gains only for original subscribers who hold bonds until eight-year maturity. Secondary market buyers or those exiting early will face a 12.5 per cent long-term capital gains tax (without indexation) or short-term rates.

The redemption price was based on the simple average of closing price of gold for the last three business days as published by the India Bullion and Jewellers Association, said the RBI.

Per the SGB Scheme, premature redemption of Gold Bond will be allowed after fifth year from the date of issue. However, the bond tenure is of 8 years. RBI has issued about 14.70 crore units of SGB so far and redeemed 2.33 crore unit, so far.

Public Insurance Registry key to modernising insurance information architecture: IRDAI chief

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

A Public Insurance Registry (PIR) will be an important step towards modernising the information architecture of the insurance sector, according to Ajay Seth, Chairman, Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI).

Speaking at an Industry Stakeholders' Discussion on the proposed PIR and Bima Sugam in New Delhi on Tuesday, Seth said by enabling standardised, consent-based access to structured insurance data, the initiative would seek to enhance transparency, strengthen consumer confidence, and support more effective regulatory oversight.

> This reform is intended to build a more accountable, efficient and data-driven insurance ecosystem
>
> AJAY SETH
> Chairman, IRDAI

EMPOWER CONSUMERS

"This reform is intended to build a more accountable, efficient and data-driven insurance ecosystem that can support sustainable growth in insurance inclusion, as envisaged in 'Sabka Bima Sabki Raksha vision," he added.

The PIR is envisioned as a consent-driven, legally compliant digital infrastructure covering the entire policy lifecycle from issuance to claims, grievance redressal, and dispute resolution. As a structured, interoperable information infrastructure it will empower consumers by bridging the knowledge gap between different participants and bringing more transparency in the entire insurance value chain.

The platform is envisaged to consolidate structured insurance data across stakeholders, reduce information asymmetry, improve fraud detection, and enable data-driven regulatory oversight.

The meeting brought together senior leadership from insurance companies and other invited stakeholders from the insurance ecosystem to deliberate on the vision, design, and implementation roadmap of PIR,, according to a release.

JSM disputes Hard Rock's termination of partnership

Our Bureau
Mumbai

JSM Corporation Pvt Ltd has disputed Hard Rock International's termination of their franchise agreements, calling the move "unilateral" and saying it was made "without proper consultation or regard for a partnership that has spanned more than two decades."

In a statement posted on LinkedIn on March 17, JSM said it was "deeply shocked and saddened" by Hard Rock International's announcement and maintained that its outlets remain open.

'REVIEWING SITUATION'

The company said it is "reviewing the situation and evaluating all legal and contractual remedies available." JSM added that its priority remains "the people who built this business with us — our employees, partners, and customers in India."

The pushback follows Hard Rock International's termination of its agreements with JSM Corporation, announced on March 16, covering the right to operate all Hard Rock Cafes and Rock Shops across India. The affected locations span 10 cities — Bengaluru , Chandigarh, Chennai, Hyderabad, Hyderabad Hitech City, Kolkata, New Delhi and Pune. Hard Rock clarified that the Hard Rock Hotel Goa is unaffected, as it operates under a separate arrangement.

CHENNAI
businessline.
WEDNESDAY - MARCH 18 - 2026

QUICKLY.

Gold steady as markets await Fed decision

Gold prices held steady on Tuesday as market participants monitored the intensifying Iran conflict and awaited the US Fed's upcoming policy decision. Spot gold was little changed at $5,011.38 per ounce by 1250 GMT. US gold futures for April delivery rose 0.3 per cent to $5,016.40. Silver fell 0.3 per cent to $80.52; platinum gained 0.8 per cent to $2,130.23. REUTERS

Iran war, rising stocks drag copper down

Copper dipped as Iran launched fresh attacks on US allies in the Gulf and London Metal Exchange inventories climbed to their highest in 6-1/2 years. Benchmark LME three-month copper was down 0.5 per cent to $12,790 a tonne. Copper stocks in LME warehouses rose to 330,375 tonnes, the most since late August 2019. REUTERS

Crude oil bounces back as war halts supply

Crude oil prices rose around 3 per cent on renewed supply fears, with the Strait of Hormuz largely shut and US allies rejecting calls to deploy warships to escort tankers. Brent futures jumped $3.07 to $103.28 a barrel by 0734 GMT, while US WTI gained $3.35 to $96.85. REUTERS

Iran war likely to hit global fertilizer market

SUPPLY BOTTLENECK. Experts say a squeeze of key chemicals like sulphur will affect supplies to global manufacturers

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

With shipments across the Strait of Hormuz stranded due to the Iran war, a squeeze in supplies of key chemicals such as sulphur will likely affect the fertilizer market, analysts and experts said.

The development could particularly affect the Indian agriculture sector, though one-third of the global fertilizer trade could be disrupted.

Fertilizers account for nearly 25 per cent of agricultural commodity production costs.

"The shipment of natural gas has declined precipitously, which affects feedstock for nitrogenous-based fertilizers," said Michael Werz, Senior Fellow at the US-based Council on Foreign Relations (CFR).

SHORT-LIVED CONFLICT

According to research agency BMI, a unit of Fitch Solutions, the Iran war may be short-lived, and it is shielding the US and China for now. India faces the most imminent risk among major agricultural markets.

The timing is particularly critical.

While the current disruption falls outside peak import season for several major markets, India's fertilizer demand window is fast approaching — late March through April, said the research agency. The peak phosphate production season begins in June.

"This means the conflict is occurring during a key import window ahead of both peak application and production periods," said BMI.

Joseph Glauber, Research Fellow Emeritus, International Food Policy Research Institute (IFPRI), said 20-30 per cent of global fertilizer exports, including urea, ammonia, phosphates and sulphur, pass through the Strait of Hormuz.

FOOD SECURITY

"A prolonged conflict would likely choke global sea trade with the Persian Gulf region, raising the costs of energy and fertilizer prices globally, directly threatening food security," Glauber said.

TWIN THREATS. The risks from the Iran war are compounded by the emerging likelihood of an El Nino event as reduced fertilizer application could significantly dent crop yields

Conflict-afflicted Bahrain, Oman, Qatar, and Saudi Arabia are critical exporters of urea, diammonium phosphate (DAP) and anhydrous ammonia, said CFR's Werz.

"With shipping activity through the Strait of Hormuz affected, the effect on global fertilizer exports is enormous and will generate cascading effects," he said.

BMI said the Iran war risk is compounded by the emerging likelihood of an El Nino event, where reduced fertilizer application, amid the already stressed growing conditions, could significantly impact yields.

CUT IN APPLICATION

It would be difficult to see how production lost due to gas shortages can be meaningfully replaced through ramped-up production elsewhere. "At that point, a reduced application becomes unavoidable," said the research agency.

IFPRI's Glauber said the conflict could affect sowing decisions and yields in the Southern Hemisphere, as well as fertilizer applications for rice in South and South-East Asia.

He said the plunge in shipping activity through the Strait of Hormuz had pushed global fertilizer prices higher.

Falling shipments of natural gas — an important feedstock for nitrogenous-based fertilizers — have driven up prices, while fertilizer exports from the Persian Gulf have dropped precipitously.

Werz said countries across the world had increasingly relied on the Gulf region to offset fertilizer losses from the Ukraine war and growing Chinese export restrictions.

PRICES SURGE

"But with about one quarter of global fertilizer production passing through the Strait of Hormuz, prices are already spiking. In the Middle East, urea price rose by 19 per cent within a week, creating new fiscal challenges for agriculture sectors across the globe," he said.

BMI said sulphur is essential for nitrogen blends and phosphate production. It represented a significant risk to the global fertilizer industry, though the impact will be moderate.

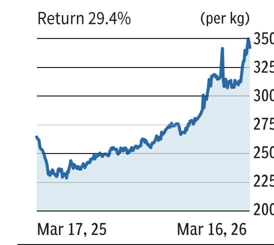
The research agency said the second-month US Gulf f.o.b granular urea prices shot up 15.9 per cent between March 2 and March 11.

Glauber said Middle East urea prices closed over $590 per tonne on March 5, up over $90 compared to a week earlier. US Gulf DAP prices hit $655/tonne, up 5 per cent.

BMI said China, which depends on sulphur imports from the region for phosphate fertilizer production, faces more pronounced risks, though they remain manageable.

COMMODITY CALL.

Buy aluminium futures if price softens to ₹341



Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Aluminium futures, which faced a moderation in price over the last two sessions, are now trading at ₹343 a kg.

The broader trend is up and even though the contract softened recently, the uptrend is intact.

The immediate outlook for aluminium futures is positive as the support at ₹340 stays valid.

Going ahead, we will most likely see a rally to ₹350, a resistance. If this level is breached, the contract will be able to go higher, probably to ₹375.

On the other hand, if the contract breaches the support at ₹340, it will open the door for a decline to ₹333, a potential support. The nearest base below ₹333 is at ₹325.

Here is our expectation given the above factors. Aluminium futures are likely to slip to ₹340 and then see a rally to ₹350.

Therefore, traders could consider buying. That said, the movement after the contract touches ₹350 is uncertain at the moment.

TRADE STRATEGY

Buy aluminium futures if the price softens to ₹341. Place stop-loss at ₹338.

When the contract rises to ₹346, tighten the stop-loss to ₹341. Book profits at ₹350.

ISMA seeks hike in selling price even as cane dues hit ₹5,000 cr

Our Bureau
New Delhi

As much as ₹4,898 crore is yet to paid by sugar mills in Maharashtra to sugarcane farmers as of February 28 in the current season, which necessitates a revision in the minimum selling price (MSP) of sugar, said an industry body.

"As the sugar season advances and reaches its penultimate phase, the industry continues to await an early upward revision of the MSP. With production costs increasing and ex-mill realisations lagging, mills are facing mounting cash-flow pressures, leading to higher cane payment arrears," said the Indian Sugar and Bio-energy Manufacturers Association (ISMA). In Maharashtra, sugarcane arrears (amount not paid to farmers within 14 days) were ₹4,898 crore as of February 28, 2026, compared with ₹2,949 crore in the corresponding period last season, it said in a statement.

NOT SO SWEET. With production costs increasing and ex-mill realisations lagging, the mills are facing mounting cash-flow pressures

157 MILLS OPERATING

"A timely MSP revision aligned with current cost structure is crucial to restore mill viability, expedite farmer payments and maintain market stability, without any additional fiscal burden on the government," ISMA said. It also said that sugar production had reached 26.21 million tonnes (mt) so far in the ongoing 2025-26 season, up by 10.5 per cent from 23.72 mt in the year-ago period.

The output so far has exceeded the total net production of 26.12 mt in the entire 2024-25 season (October-September).

STATE-WISE DETAILS

Crushing operations were underway as 157 mills were in operation as on March 15, while 379 mills had closed operations.

As per the data, production in Maharashtra, the country's largest sugar producer, rose to 9.84 mt as of March 15 from 7.87 mt year-ago.

Production in Uttar Pradesh, the largest sugarcane producing State, reached 8.13 mt from 8.12 mt, while in Karnataka it reached 4.60 mt from 3.92 mt in the said period.

ISMA said that some mills in south Karnataka were expected to resume operations during the special season from June/July to September 2026.

Iran war affects Indian oilmeal exports

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

The Solvent Extractors' Association of India (SEA) has said that the escalating conflict between Iran and the US/Israel has significantly disrupted India's oilmeal exports, particularly to West Asia and Europe, due to instability around the Strait of Hormuz and the Red Sea.

BV Mehta, Executive Director of the SEA, said shipping companies are avoiding the Red Sea and the Strait of Hormuz, causing detours that increase transit times and costs, which threaten the continuity of oilmeal exports to West Asia and Europe.

On alternative routes, he said the forced detour around the Cape of Good Hope adds 10-15 days to shipping journeys, causing delays and container shortages. Roughly 20 per cent of India's oilmeal exports destined for West Asia and 15 per cent destined for Europe are at risk due to logistics and shipping disruptions, he said. The conflict has caused a surge in crude oil prices (crossing $100 a barrel) and increased insurance premium for vessels. This has made shipments costlier and less viable.

Data compiled by the SEA showed that India exported 34.93 lakh tonnes (lt) of oilmeals during April-February of 2025-26 against 39.33 lt in the corresponding period of 2024-25, registering a decline of 11.18 per cent.

The overall export of soybean meal declined by 23 per cent to 14.92 lt during April-February 2025-26 (19.40 lt in April-February 2024-25). Export of soybean meal declined by 48 per cent to 4.73 lt (9.16 lt) during the four months of the new season (November-February), Mehta said. This is because Indian soybean meal is expensive in the international market at $483 a tonne (FOB). Argentine soybean meal is priced at $420 a tonne (CIF Rotterdam).

CHINESE CHALLENGE

He said Indian rapeseed meal exports had surged during the year, driven by massive demand from China and competitive pricing against European suppliers, with high protein content making it ideal for animal feed. China's imports exceeded 7.7 lt in April-February 2025-26.

Indian rapeseed meal is currently priced about $225 a tonne (FOB/FAS Kandla), making it cheaper than Hamburg rapeseed meal (ex-mill) at $297 a tonne.

India's exports, however, dipped temporarily in early 2026 due to lower crushing ahead of new crop arrivals. He said China imposed 100 per cent tariffs on Canadian rapeseed meal and oil in March 2025, in retaliation for Canada's duty on Chinese electric vehicles.

The move made Canadian shipments economically unviable, forcing China to look for alternative suppliers, with India emerging as the main beneficiary in bridging the supply gap.

China suspended the 100 per cent tariffs on Canadian Canola (rapeseed) meal with effect from March 1 ,2026, lasting until December 31, 2026. Exports of Indian rapeseed meal to China will face competition because of this, he said.

Comparing the current price level of oilmeals with that in February 2025, he said soybean meal prices had jumped to $489 a tonne from $370. Rapeseed meal prices remained more or less same in the range of $240-250 a tonne (FOB) and for castorseed meal in the range of $80 a tonne.

ABUNDANT ARRIVALS

PRICES LAG. Workers sort and pack wheat at a wholesale market in Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh. Though wheat arrivals are picking up, prices in the State are ruling at ₹2,305 a quintal, lower than the minimum support price (MSP) of ₹2,585. Prices are likely to rise once the government begins procurement at MSP for its buffer stocks PTI

Scattered rain triggers uneven coffee blossoms

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

The country's coffee-growing regions have received uneven pre-monsoon rain, leading to scattered blossoms yet another year. Growers are concerned that the patchy showers may influence the robusta crop, even as they await adequate rainfall for arabica, whose flowering normally takes place during late March-early April.

Timely pre-monsoon rain during March-April are crucial for triggering the flowering of coffee buds. These spells are commonly referred to as blossom showers.

"Blossom rains haven't been good anywhere. Rains were very scattered. It is a cause for concern, but too early to say anything now. Growers who have irrigation setups are giving artificial irrigation. In some areas, it rained yesterday with a lot of hailstorms, which is very bad," said M Salman Baseer, Chairman, Karnataka Planters' Association.

WEATHER IMPACT. Uneven blossoms, influenced by erratic rainfall patterns, have become a norm in recent years

"Blossom rains have been sporadic. Not all areas have received sufficient blossom rains. It is a little early to comment on the impact. Certain areas have received rainfall yesterday. Hopefully, robusta setting should be good. We may know in a week or two," said Sahadev Balakrishna, Chairman, UPASI Coffee Committee.

"Arabica ideally requires higher quantum of rain for blossom and preferable in late March-early April. This year, the rainfall already received might be too early for an ideal arabica blossom and that too after a higher crop (so naturally it will lead to a lower arabica crop next year as it will be an 'off' year for arabica)," Balakrishna said.

RUNNING BLOSSOMS

Uneven blossoms, influenced by erratic rainfall patterns, have become a norm in recent years, resulting in running blossoms.

A Nanda Belliappa, Chairman of the Codagu Planters Association, said, "Rains have been uneven and quite bad in some areas. People who had access to water have taken up irrigation, while the small growers are dependent on rain. There could be a 10-15 per cent impact on the robusta."

RAINFALL DEFICIT

According to data from the India Meteorological Department, cumulative rainfall during March in Chikkamagaluru was 64 per cent below normal, while the deficiency was 77 per cent in Kodagu and 100 per cent in Hassan.

According to M Senthil Kumar, Director of the Central Coffee Research Institute, this year's blossom showers were scattered and occurred in multiple spells across most coffee-growing regions. Rainfall was received during January (around 10 mm to 41.5 mm) and again in February (about 5 mm to 36.8 mm).

As a result, plantations witnessed multiple rounds of blossoming instead of a single uniform blossom. Such staggered flowering is mainly due to the irregular distribution of rainfall during the blossom period.

Referring to the scattered rainfall, multiple blossoms and fruit-setting observations this year, Kumar said the final yield will depend on the monsoon rain and disease incidence.

Centre hikes 'arthiya' commission in Punjab, Haryana by nearly ₹5/qtl

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Centre has raised the commission payable to *arthiyas* (commission agents) and co-operative societies in the procurement of wheat and paddy for the government, effective from the rabi marketing season 2026-27, scheduled to start from April 1.

Based on the recommendations of a committee, the government hiked the commission for *arthiyas* procuring wheat in Punjab and Haryana to ₹50.75 per quintal from ₹46. The *arthiya* commission for wheat in Rajasthan has been raised to ₹45.67 per quintal from ₹41.40, while the commission for procuring paddy has been hiked to ₹50.61 per quintal from ₹45.88.

Similarly, the commission payable to co-operative societies has been revised to ₹29.79 per quintal from ₹27 for wheat, and to ₹35.30 per quintal from ₹32 for paddy.

For procurement carried out at modern silos, the commission will remain at 50 per cent of the rate applicable in *mandis*, in line with the existing policy framework.

VARYING RATES

Unlike many other schemes where a uniform policy applies across the country, the existing guidelines allow commission rates to vary from State to State and across agencies.

Under the procurement operation, commission is payable to societies, co-operatives, sub-agents and *arthiyas* for providing intermediary and aggregation services.

"Based on requests received from various State governments for revision of the commission rates, a sub-committee was constituted with representatives from the Food Corporation of India (FCI), States and the Department of Food and Public Distribution. The committee examined the prevailing rates and recommended revision of the commission structure," the Food Ministry said in a statement.

The revision of commission rates is aimed at ensuring continued efficiency of the procurement system and supporting the agencies involved in facilitating procurement on behalf of the government, it said.

The procurement estimates for the 2026-27 RMS have been fixed at 30.3 million tonnes (mt) of wheat, 7.6 mt of rabi rice, and 0.78 mt of maize and millets.

China, Vietnam & Bangladesh begin buying Indian cotton yarn

WAR FALLOUT. Prices firm up following global trend and improving demand

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

SPINNING SUCCESS. Demand for yarn is strong from China as well as countries such as Bangladesh and Vietnam. Prices have risen by ₹10-₹15 a kg on higher demand

Demand for Indian cotton yarn has picked up from countries such as China, Bangladesh and Vietnam, among others, following the disruption in global logistics after the breakout of war in West Asia.

"There is a very good demand for cotton yarn from China. Due the disruption in the global supply chain, whatever cotton the Chinese buyers may have bought may not reach in time. So instead of buying cotton, they are buying cotton yarn from India to meet their immediate requirement," said Vinay N Kotak, President, Cotton Association of India (CAI).

Kotak said cotton imports were affected because of this disruption in the supply chain.

The freight rates have gone up and also the prices have moved up. Also, the transit time has increased substantially, maybe by at least 10-15 days, he said.

QUOTAS UP

To ease the cotton supply situation, China increased the quota for import compared to last year.

On Monday, the National Development and Reform Commission (NDRC) of China issued 3 lakh tonnes of cotton sliding-scale duty quota to ease the current tight supply situation. This year, the quota is higher by 1 lakh tonnes when compared with 2025.

Ramanuj Das Boob, a sourcing agent in Raichur, said that the demand for yarn is good from China and also from countries such as Bangladesh and Vietnam.

Yarn prices have improved by ₹10-₹15 per kg on rising demand. Also, the domestic prices are seen improving on firming demand and tracking the global market.

Cotton Futures on the ICE are hovering around 68.78 cents per pound, an increase of 13 per cent over the past two weeks.

CCI HIKES PRICE

In the domestic market, the Cotton Corporation of India (CCI), the largest stock holder, has increased the prices by a total of ₹1,200 per candy in the last two days. "There is good demand for cotton due to the better yarn prices," Boob said.

Taking into account the emerging developments in the markets, the CAI has revised upwards the domestic off-take of cotton by 10 lakh bales (of 170 kg each) to 315 lakh bales as of end-February, compared to the end-January projections of 305 lakh bales.

FACT unveils ₹6,350-cr Capex 2.0 to boost fertilizer self-reliance

V Sajeev Kumar
Kochi

Public sector company Fertilisers and Chemicals Travancore Limited (FACT) plans a major expansion programme — Capex 2.0 — at a total investment of ₹6,350 crore. The initiative aims to strengthen fertilizer manufacturing capacity and contribute to the government's vision of Aatmanirbhar Bharat, which focuses on self-reliance in the fertilizer sector.

The expansion projects include setting up of a 700 tonne per day phosphoric acid plant and a 2,200 tonne per day sulphuric acid plant at the Cochin division, a 1,500 mtpd urea plant at Udyogamandal, and a 20,000 tonne ammonia storage tank at Willingdon Island.

FACT's newly appointed Chairman and Managing Director S Sakthimani told *businessline* that the complex fertilizer plants currently operate using both captive and externally sourced phosphoric and sulphuric acid.

The existing plants have the capacity to produce 8,60,000 tonnes per annum of NP 20:20:0:13 fertilizer.

This capacity is expected to increase to 1.4 million tonnes annually once the proposed 1,650 MTPD NPK plant at the Cochin division becomes operational.

DEDICATED PLANTS

The raw material requirements for the new NP plant will largely be met through imports.

He said that ensuring a consistent supply of sulphuric acid is essential for maintaining uninterrupted production at complex fertilizer plants.

To address this requirement, FACT plans to establish dedicated sulphuric acid and phosphoric acid plants at the Cochin division, along with the augmentation of bulk material handling facilities at both the Cochin division and Willingdon Island.

Besides, the company has proposed setting up an urea plant as an add-on to the existing ammonia plant to utilise the carbon dioxide generated during ammonia production.

S Sakthimani, CMD

An ammonia storage tank is also planned at Willingdon Island to support expanded operations.

The Board of Directors has granted in-principle approval for the expansion projects, which are currently under consideration by the Fertilizer Ministry.

IMPACT OF WAR

FACT is currently setting up a 1,650 tonnes per day NP plant, primarily designed to produce NP 20:20:0:13 fertilizer.

The project will also enable the production of ammonium phosphate sulphate (20:20:0:13) and diammonium phosphate (DAP – 18:46:0). This will help the company strengthen its presence in the phosphatic fertilizer market and diversify its product portfolio.

Production from the new facility is expected to begin during the first half of the 2026-27 financial year.

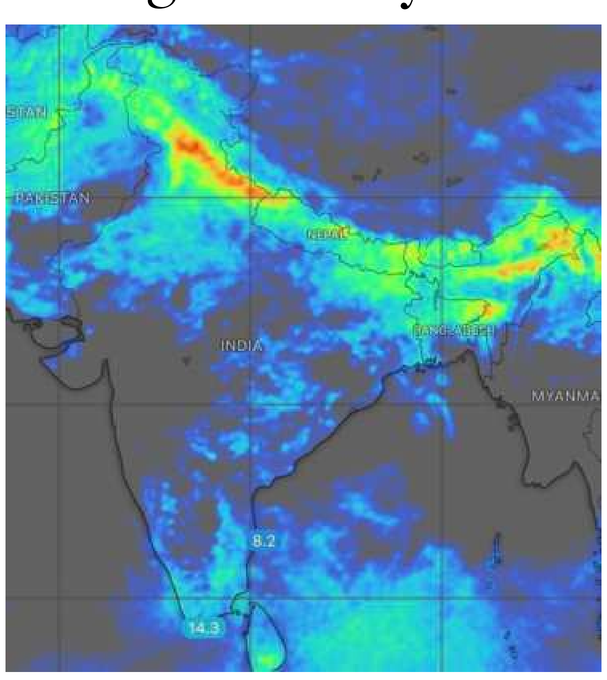
Once completed, the project will enable FACT to increase its fertilizer production capacity from 1 million tonnes to approximately 1.5 million tonnes per year.

To a question on the impact of the West Asia crisis on fertilizer production and raw material availability, Sakthimani said the company is not facing any immediate constraints.

Since the current period is the off-season, FACT is utilising the time to carry out maintenance activities.

Thunderstorms roam parts of country as heat engine briefly exits

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram



WEATHER ALERT. Rain, snow, lightning and thundershowers (blue, green, red) may unfold variously over northern and southern parts of the country for five days until Sunday WWW.WINDY.COM

Sustained western disturbance activity over North-West India has driven away the heat-building anticyclone from the plains of West and adjoining North-West India into the Arabian Sea, allowing troughs and cyclonic circulations to form over disparate parts of the land triggering rain, high winds and thunderstorms.

Numerical weather models of the India Meteorological Department (IMD) suggest the anticyclone may need to extend its stay off Mumbai and the Konkan coast at least until March 27. Emerging variously wet and violent weather is expected to put a cap on mercury levels over North-West, Central and adjoining East India for as many days.

US AGENCY'S FORECAST

The Climate Forecast System of the US has ventured to predict that the occasionally wet weather may persist over most parts of India right into April, with major western disturbance activity holding on until at least April 4. This may continue, though on a less intense scale, until April 24, with North-West, Central and East India being seen to benefit the most.

The IMD models indicated on Tuesday morning that a stream of moisture-laden easterlies from the Bay may maintain a steady stream into the South Peninsula and adjoining Peninsular India laid bare by the anticyclone.

The easterly wind stream may spark isolated to scattered light to moderate rain, thunderstorms, lightning and gusty winds (30-50 km/h) over coastal Andhra Pradesh, Yanam, Telangana, Rayalaseema and Karnataka for next four days, Kerala and Mahe for two days, and Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Karaikal for four days.

WESTERN DISTURBANCE

The IMD located a prevailing western disturbance as a trough having entered Indian territory approximately along the Bathinda latitude in Punjab. An upper air cyclonic circulation over Haryana and north-west Rajasthan persist.

A weather-making east-west-oriented trough lay extended from Haryana and north-west Rajasthan to south-west Uttar Pradesh across north-east Rajasthan.

Towards the South, a trough ran down from north interior Karnataka to the Gulf of Mannar across south interior Karnataka and interior Tamil Nadu.

Telangana urges farmers to shift from paddy to palm oil amid price rise

KV Kurmanath
Hyderabad

Prices of palm oil shot up by 80 per cent from ₹12,000 a tonne to ₹21,546 in Telangana in the past 10 years, with the State government encouraging farmers to move away from the water-guzzling paddy to palm oil plantation.

The State, which grows this edible crop on about one lakh hectares, has set a target to increase the area to 10 lakh hectares over the next few years.

With interest in the plantation crop growing, the State government will inaugurate an oil palm factory with an investment of ₹300 crore at Narmetta village in Siddhipet district.

Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy will formally inaugurate the factory on March 22. The plant will help farmers add value to their produce. He will lay the foundation stone for a ₹40 crore refinery.

"The State has emerged as a major paddy producer in the country as groundwater levels improved. The bonus given by the State government as an incentive for producing super fine varieties encouraged farmers to grow more paddy," Telangana Agriculture, Marketing and Co-operation Minister Tummala Nageswara Rao said.

Citing issues with procurement, the Minister felt that farmers should move away from paddy and shift to crops that didn't face challenges, such as pests and diseases, and wild boar and monkey attacks.

With interest in the plantation crop growing, the State govt will inaugurate an oil palm factory with an investment of ₹300 crore in Siddhipet district

"Oil palm fits the bill here. I appeal to farmers to shift to oil palm. In order to encourage more farmers to take up this edible oil crop cultivation, the Union government must take measures to increase the price to ₹25,000 a tonne," the Minister said.

OIL PALM FACTORY

The plant, with an initial processing capacity of 30 tonnes per hour (TPH), can scale up capacity to 120 TPH. The plant will also have a facility to support the Vijaya Hyderabad brand of edible oils.

Stating that the increased prices were quite encouraging, Mahesh Reddy, an oil palm farmer from the undivided Khammam district, hoped that prices will remain high during the upcoming marketing season (May to October).

CHENNAI
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QUICKLY.

CCAvenue, Shiprocket join for faster payments

Mumbai: AvenuesAI's payments brand, CCAvenue, has integrated with Shiprocket Checkout, the companies announced on Tuesday. The partnership aims to give merchants access to a faster, tailored checkout experience for Indian consumers and direct-to-consumer brands. Shiprocket Checkout's merchant partners will gain access to CCAvenue's payment features, including same-day settlements, international payment acceptance, no-cost EMI options and payment links that can be shared via WhatsApp, SMS, Instagram and e-mail. OUR BUREAU

TN Petro halts ops at propylene oxide plant

Chennai: Tamil Nadu Petroproducts has temporarily halted operations at its propylene oxide plant in Manali on Tuesday, following a disruption in the supply of propylene, a key raw material. The company announced to the stock exchanges that the disruption comes amid ongoing geopolitical tensions, with the Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas directing refineries and oil marketing companies to suspend supplies of crude-based petroleum products to downstream industries and prioritise LPG production. OUR BUREAU

India opposes US bid for permanent moratorium on e-comm duty at WTO

GROWTH DISPARITY. Says duty-free regime benefits developed economies, deprives others of revenue

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

The US is pressing for a permanent moratorium or ban on customs duties on electronic transmissions at the upcoming 14th Ministerial Conference (MC14) of the World Trade Organization (WTO) in Cameroon. But India is digging in its heels, calling for a complete rethink of the long-standing moratorium, sources said.

New Delhi has argued that the duty-free regime (first agreed in 1998 and renewed at every Ministerial Conference of the WTO since) has tilted the playing field in favour of a handful of developed economies that dominate digital exports, while depriving developing countries of a growing and potentially significant source of revenue. As a net importer of digital products, India maintains that the fiscal burden of the moratorium falls disproportionately on the Global South.

"India argued its case strongly at a recent WTO discussion dedicated on e-commerce and underlined that the growth of e-commerce or gains from e-commerce should not be conflated with the so-called benefits of the moratorium," a source tracking the matter told *businessline*.

In a draft Ministerial declaration circulated at the WTO recently, Washington demanded not only that the moratorium be made permanent, but that its scope be expanded.

SCOPE OF EXPANSION. The proposal seeks to move beyond the carrier medium to explicitly cover transmitted content, including films, software, and music REUTERS

REVENUE LOSS

The proposal, backed by 18 others, seeks to move beyond the carrier medium (bits and bytes) to explicitly cover transmitted content, including films, software and music.

"Customs duties can be charged on the carrier medium and/or the content (the value of the movie). One estimate is that the content is 80 per cent of the value of a recorded CD . The tariff revenue loss would then be much greater than if the moratorium merely applies to the bits/bytes," Sanya Reid Smith from Third World Network stated. Giving up the right on taxing AI services in the future could compound these losses.

An earlier study by intergovernmental body South Centre estimated that developing countries and LDCs together lost around $56 billion between 2017 and 2020 in revenues due to the moratorium which has been extended continuously every two years since 1986.

India alone has lost roughly $500 million annually, and this is believed to have increased with rising digital imports.

Interestingly, while the WTO has historically extended the moratorium on e-commerce tariffs in tandem with the moratorium on the TRIPS non-violation moratorium (preventing disputes where no specific rule was broken), the US has made no mention of it.

The matter is set to take centrestage at the WTO MC14, that will take place March 26-29 in Yaoundé, Cameroon, presenting a critical test for India's negotiators.

'Vehicle scrappage network running at 25% capacity'

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

The country's vehicle scrapping infrastructure is operating at about a quarter of its installed capacity, with 134 authorised facilities capable of dismantling 1.3-1.6 million vehicles annually, but only 2,79,792 vehicles have been scrapped so far in FY26, according to data shared by Road Transport and Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari in a written reply to the Rajya Sabha.

"The existing RVSF infrastructure is... sufficient to support the transition towards an organised and environmentally-compliant vehicle scrapping ecosystem," Gadkari said in response to a question on the operational efficiency of scrapping centres.

The data indicate that while capacity has been created, utilisation remains low due to the limited inflow of vehicles into the authorised centres.

"A significant number of vehicle owners prefer annual fitness tests instead of scrapping their ageing vehicles, allowing them to extend operational life," a senior Ministry of Road Transport and Highways official said.

At the current pace of around 2,80,000 vehicles being scrapped annually, it could take over 15 years to clear the backlog, even as another five-six lakh vehicles cross the 15-year threshold every two years, according to analysts.

VEHICLE INFLUX

The gradual rollout of Automated Testing Stations (ATS), meant to identify unfit vehicles and direct them to scrapping facilities, has slowed the pace of scrappage. Industry data suggest actual scrappage remains below 3 per cent of the eligible vehicles, pointing to deeper structural issues.

"There is a clear mismatch between scrap value and resale value... the resale value of an ageing M&HCV is often in multiples of scrap value, which discourages scrappage," said Hemal Thakkar, Director, Crisil Intelligence.

"The lack of sufficient incentives to persuade vehicle owners to scrap their older vehicles remains a key bottleneck," said Kinjal Shah, Senior Vice-President & Co-Group Head, Corporate Ratings, ICRA.

SYSTEM GAPS

The dominance of the informal recycling ecosystem continues to undercut authorised facilities.

"From the customer's point of view, it is easier and more beneficial to sell the vehicle to a second-hand dealer," said Anurag Singh, Managing Director at Primus Partners.

Experts stated that improving liquidity and ease of transactions will be critical. Suggested measures include direct cash incentives, digital and time-bound payouts, market-linked scrap pricing, integration with OEM exchange programmes and stricter enforcement against unauthorised recycling.

Industry observers said the core issue is not infrastructure capacity, but the limited inflow of end-of-life vehicles into the formal scrappage ecosystem, a gap likely to persist unless scrappage becomes financially viable.

Garment exports slip in Feb amid weak demand

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Ready-Made Garment (RMG) export sector declined 8.6 per cent in February 2026 to $1.40 billion as against $1.53 billion in February 2025.

However, the cumulative exports for the period April 2025 to February 2026 stood at $14.53 billion, up from $14.46 billion, reflecting a marginal growth of 0.51 per cent, said A Sakthivel, Chairman, Apparel Export Promotion Council (AEPC), in a press release.

GLOBAL TENSIONS

The RMG sector continues to demonstrate resilience despite persistent global economic uncertainties and supply chain disruptions.

The sector has been navigating multiple external challenges, including subdued demand in key markets, he added.

Sakthivel said geopolitical tensions and economic uncertainties had impacted order flows, particularly from major markets, such as the US and parts of West Asia. These developments had resulted in cautious sourcing patterns among global buyers.

"Going forward, the elevated freight rates and the increased cost of inputs have started placing additional pressure on exporters, affecting overall margins and operational planning for manufacturers and exporters across the value chain," he said.

Despite these headwinds, the Chairman of the AEPC expressed confidence in the long-term strength of India's apparel sector, emphasising that the industry continues to adapt through market diversification, product innovation and improved supply chain efficiencies.

He reiterated the industry's commitment to strengthening India's position as a reliable global sourcing destination for apparel.

LOOKING AHEAD. Industry leaders cite subdued demand, rising freight costs and higher input prices as key challenges, while expressing confidence in long-term growth through diversification and innovation

Cumulative exports for April 2025 to Feb 2026 reflected a marginal growth of 0.51 per cent

More GCCs dole out stocks to secure top talent

Rohan Das
Chennai

As global capability centres (GCCs) go on the hunt to secure top-tier talent, there has been an evolution in the compensation structures for senior leaders and management within these organisations.

As per a latest report from GCC consulting firm UnearthIQ, a significant portion of GCCs are now offering long-term incentives such as Employee Stock Ownership Plans (ESOPs), restricted stock units and performance shares as part of their total compensation package.

The report, based on MCA filings and interviews with top GCC executives, stated that around 55-65 per cent of large GCCs (parent business of revenue over $5 billion) are now offering ESOP-equity related payouts as part of their total compensation.

WIN-WIN FOR ALL. From an employee perspective, equity compensation can be more tax efficient compared to full cash payouts

The share is slightly lower for mid-market ($2-5 billion) and Nano GCCs (sub-$1 billion) with 45-55 per cent and 30-34 per cent of such firms offering these benefits.

It added that such benefits often play a big role in inflated reported compensations and high salary packages with stock payouts contributing to about 10–20 per cent of the median CTC.

Overall, the report found that the compensation for leaders in large GCCs are in the range of $0.5-1 million, while for mid market and nano GCCs, they are in the range of $0.25-0.62 million and $0.16-0.25 million respectively.

RETAIN TALENT

According to Aditya Narayan Mishra, Managing Director and CEO of HR firm CIEL HR, the increase in stock-linked payouts is primarily driven by the demand to retain top-tier talent.

"With the number of GCCs increasing, there is a pressure to secure and keep the best talent. To redeem these options, employees will have to stay with the company for a fixed period of time. So, people who are trying to leave in one-and-a-half years will stay for at least two years," he said.

Moreover, he added, such structures help firms in managing upfront costs by splitting compensation into fixed pay and stock-linked incentives reducing immediate cash outflow while deferring part of employee costs into the future.

From the perspective of an employee, equity compensation can be more tax efficient compared to full cash payouts.

Around 55-65 per cent of large GCCs are now offering ESOP-equity related payouts as part of their total compensation

L Catterton doubling down on India with a larger fund, bets big on the consumer story

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Consumer-focused investment firm L Catterton, which is in the process of raising its first India-focused fund and deploying the proceeds, is doubling down on India with the prospects of a larger fund in the future.

Of the $400-million target corpus, the private equity firm has already raised $200 million and deployed roughly half of that.

The remainder will be raised over the next year-and-a-half, with the option to raise an additional $200 million.

So far, it has invested in snacks brands Farmley and Haldiram's and healthcare firm Healing Hands Clinic. The investments have been, on an average, made at 20-40 per cent discount to comparable transactions, said L Catterton India's Partner and Co-Head Vikram Kumaraswamy.

REGISTERING GROWTH. India portfolio companies' revenue have increased on average by around 25 per cent while EBITDA margins expanded by 600 bps over the past year

FAVOURABLE DEALS

He pointed out that its investments were proprietary deals, either from the founder or from a relatively early stage of a formal company-led or intermediary-brokered fundraising process to help it get deals on favourable terms.

L Catterton's proposition was not just bringing in capital, but also building up the capabilities of the investee companies, said Sanjiv Mehta, Executive Chairman of L Catterton India. "India is going to be the largest consumer story for many years to come," he added.

Drools, a pet food brand in which it has invested previously through its Asia fund, has reached a stage where it could go public, while Haldiram's was also on the way for a public listing, said Kumaraswamy, though he declined to give specific timelines for this. Sales to strategic investors have been a preferable exit option for the firm globally.

The India portfolio companies' revenues have increased on an average by around 25 per cent and while EBITDA margins expanded by 600 bps over the past year.

The firm has also invested in Jio Platforms, holding around 0.4 per cent stake, and is learnt to be exploring the option of offloading its stake in Jio's initial public offer expected later this year.

Venture Catalysts fully cashes out from Pee Safe

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Venture Catalysts, integrated incubator and early-stage investment platform, has announced that it has taken full exit from Pee Safe, following the women's hygiene and wellness brand's recent $32-million funding led by global healthcare-focused private equity firm OrbiMed.

The secondary component of the round enabled liquidity for select early investors, including Venture Catalysts, converting long-term value creation into cash returns.

In June 2017, Pee Safe had raised pre-series capital that included Venture Catalysts, highlighting the firm's focus on founders with clarity of mission and speed of execution. At the time of investment, organised women's hygiene innovation was still nascent in India, reflecting Venture Catalysts' ability to spot underserved consumer categories ahead of mainstream investor attention.

INVESTED CAPITAL

The exit was completed in January 2026, generating a 9.60 multiple on invested capital and an XIRR of 30.53 per cent for the fund and its limited partners.

The OrbiMed led round brings Pee Safe's total funding to $45.55 million, with investors including Zerodha and Natco Pharma continuing to be part of the company's investor base. The company plans to use the capital to expand offline retail presence, strengthen brand-led marketing and deepen reach across quick commerce and major online marketplaces.

With Imperial Blue buy, Tilaknagar Industries now a pan-India spirits player; whisky forms 70% of portfolio

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

The acquisition of Imperial Blue has transformed Tilaknagar Industries into a pan-India spirits player, with whisky now accounting for nearly 70 per cent of its portfolio and reducing its dependence on the southern markets from about 90 per cent to 50-60 per cent.

"Our whisky portfolio will help expand our market presence nationwide and with our penetration into the North. With Imperial Blue, Tilaknagar is now present in most retail stores across the country," said Sanaya Dahanukar, Marketing Manager, Tilaknagar Industries.

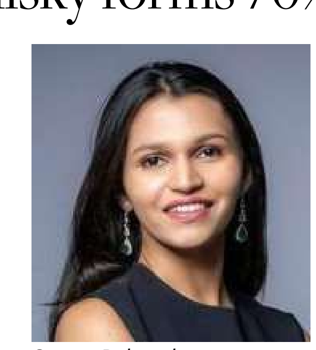
In December 2025, Tilaknagar completed the acquisition of the Imperial Blue business division from Pernod Ricard India via a slump sale for a lump-sum consideration of ₹3,442 crore.

With the acquisition, the company's dependence on its brandy portfolio has reduced from about 90 per cent to 30 per cent.

"While we remained a brandy-first company for a long time, we eventually decided that a meaningful presence in whisky was essential. With the company in a strong position, the opportunity to acquire Imperial Blue came at the right time and proved to be a game changer," Dahanukar said.

TWEAKING TACTICS

She added that Tilaknagar did not plan to divert attention from brandy to whisky; instead, it intends to use its expanded presence to introduce brandy in newer regions and broaden the category's footprint across the country.



Sanaya Dahanukar, Marketing Manager, Tilaknagar Industries

"Over the last 5-10 years, we've noticed that the brandy-consuming population is ageing, leading us to recognise that this category requires improvement to maintain its relevance. While there are no concerns in current consumption patterns, other categories, like whisky, will see more activity. Most other alcohol players are not investing in brandy because their presence in the category is mostly tactical," Dahanukar said.

To keep the category relevant, Tilaknagar has introduced innovations such as Mansion House Flandy, a flavoured variant to attract younger consumers. The company is also tapping into the premiumisation trend by building a price ladder within brandy through offerings such as Courrier Napoleon, Mansion House Chambers and Monarch Legacy Edition, to bring greater aspiration and premium appeal to the category.

Going forward, the company expects both whisky and brandy portfolios to deliver double-digit growth.

Amara Raja Design develops power conditioning cabinet for naval sonar systems

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Amara Raja Design Alpha (ARDA), a specialised engineering R&D firm and part of the Amara Raja Group, has developed an indigenous power conditioning cabinet (PCC) for naval sonar systems, marking the company's first deliverable in mission-critical defence electronics.

Suresh Nair, MD, ARDA, said on Tuesday, "This development reflects our commitment to building deep, long-term capability in strategic-ally-important technologies alongside India's defence research institutions."

About 61 per cent of the system's components will be indigenous, enabling around 40 per cent cost efficiencies through advanced power engineering and local manufacturing.

About 61% of the system's components will be indigenous

HIGH POWER QUALITY

The PCC will support loads of up to 160 kW, delivering stable, high-reliability power distribution for sonar systems, where the acoustic detection equipment requires extremely-high power quality during sustained maritime operations.

ARDA operates from Infopark, Kochi, the city that is home to the DRDO's Naval Physical and Oceanographic Laboratory.

QUICKLY.

Malabar Gold charts ₹1,580-cr retail expansion

Kochi: Malabar Gold & Diamonds has announced a major retail expansion with the launch of 20 showrooms before March 31 at a total investment of ₹1,580 crore. According to the company, the expansion is one of the fastest showroom rollout initiatives in the sector. It will take the total global showroom count to 445 across 14 countries, with a presence in 22 States and UTs. It is expected to generate over 725 jobs. OUR BUREAU

Ramping up domestic LPG production: Sitharaman

New Delhi: Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said the domestic production of LPG is being ramped up to ensure supply to households amid the West Asia crisis. Replying to a debate on the second batch of supplementary demands for grants in the Rajya Sabha, she also said the country had enough fertilizer for kharif crops, and global bidding to procure nutrients for the next rabi season will start soon. PTI

Biz hit as migrants head home due to LPG crisis, polls

BEARING THE BRUNT. Manufacturing sector is in no hurry to get the workers back due to weak export demand and fewer orders

TE Raja Simhan
Chennai

With almost a week gone by since the LPG crisis hit industries, the hospitality, medium-sized industrial units and logistics sectors are now staring at a labour crisis with migrant workers either returning home or not in a hurry to get back to work.

Migrants from Assam and West Bengal working in Tamil Nadu were planning to go home to cast their votes in April, but some of them have left early for their hometowns as they are not able to manage their food outside homes, said an official at a restaurant in Chennai. It will take a month for them to return, he added.

Some restaurants and eateries that are heavily dependent on migrant labour for jobs of chefs and waiters have also borne the brunt.

A restaurant manager in Chennai said seven of his migrant employees went home last Sunday, though he expects them to come back soon.

POLLING ISSUE

The trend is also pronounced in Kerala, where the LPG shortage coincided with seasonal factors.

Officials noted that nearly half of Kerala's migrant workforce hails from the poll-bound States, making such movement typical during election cycles. This year, however, the LPG shortage appears to have hastened departures.

Joel K Jose, General Manager of a four-star hotel near Infopark, said about 20 per cent of the migrant workforce left for their home States, including Odisha, Uttar Pradesh, Assam and West Bengal. Many have indicated they will return after April 20, once polling concludes.

In Kochi, for instance, closure of eateries and fuel shortage have triggered early departure of migrant workers, further accelerated by the ongoing Ramadan period and the upcoming Assembly elections in Assam and West Bengal.

EMPTY TANK. A restaurant at Fort in Mumbai closed due to the cooking gas shortage PTI

HARVESTING HIT

Baby John, President of the Pineapple Growers Association Keralam, said labour shortages had disrupted harvesting activities as the sector relies heavily on migrant workers. While such workers usually return during summer, they are now expected only by mid-June.

In Bengaluru too, restaurant managers report difficulties in procuring LPG cylinders, leading to a reduction in workforce. One restaurant in Basavanagudi has already seen over 20 workers leave, while another in Banashankari has cut staff strength from 50 to 20. Alternative fuels like firewood are seen as unreliable.

ORDERS DOWN

An auto component manufacturer in Coimbatore said some migrant workers who left for Holi had not yet returned, but the company had also not pressed for their return amid weak export demand and fewer orders.

In Maharashtra's industrial hubs, rising food costs, exacerbated by LPG shortages, are pushing migrant workers to return home. Prices of staples like 'vada pav' have risen sharply, while portion sizes in canteens and roadside stalls have shrunk, making urban survival increasingly difficult for contract labour.

The impact is also spreading to the transport sector, raising concerns of supply chain disruption.

"We are losing drivers big time," said Bal Malkit Singh, Advisor and former President of the All India Motor Transport Congress (AIMTC). "Vehicle movement has declined by up to 50 per cent in some segments, and could fall further to 70–80 if the situation persists." The Amazon India Workers Union, in a statement on Tuesday, said rising cooking gas prices and stagnant wages were pushing workers towards severe financial stress, and workers were unable to access LPG connections and forced to rely on open-market gas sold at sharply higher rates.

KILNS DOWN

On the other hand, production stoppage in gas-dependent sectors is also rendering migrant workers jobless.

More than 430 ceramic units in Gujarat's Morbi cluster, which had already shut operations due to gas shortages, on Tuesday decided to remain closed for another 15–20 days till supply resumes and the situation stabilises, pushing a large number of migrant workers out of work, as the fuel crisis deepens in one of the world's largest tile manufacturing hubs.

With inputs from V Sajeev Kumar in Kochi, Amit Vijay Mohile in Mumbai, Avinash Nair in Ahmedabad and Aishwarya Kumar in Bengaluru

'One phone call from the PM and Iran let LPG vessels pass'

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Union Agriculture and Rural Development Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan on Tuesday told the Rajya Sabha that the recent arrival of two Indian-flagged LPG tankers after passing through the closed, war-hit Strait of Hormuz in the Gulf was possible due to the intervention of Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

After finishing his speech on the discussion related to the Rural Development Ministry, Chouhan went on to add: "The entire world is watching, now that the crisis has come — no gas tanker is allowed, no ships are permitted. One phone call from the Prime Minister, and Iran said, take it (through Hormuz) with the Indian flag, no one will stop."

He also said that earlier, Ukraine and Russia had paused the war to allow Indian students' safe return after Modi had made phone calls to both countries and requested safe passage for them.

Chouhan said that the Opposition's protest against the newly enacted Viksit Bharat-G RAM G law had failed to garner any public support as people had accepted it as a better scheme than the previous MGNREGA.

He accused the Congress of disregarding the principles of Mahatma Gandhi and changing the name of the scheme from National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (NREGA) to Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA) only for votes.


Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan addressing the Rajya Sabha in New Delhi on Tuesday ANI

LEGENDS IGNORED

He further claimed that during the Congress regime, 600 government schemes were started in the name of Jawaharlal Nehru, Indira Gandhi and Rajiv Gandhi.

But leaders like Shaheed Bhagat Singh, Chandra Shekhar Azad, Rani Lakshmi Bai and Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel were ignored.

According to Chouhan, except for Karnataka, States ruled by Opposition parties, such as Jharkhand, Kerala, Punjab, Jammu and Kashmir, and Himachal Pradesh, had made budgetary provisions for implementing the VB-G RAM G scheme. "From 2006-07 to 2013-14, the UPA government spent ₹2.12 lakh crore, while the Narendra Modi government has spent ₹8.58 lakh crore," he said, adding that the current government had allocated more funds to the States compared to the UPA.

Issues like misuse of funds, fake vouchers and fake bills were taken into account while making the VB-G RAM G and provisions had been made to prevent such misuse, as 11 lakh complaints were reported under MGNREGA, he said.

Kerala Assembly polls: Congress names first list of candidates

Press Trust of India
New Delhi/Thiruvananthapuram

The Congress on Tuesday released its first list of candidates for the upcoming Kerala Assembly elections, announcing nominees in 55 of the 92 seats it is contesting.

Key seats such as Aranmula and Chengannur have not been included in the first list. Kannur and Konni also remain undecided, keeping suspense over the possible entry of MPs into the Assembly fray.

Senior Congress leaders K Sudhakaran and Adoor Prakash were reported to be considering entering the fray, but candidates have not been announced in Kannur and Konni, the constituencies linked to them.

One of the notable aspects of the list is the exclusion of Perumbavoor MLA Eldose Kunnappilly, making him the only sitting legislator left out in the first phase.

Leader of the Opposition VD Satheesan has been renominated from Paravur, while senior leader Ramesh Chennithala will contest from Haripad. In Kannur district, KPCC chief Sunny Joseph has been fielded from Peravoor. Senior leader K Muraleedharan will contest from Vattiyoorkavu in Thiruvananthapuram district, while former MP TN Prathapan has been nominated from Manalur.

Youth Congress State president OJ Janeesh has been fielded from Kodungallur.

Actor Ramesh Pisharody has been fielded from Palakkad. Several sitting MLAs have been renominated, including Thiruvanchoor Radhakrishnan (Kottayam), Anwar Sadath (Aluva) and Roji M John (Angamaly). In Puthuppally, Chandy Oommen has been renominated.

Among women candidates, Uma Thomas (Thrikkakara), Shanimol Usman (Aroor), Bindhu Krishna (Kollam) and Ramya Haridas (Chirayinkeezhu-SC) have been included.

Kashmir sees early signs of tourism revival as tulip and almond gardens draw crowds

Gulzar Bhat
Srinagar

With the opening of the Indira Gandhi Memorial Tulip Garden and the Badamwari Garden, early signs of revival are emerging in Srinagar's tourism sector, with stakeholders hoping the spring season will mark a turnaround after last year's disruption following the Pahalgam terror attack.

According to official figures, 4,229 visitors came to the tulip garden on its opening day on Monday.

"The figure is based on physical ticketing. Many visitors also booked their tickets online," a Floriculture Department official said, adding that by 2 pm on Tuesday, more than 3,700 people, including 14 foreign tourists, had visited the garden.

Official data also showed that over 6,000 people had visited Badamwari to witness the almond blossoms since it opened on March 14.


LEISURE TIME. Tourists at the Badamwari Garden in Srinagar IMRAN NISSAR

Director of Floriculture, Kashmir, Mathoora Masoom said that the department had not anticipated such an overwhelming response on the first day of the tulip garden's opening.

"We are looking forward to a steady rise in tourist footfalls in the coming weeks," she added.

Chief Minister Omar Abdullah inaugurated Asia's largest tulip garden on Monday. He expressed the hope that the spring season would breathe new life into the tourism sector and those associated with it.

FRESH OPTIMISM

Last year's terror attack at Pahalgam, which left 26 people dead, had derailed the Valley's tourist season. "The reopening of gardens has infused fresh optimism among tourism stakeholders, with early trends indicating a strong start to the season," said Qazi Tauseef, spokesperson of the Kashmir Economic Alliance.

He said spring tourism traditionally sets the tone for the entire year, and early positive trends could translate into sustained momentum in the coming months. "Advance bookings and increased tourist inquiries at key destinations point towards a promising spring," he added.

Hoteliers and tour operators in Srinagar said weekend occupancy levels were already improving, with a noticeable rise in enquiries for April and May. Taxi operators and tourist guides also reported increased demand, particularly for visits to the tulip garden and other nearby attractions.

TMC announces list of candidates for Bengal elections, says it will contest 291 of 294 seats

Our Bureau
Kolkata

The ruling Trinamool Congress in West Bengal on Tuesday announced its list of candidates for the Assembly elections, declaring that the party will contest 291 of the 294 seats in the State.

Trinamool Congress supremo and Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee will contest from the Bhabanipur seat in south Kolkata, setting the stage for a direct contest with BJP leader and Leader of the Opposition Suvendu Adhikari.

In the 2021 Assembly polls, Adhikari defeated Banerjee from the Nandigram constituency in West Bengal's Purba Medinipur district. Following her defeat, Banerjee re-entered the Assembly after a byelection in Bhabanipur.

"We will contest 291 of the total 294 seats. The remaining three seats will be contested by our ally Anit Thapa-led Bharatiya Gorkha Prajatantrik Morcha (BGPM) in the Darjeeling hills," Banerjee said during a media conference.


POLL BUGLE. West Bengal CM and Trinamool Congress supremo Mamata Banerjee and the party's national general secretary Abhishek Banerjee at a media conference JAYANTA SHAW

She expressed confidence that the Trinamool Congress would retain power with a comfortable majority in the 2026 Assembly elections.

Banerjee predicted that her party would secure more than 226 seats in the election. "We will win more than 226 seats in the 2026 Assembly polls," she said.

Notably, in the last Assembly elections in Bengal, Trinamool Congress secured 215 seats, while the BJP was able to capture 77 seats.

'FOCUS ON ALL SEATS'

Asked about the challenge Adhikari will pose to her in the Bhabanipur constituency, Banerjee said, "We are going to win from the Bhabanipur Assembly constituency with the maximum number of votes. Our focus is on all 294 Assembly constituencies."

Months before the announcement of the schedule, Adhikari said he would contest from Bhabanipur and defeat Banerjee again.

In West Bengal, voting will be conducted in two phases on April 23 and April 29. The first phase will cover 152 Assembly constituencies, and the second phase will cover 142 constituencies.

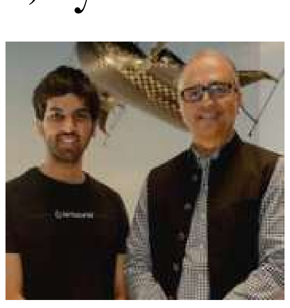
The BJP on Monday released its first list of 144 candidates for the Assembly elections, and the Left Front also declared its first list of 192 candidates.

Narayana Health expands drone pact with Airbound, eyes 50% cut in lab costs

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

Narayana Health and drone manufacturer Airbound have completed a medical logistics pilot using drones in Bengaluru. The collaboration is being positioned as part of a broader cost-efficiency and scale strategy.

Narayana Health Founder and Chairman Devi Prasad Shetty said centralising diagnostics, enabled by drone transport, could reduce lab testing costs by up to 50 per cent by improving throughput and automation. "When you do 25,000 tests in one lab, most of it automated, the cost per test drops dramatically. The cost benefit will be huge, and it will keep going down as volumes increase," he said.


Naman Pushp, Founder and CEO, Airbound, (left) with Devi Prasad Shetty, Founder & Chairman, Narayana Health

"The hospitals we are building will function as collection centres linked to central labs. Centralising laboratories and blood banks presents a massive opportunity to lower the cost of diagnostics," he said.

NETWORK EXPANSION

The partnership will be expanded across five hospitals coming up in Banashankari, Bannerghatta, Electronic City, HSR Layout and New Town (Kolkata) as the company scales its hub-and-spoke model.

Running since January 2026, the 4 km aerial route is completed in about 10 minutes, compared to significantly longer road transfers dependent on Bengaluru's traffic conditions.

The pilot logged over 700 flights over 54 days, carrying up to 40 diagnostic samples per trip without any failed deliveries.

Airbound is also looking beyond healthcare, with plans to expand into e-commerce and quick commerce logistics.

The company currently manufactures about one drone per day at its Hoskote facility and is preparing to scale up production to support wider deployment.

LPG stocks to last for 15 days, says AP CM Naidu

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Andhra Pradesh has a stock of 14,000 tonnes of liquefied petroleum gas adequate for the next 15 days, said Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu.

At a review meeting on the availability of LPG with representatives of petroleum companies in Amaravati on Tuesday, the Chief Minister said the State would be receiving more LPG soon to meet its requirements, and there is no immediate shortage of cooking gas.

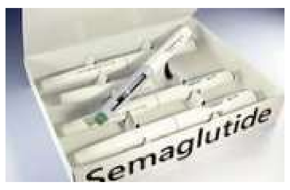
He directed the officials to ensure uninterrupted supply of gas to hospitals, hostels, educational institutions and temples while asking them to explore the feasibility of providing other alternatives for the needy to meet energy requirements in view of the continued pressure on LPG stocks. Steps should also be taken to ensure adequate supply of induction stoves in the market, Naidu added.

The Chief Minister instructed officials to prevent hoarding and black market sale of LPG by adopting technology-based modalities, including QR code and OTP-based delivery of gas cylinders, according to a release.

CHENNAI
businessline.
WEDNESDAY - MARCH 18 - 2026

QUICKLY.

Zydus, Lupin tie up for new Semaglutide injection



Ahmedabad: Zydus Lifesciences has partnered with Lupin Limited to co-market its Semaglutide Injection, aimed at adults with type 2 diabetes mellitus. Under the agreement, Zydus will market the therapy under the brands Semaglyntm, Mashematm and Altermetm, while Lupin will promote it as Semanext and Livarise. The injection comes in a 15 mg/3 ml formulation with a reusable pen device, designed to simplify administration. Lupin will pay Zydus upfront licensing fees along with milestone-based payments tied to pre-defined targets, the company said on Tuesday. Sharvil Patel, MD, of Zydus Lifesciences, said, "The innovative pen device is designed to make therapy simpler and improve quality of life. Partnering with Lupin allows us to broaden access and expand reach across India." OUR BUREAU

Air India restores all 30 legacy aircraft grounded since takeover

OPERATIONAL PUSH. Return of Boeing 777-300ER VT-ALL completes post-privatisation fleet revival programme

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

The Tata Group-promoted Air India has brought back into service all 30 previously-grounded aircraft inherited at the time of its privatisation, raising its current fleet strength to 186 aircraft, industry sources told *businessline*.

With the return to service of Boeing 777-300ER VT-ALL, all the long-grounded aircraft, 19 narrow body and 11 wide body, have been restored and joined the fleet.

Sources said the development marked a significant milestone in Air India's transformation journey.

LONG-GROUNDED

At the time of privatisation, Air India had inherited a total of around 110 legacy aircraft of which as many as 30 were long-grounded.

Notably, the VT-ALL will now go for a comprehensive $400 million retrofit programme from 2027.

STRENGTHENING SERVICES. Post-privatisation, Air India committed resources to revive each of these aircraft as part of its broader operational restoration programme

Sources said at the time of Air India's return to the Tata Group in 2022, rebuilding the fleet and restoring operational capability were identified as a "key priority".

Post-privatisation, Air India committed resources to revive each of these aircraft as part of its broader operational restoration programme. When contacted, Air India's Chief Operations Officer, Captain Basil Kwauk, acknowledged the development stating that that Boeing 777-300ER VT-ALL, is back into service.

BACK INTO SERVICE

"It is the last of the 30 grounded aircraft and bringing this aircraft back into service basically delivers a promise, that we once said that we will bring all grounded aircraft back and today Air India delivers," he told *businessline*.

VT-ALL had remained grounded since February 2020 due to multiple unserviceable systems, ageing components and non-availability of key components and spares.

In April 2025, Air India initiated restoration work to bring this aircraft back into operational service in support of its long-haul network expansion. The aircraft entered the MRO facility in Nagpur for the nose-to-tail overhaul in May 2025, where it underwent an extensive restoration programme.

It is learnt that more than 3,000 key components were installed during the process, along with completion of over 4,000 maintenance tasks. These included around 80 mandated modifications, among them the Longeron Modification, which involves a major structural reinforcement of the aircraft.

Additionally, major assemblies were replaced, including engines, the auxiliary power unit, inlet and fan cowls and thrust reverser cowls. Both the left and right engines were replaced as part of the restoration.

Besides, the aircraft underwent comprehensive systems rebuild covering air-conditioning, landing gear, hydraulics, oxygen systems, avionics and engine systems.

Furthermore, each repair and modification was carried out under regulatory oversight by the Directorate General of Civil Aviation, with technical guidance from Boeing.

VALIDATION PHASE

The airline said that the aircraft has now completed its validation phase, which included system checks under operational conditions, detailed inspections and test flights. Meanwhile, VT-ALL has received the Airworthiness Review Certificate, a mandatory certification confirming that the aircraft meets the safety parameters required to commence regular operations.

Air India, Swiss to operate extra flights as war rages

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Air India and Swiss are adding extra flights from Delhi to facilitate passengers impacted by ongoing West Asia conflict.

While Swiss is operating a second daily flight between Zurich-Delhi from March 19-23, Air India will offer 36 extra services to London (from Delhi and Mumbai), Frankfurt, Zurich and Toronto from March 19-28.

CAPACITY BOOST

"Together these flights will add 10,012 seats on five routes boosting capacity and providing more choice to travellers when travel options are limited," Air India said.

Swiss said it is responding to current high demand for flights between India and Europe.

"International air traffic in West Asia remains severely restricted. Many travellers are having to change their original travel plans and are looking for alternative routes back to Europe or onward to Asia.

Swiss said it is responding to current high demand for flights between India and Europe

Consequently, demand is currently high for the existing Swiss connections between Delhi and Zurich, which are already largely fully booked," the airline said on Tuesday.

Over two lakh passengers have travelled to India from West Asia with partial resumption of flights.

Scheduled flights are being operated to Muscat and Jeddah.

Indian carriers have been forced to cancel planned operations to Dubai following the local government's decision to suspend flight permissions of foreign carriers. Emirates and flydubai, however, continue to operate flights to India.

India needs clear foreign policy roadmap: Parliamentary panel

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Ministry of External Affairs must, on a priority basis, formulate a comprehensive formal document articulating the country's foreign policy objectives and goals in the medium term and make it publicly available, a Parliamentary Committee on External Affairs has suggested.

"The committee is of the considered view that the absence of a formal, publicly available foreign policy document is a significant gap for a country of India's global stature, ambitions and expanding international engagement," according to the recommendations of the 'Twelfth report of the committee on External Affairs (2025-26) on demands for grants (2026-27)' of the MEA presented in Parliament on Tuesday.

FOREIGN POLICY

The committee noted that 36 countries, ranging from major powers like the US, the UK, Germany, Japan and Russia to smaller nations such as Estonia, New Zealand, Slovenia and Bhutan, already publish formal foreign policy or national security strategy documents.

> **The panel is of the view that the** absence of a formal foreign policy document is a significant gap for India's global ambitions

These publications consolidate international objectives, priorities, and strategic approaches into a single, accessible volume.

The MEA does issue its annual report, which is comprehensive and valuable as a record of the previous year's diplomatic activities, but it is inherently a retrospective document, it said.

"It is not a forward-looking strategic document that articulates where India seeks to go in the world, what its priorities are, and how it intends to pursue them over the medium to long term," the report stated.

SEEKS CLARITY

Since the Ministry has acknowledged that there are no obstacles to preparing such a document, the committee would like to understand why it has not been prepared to date, particularly given India's growing global profile and its active engagement across bilateral, regional, and multilateral platforms.

"The committee, therefore, strongly recommend that the Ministry... take up on priority the preparation of a formal Indian foreign policy document — a publicly available, medium-term strategic document that clearly articulates India's foreign policy objectives, regional and global priorities, key bilateral and multilateral engagements, and the guiding principles of India's approach to the world," it said.

It also asked the MEA to define a timeline for completing this exercise.

Yotta to deploy 5,000 Gorilla Tech GPUs for AI workload

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Yotta Data Services has signed a binding agreement with Gorilla Technology Group Inc, a London-based global intelligence solution provider, to deploy approximately 640 high-performance Nvidia HGX B200 servers with more than 5,000 GPUs for AI workloads.

Gorilla will provide the GPU infrastructure under a long-duration commercial model, while Yotta will implement and operate the same at its Navi Mumbai data centre and deliver AI compute services, including hyperscale GPU clusters, bare-metal GPUs, virtual machines, AI lab workstations, serverless GPUs and AI model end-points, to enterprises and government customers. "We see this collaboration as an important step in scaling AI capacity in India. In Gorilla, we see a long-term infrastructure partner, who will help us realise the vision of enabling large scale GPU deployment in India over the next three years to meet the AI needs of India, APAC, West Asia as well as the Global South," said Sunil Gupta, Co-Founder & CEO of Yotta.

ADDITIONAL SERVERS

Gorilla and Yotta are also exploring a broader deployment pathway of more than 5,000 additional servers, over the next year or so.

This collaboration aims to support India's growing AI infrastructure demand, creating opportunities for wider strategic cooperation, including potential data centre development initiatives in Thailand. For now, the agreements establish Gorilla as a key infrastructure partner to Yotta, supporting high-performance AI compute deployments.

REVENUE TARGET

Based on the executed agreements, Gorilla expects this deployment to contribute $500 million in its revenue over the next five years.

For Gorilla, this is an opportunity to be part of India's sovereign AI buildout through Yotta, which has publicly committed 9,216 advanced GPUs to that effort.

"By signing up with Yotta, we are placing Gorilla directly in India's AI infrastructure buildout with a partner that brings scale, credibility and execution," said Jay Chandan, Chairman & CEO of Gorilla Technology.

Health tech firm Oura marks debut with smart ring

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Finnish health-tech company OURA has entered India with the launch of its Oura Ring 4 — a smart ring that tracks over 50 health and wellness indicators, the company said. The product will be available from tomorrow through Croma stores and Amazon, it added.

The wearable Oura Ring 4 translates health data into personalised insights through the Oura App (iOS and Android).

The product is made from lightweight titanium and it would be in 12 sizes (4-15) and six colours.

The product is priced ₹28,900 (silver and black) and ₹39,900 (stealth, brushed silver, gold, and rose gold), and its monthly membership fee is ₹599.

'Graduate unemployment alarmingly high'

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

Persistently high levels of graduate unemployment among young people — nearly 40 per cent for those aged 15-25 and about 20 per cent for the 25-29 age group — have been flagged in a report released by Azim Premji University on Tuesday. It also noted that only a small proportion of graduates are able to secure stable salaried employment within a year of completing their studies.

The 'State of Working India 2026' report presents a concerning outlook on youth employment on the basis of, what it said, official databases spanning four decades to examine how youth participation in education and employment has evolved.

"Youth unemployment rates are significantly higher than overall unemployment rates globally, but in India,

this gap is particularly pronounced. While this pattern reflects common labour market frictions faced by new entrants, it also signals deeper constraints in labour demand," the report observes.

PROBABLE IMBALANCE

The report calls for accelerated job creation, noting that India's share of the working-age population — estimated at about 263 million when those in education are excluded from the overall youth population of 367 million — is projected to begin declining after 2030. It argues that this makes it imperative to act now, as sustained employment growth will be critical to ensuring that the country's demographic dividend translates into long-term economic gains.

The youth population, defined as those aged 15 to 29, is the largest in the world.

POST-COVID BOOM

While adequate numbers of salaried jobs have not been created, there have been some gains.

In the post-Covid period, India's employed population increased from 490 million to 572 million, with employment rates rising from 71 to 74 per cent for men and from 26 to 34 per cent for women between 2021–22 and 2023–24.

However, the report highlights that a majority of the employment growth has been in agriculture. "Of the 83 million jobs added between 2021-22 and 2023-24, 40 million have been in agriculture, with women accounting for a large share (38 million)," it noted.

AMBITIOUS FUTURE

While employment challenges persist, educational enrolment has risen sharply over the past four decades. Among men aged 15-19, enrolment increased from 49 per cent in 1983-84 to 73 per cent in 2023-24. For women, the rise has been sharper, from 38 per cent in 1983 to 68 per cent in 2023.

Suggesting policy priorities, the report pitches for the expansion of salaried employment opportunities to match the capabilities of a highly-educated workforce. It adds that the exact number of jobs required will depend on assumptions about the future structure of the market.

Rapidly developing Naidupeta emerges as a key industrial node in southern AP

The region is attracting marquee investments and social infrastructure for a growing industrial workforce

G Naga Sridhar
Tirupati

In a striking turnaround, the Andhra Pradesh Industrial Infrastructure Corporation (APIIC) Special Economic Zone (SEZ) at Naidupeta in Tirupati district has sprung back to life, catalysing both industrial expansion and a quiet but significant rural economic shift.

After remaining largely inactive for over five years, the SEZ is now a hive of activity, with marquee investments in solar energy, electronics and manufacturing — cleared over the past two years by the Chandrababu Naidu-led NDA government — moving rapidly from blueprint to reality. At the centre of this transformation are four villages — Dwarakapuram, Menakuru, Pallavolu and Attivaram — home to nearly 28,000 people. For residents, the impact is already visible.

"Projects under construction and those nearing completion have boosted our incomes," said S Gurunatham of Attivaram. "There is a clear rise in demand for rental housing, local transport and jobs. The change in the past year has been substantial."

"It was a surprise for me to find a job near my village itself and many of the local graduates have been able to find employment here," P Vinod of Mekanuru village, a recent graduate said.

TOWNSHIP RISING

Beyond direct employment, the industrial push is triggering a broader ecosystem shift. Companies are investing in worker housing and social infrastructure, signalling a move towards creating a sustainable industrial township model.

ECONOMIC SHIFT. A facility of Premier Energies is coming up at the Naidupeta SEZ in Tirupati district of Andhra Pradesh. With a major part of the work completed in less than 12 months, the facility is set for inauguration in June

Premier Energies, one of the anchor investors, has launched an affordable housing initiative to support workforce needs. Plans are also underway to strengthen access to education, healthcare and essential services — critical to retaining skilled labour in a semi-rural setting.

The SEZ has attracted a mix of manufacturing players, including Premier Energies, Syrma SGS, Websol Energy Systems and Philips Carbon Black, collectively positioning Naidupeta as an emerging industrial node in southern Andhra Pradesh.

Premier Energies' ₹6,000 crore integrated solar manufacturing facility is among the most significant projects. Envisaged with 4-7.4 GW solar cell capacity and 5-6 GW module capacity, the unit is nearing completion in its first phase and is scheduled for commissioning by June 2026.

"We have already hired professionals from colleges in Nellore, Sullurpeta and Tirupati, and recruitment will continue as we scale up," said MN Phaneedra Rao, Project Manager, Premier Energies. Of the planned 2,000 jobs, around 375 skilled positions have already been filled.

Websol Energy Systems is also setting up an 8 GW integrated solar manufacturing facility with an investment of ₹3,538 crore, expected to generate about 200 direct jobs.

The proactive role of the State government has been a driver for new investments in the region.

"The land allotment has been hassle-free and industry-friendly. The investors are favouring Naidupeta in view of the plug and play infrastructure being provided and its proximity to Krishnapatnam Port, Tirupati and Sri City industrial zone," M Abhishikth Kishore, Vice-Chairman and Managing Director, APIIC, said.

STANDOUT FEATURE

Industry officials point to the pace of project rollout as a standout feature. "Our DPR was approved in January 2025, land was allotted in March, and construction began in April. We are on track for commissioning by June 2026," Rao said, describing the timeline as a record in the State's industrial development landscape.

Strides Pharma arm in $12 m deal to acquire Sandoz generics

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Strides Pharma International AG, a step-down subsidiary of Strides Pharma Science Limited, has signed an agreement for the acquisition and in-licensing of a portfolio of branded generic products across Sub-Saharan Africa from Sandoz AG, Switzerland, and its group entities.

The deal involves an initial consideration of $12 million, payable at closing, and will be funded through internal accruals. The firm expects the transaction to be EPS-accretive, supported by profitable branded sales and improved operating leverage.

The agreement spans four key markets — West Africa (covering 10 countries), Ghana, Nigeria and Kenya.

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Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
20 Microns [5]	151.31	153.17	152.50	154.27	150.21	90.79	284.10	146.85	9	153.60
360 One WAM	1022.90	1043.40	1022.90	1045.90	1020.10	433.49	1273.80	790.50	-	-
3i Infotech	12.86	12.72	13.00	13.04	12.70	687.98	27.45	12.68	-	-
3M India	32970.00	33110.00	33200.00	33775.00	32820.00	3.50	38300.00	26800.05	114	33130.80
5PAISA	292.55	291.10	296.00	299.85	289.00	88.85	435.95	289.35	32	290.40
63 MoonsTe [2]	545.70	546.25	548.00	556.00	540.20	77.28	1130.00	538.95	60	546.15
A										
Aadhar Hsg	478.75	480.55	480.00	481.40	470.50	242.68	547.80	399.35	-	-
Aarti Drugs	339.10	334.15	337.10	344.50	332.90	132.18	574.95	312.50	16	334.00
Aarti Ind [5]	425.15	424.95	425.15	428.90	416.40	479.55	494.00	338.20	42	424.85
Aarti Pharm	629.35	644.55	631.30	654.35	631.30	153.07	971.00	574.45	-	-
Aavas	1128.10	1101.60	1133.40	1134.00	1096.00	401.48	2238.35	1095.55	14	1101.60
AB Capital	314.60	318.65	314.60	324.15	313.60	4360.17	369.25	160.70	28	318.70
AB Cotspin	399.55	405.65	395.10	410.00	390.00	34.81	504.00	335.00	-	-
AB InfraBuil	17.01	17.19	17.40	17.72	16.86	3898.42	224.98	16.75	-	-
AB Real Est	1094.90	1121.00	1101.90	1137.30	1084.60	361.62	2537.90	1080.10	-	-
AB Sun Life	952.50	958.20	964.10	994.95	942.65	904.50	1046.55	556.45	-	-
ABB [2]	6218.00	6310.50	6237.50	6337.50	6176.50	297.13	6555.00	4590.05	80	6312.45
ABB Powerpro	24205.00	24710.00	24495.00	24795.00	24180.00	95.15	26325.00	10400.00	-	-
Abbott (I)	26670.00	26450.00	26890.00	26890.00	26290.00	5.18	35921.55	26000.00	37	26464.60
ABFRL	58.49	58.19	58.54	59.10	57.89	4108.52	107.71	57.53	-	58.23
ACC	1373.20	1385.00	1380.00	1391.10	1368.50	247.66	2123.30	1361.00	10	1384.35
ACCELYA	1164.30	1181.20	1160.00	1201.00	1156.00	18.35	1524.55	1135.05	15	1180.45
ACME Solar	244.89	247.01	245.00	251.50	242.40	691.68	324.30	172.63	-	-
Action Cons [2]	817.30	820.90	819.30	832.40	817.30	164.16	1390.00	775.00	22	821.55
Acutaas Chem	2165.00	2302.60	2182.00	2324.30	2170.00	699.14	2553.65	1040.50	-	-
Adani Ent [1]	1978.00	1975.40	1989.90	1990.00	1945.00	1268.99	2612.75	1850.00	98	1975.30
Adani Green	866.95	868.65	874.85	874.85	848.05	2644.90	1179.20	767.00	194	868.95
Adani Ports [2]	1373.90	1365.50	1379.00	1379.00	1351.20	2605.91	1584.00	1041.05	158	1363.50
Adani Pwr [2]	154.06	155.60	156.00	157.44	153.61	41644.73	182.75	94.41	29	155.50
Adani T Gas	522.05	516.85	525.70	533.70	490.00	8611.07	798.00	462.80	-	-
Adani Wilm	172.30	175.01	173.55	178.00	173.06	7193.13	291.20	171.19	-	-
Adani.E.Sol	996.50	1000.60	1008.60	1008.60	972.00	1607.12	1067.70	744.90	-	-
ADF Foods [2]	180.21	179.71	180.50	183.74	177.67	169.36	301.00	168.80	21	180.40
AdityaBirlaL	95.75	97.29	96.40	97.45	94.22	1389.59	175.00	94.22	-	-
AdityaInfote	1588.20	1611.50	1599.00	1644.00	1599.00	174.34	1759.00	1015.00	-	-
AdityaVisi	444.20	447.10	445.00	455.10	436.80	130.68	598.70	327.60	-	-
AdorWelding	941.40	941.70	946.30	966.60	902.00	28.66	1260.00	788.00	-	-
Advait Ener	1506.40	1544.20	1520.60	1578.00	1515.80	24.48	1885.00	1351.00	-	-
Advance Agro	101.49	98.99	102.30	103.01	97.76	420.12	154.00	96.50	-	-
Advent Hotel	157.73	150.16	158.00	160.81	147.55	254.71	345.05	147.55	-	-
Advenzymes [2]	275.45	280.70	275.45	286.00	273.25	110.66	366.55	259.70	26	281.10
Aegis Log [1]	604.10	619.85	606.00	651.00	601.15	5094.86	946.50	586.00	34	620.05
Aegis VopakT	188.95	191.82	189.59	194.60	189.25	378.93	302.00	183.01	-	-
Aequs	115.11	121.85	116.01	123.14	115.53	1824.03	165.40	113.30	-	-
Aeroflex Ind	246.91	251.77	249.50	253.00	244.55	2026.48	253.00	148.01	-	-
AeroflexEnt	65.90	67.31	66.19	68.85	65.68	320.12	113.90	65.31	-	-
Aether Ind	1025.05	1006.20	1039.20	1039.20	1001.50	135.88	1083.60	725.00	-	-
Afcons Infra	278.50	280.60	278.50	282.70	276.00	477.07	498.70	271.50	-	-
Affle [2]	1311.20	1290.40	1307.10	1312.50	1275.50	521.32	2186.80	1221.05	143	1291.15
Afford Robo	156.48	151.59	156.45	158.09	150.35	51.05	534.40	150.35	-	-
Agarwal ind	433.90	431.40	434.95	457.40	425.55	154.83	1099.75	422.20	16	431.35
AGI Greenpac	506.75	511.00	507.00	513.90	494.50	204.44	1009.00	478.20	-	-
AGI Infra	303.75	300.80	305.00	312.15	297.55	1711.80	1408.00	224.70	-	-
Ahluwalia [2]	727.25	722.40	721.05	737.00	719.55	76.47	1129.20	718.00	18	725.25
AIA Engg [2]	3665.60	3736.20	3729.00	3929.00	3710.10	715.85	4200.00	3000.60	27	3736.55
Ajanta Pha [2]	2954.10	3020.60	2980.70	3071.60	2959.00	230.31	3158.20	2022.05	40	3020.95
Ajax Engg	475.05	489.85	475.05	491.40	475.05	75.26	756.20	453.00	-	-
Ajmera [2]	114.16	113.87	115.25	116.47	113.02	228.97	221.23	113.20	20	113.90
AKI India	4.84	4.58	4.82	4.82	4.44	968.67	16.05	4.24	-	-
Aksh Optifib [5]	4.28	4.66	4.37	5.13	4.32	2480.48	12.91	4.11	-	4.74
Akums Drugs	463.70	463.85	462.00	472.00	456.55	148.63	622.95	405.00	-	-
Akzo Ind	2884.70	2895.80	2884.70	2901.90	2850.00	12.25	3909.25	2649.05	35	2893.75
Alankit [1]	7.65	7.56	7.94	7.94	7.45	322.34	18.07	7.36	-	7.58
ALEM PHAR [2]	675.30	670.00	675.75	682.45	665.10	35.05	1107.80	665.10	26	670.50
Alembic Ltd [2]	79.50	79.44	79.61	83.00	78.59	443.14	125.70	78.00	15	79.44
Algoquant Fi	54.80	55.00	54.70	56.12	54.70	1236.25	71.01	49.54	-	-
AlivusLife	925.45	936.10	928.00	942.45	912.60	74.46	1225.10	819.00	-	-
[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]
ARIES AGRO	324.90	329.85	324.30	333.25	320.75	49.66	459.00	236.10	12	329.25
Arih.Capital	69.57	69.66	69.90	70.30	68.11	134.16	120.00	61.00	-	-
Arisinfra So	104.41	102.56	105.76	105.76	101.12	341.14	208.50	82.18	-	-
Arkade Dev	103.35	103.36	103.90	104.89	101.80	409.91	213.69	100.00	-	-
Arman Fin	1374.10	1418.10	1374.10	1435.00	1361.10	33.73	1849.95	1111.00	34	1425.35
Arrow green	345.80	367.35	348.80	372.00	345.80	79.31	816.15	342.00	12	366.80
Artemis Med	219.53	222.40	218.25	223.65	217.12	74.43	306.15	210.06	-	-
Arvind Fash [4]	380.80	394.60	384.25	398.55	376.85	177.19	579.05	338.00	-	395.60
Arvind Ltd	350.65	354.70	350.65	359.95	347.25	279.65	404.95	271.55	33	354.75
ArvindSmart	539.05	533.60	535.00	550.35	531.25	43.41	756.00	490.35	106	532.60
Asahi Ind. [1]	839.70	839.90	840.00	856.75	832.35	64.82	1072.95	576.60	71	840.50
Ashapura [2]	493.00	496.65	494.10	499.80	486.60	359.17	924.70	311.00	35	496.80
Ashok Leyl [1]	172.77	176.11	174.00	176.60	171.70	20890.04	215.35	95.20	28	176.10
Ashoka [5]	114.27	112.50	114.27	114.28	111.20	1716.28	230.70	111.25	16	112.65
Asian Energy	270.00	291.05	274.05	299.20	268.05	703.96	391.65	215.00	-	-
Asian granit	62.47	60.07	63.34	63.34	57.84	4541.50	78.78	39.58	-	59.91
Asian Paints [1]	2217.70	2238.20	2217.70	2261.50	2217.20	875.46	2985.50	2163.00	53	2238.40
ASK Auto.	408.10	406.00	408.10	411.50	403.05	102.97	578.50	372.55	-	-
Asso Alcohol	710.20	705.25	708.00	723.00	700.15	176.64	1477.95	696.00	-	-
ASTECFE	580.25	585.45	588.95	593.35	569.75	81.25	990.87	555.40	-	585.85
ASTERDM	649.20	669.55	657.05	675.50	649.20	811.37	732.00	419.45	105	669.65
Astra Micro [2]	954.10	964.45	960.50	975.00	956.60	166.29	1195.65	615.50	62	965.15
Astral Poly [1]	1619.70	1652.00	1624.90	1660.00	1619.70	490.08	1767.95	1233.15	77	1651.90
Astrazeneca [2]	8375.50	8449.50	8440.50	8506.00	8312.00	5.90	10653.05	6501.60	102	8445.30
Atal RealTe	22.04	22.42	22.30	22.90	21.90	6136.51	29.20	11.80	-	-
AtherEnergy	713.20	723.75	726.95	729.65	706.35	1252.99	790.00	288.15	-	-
Atlanta Elec	979.75	1033.25	999.00	1040.00	978.00	150.12	1097.85	707.60	-	-
ATUL AUTO [5]	405.55	411.45	410.00	416.00	404.75	95.02	554.20	381.70	25	411.90
ATUL.	6256.00	6198.50	6270.00	6306.50	6142.00	33.29	7793.00	4882.00	35	6191.05
AU SFB	885.30	902.05	888.00	903.95	874.80	1867.68	1038.75	479.00	29	902.25
Aurionpro So	830.50	821.20	835.05	835.05	817.85	142.98	1663.15	807.40	41	821.40
Aurob Pha [1]	1279.60	1286.00	1284.90	1295.00	1275.10	635.15	1319.60	994.35	35	1287.40
Authum Inv	464.10	477.95	470.60	484.80	462.00	772.75	3318.70	400.00	-	-
AUTOIND	60.33	59.71	61.20	61.45	58.80	299.36	96.00	58.58	18	59.21
Avadh Sugar	410.90	401.75	414.00	433.15	398.20	178.96	586.35	307.75	11	401.00
Avalon Tech	885.10	901.00	885.10	933.00	885.00	222.53	1318.00	666.75	-	-
Avantel	130.00	127.62	131.10	132.69	127.00	1169.53	215.00	102.20	-	-
Avanti Feeds [1]	1215.90	1244.20	1216.30	1263.00	1198.00	603.01	1489.45	582.00	30	1246.55
AvenueSai	14.01	14.07	14.20	14.25	14.00	4141.53	23.64	13.80	-	-
AVG Logistic	140.02	160.75	142.50	168.02	137.71	357.88	339.90	130.00	-	-
Avonmore Cap	11.97	12.19	12.00	12.44	11.47	525.51	24.19	11.40	-	-
Awfis Space	271.15	277.10	268.55	284.50	263.25	411.95	718.95	250.70	-	-
Axis Bank [2]	1214.70	1228.10	1219.70	1232.30	1210.00	5707.32	1418.30	1010.05	16	1229.10
AXISCADES [5]	1318.60	1384.50	1331.90	1384.50	1320.40	59.79	1778.55	725.00	184	1387.15
Aye Finance	100.54	102.29	100.04	102.90	97.44	380.84	149.50	97.45	-	102.15
Azad Engg	1494.80	1501.30	1499.10	1520.80	1486.10	102.10	1899.00	1159.45	-	-
B										
Baazar Style	240.10	239.90	243.70	245.35	235.65	684.51	392.00	220.50	-	-
BAJAJ AUTO	9073.00	9110.00	9100.00	9250.00	9006.50	245.26	10186.60	7088.25	28	9106.30
Bajaj Cons [1]	330.45	343.60	335.00	352.60	331.50	877.98	408.65	153.00	28	343.35
Bajaj Elect [2]	360.90	342.45	368.00	398.00	336.90	4941.53	710.00	340.00	85	342.25
Bajaj Fin [1]	878.15	868.60	878.15	881.05	859.55	7941.39	1102.45	810.21	34	868.60
Bajaj Finser [1]	1773.90	1774.70	1775.60	1782.60	1757.00	1259.53	2194.65	1726.10	200	1774.90
Bajaj HCare	279.15	278.20	283.35	285.00	275.45	532.48	745.00	273.25	-	-
Bajaj Hindus [1]	15.56	15.76	15.65	16.14	15.60	5628.44	29.62	14.89	-	15.76
Bajaj Holdng	9631.00	9663.00	9630.00	9729.00	9531.00	31.66	14873.20	9350.00	40	9653.85
Bajaj HouFin	81.31	81.30	81.50	81.95	81.05	4586.29	136.96	79.83	-	-
Bajel Proj.	167.95	175.52	175.59	182.39	168.37	41323.30	263.90	137.25	-	-
Balaji Amine [2]	1013.30	1000.40	1000.00	1018.20	992.00	67.78	1946.00	905.15	23	999.60
Balaji Tele. [2]	93.23	91.06	92.90	94.80	90.25	244.06	139.99	50.00	18	91.30
Balkrish Ind [2]	2165.80	2150.90	2165.80	2180.90	2139.20	118.97	2815.40	2020.05	32	2149.90
BalmerLawrie	159.74	160.69	159.75	161.70	159.75	141.88	238.00	157.20	12	160.80
BalramChini [1]	483.20	467.25	487.00	494.00	464.20	1093.40	627.00	393.40	23	466.90
Balu Forge	441.80	445.85	445.90	451.80	438.00	316.69	784.00	341.05	-	-
Banco Prod [2]	562.35	576.70	570.80	578.90	563.60	197.09	879.60	305.00	23	576.05
Bandhan Bk	162.54	159.58	163.00	163.99	158.19	10502.38	192.45	134.30	26	159.65
Bank of Maha	63.33	62.48	63.85	63.89	61.40	19530.27	76.99	38.11	7	62.47
Bansal Wire	251.70	252.80	256.00	265.45	249.00	82.78	434.30	228.20	-	-
BartronicInd	8.16	8.12	8.28	8.33	8.05	810.33	19.00	7.93	-	-
BASF India	3465.70	3420.10	3475.00	3475.00	3399.90	23.09	5418.20	2906.90	38	3406.50
Bata India [5]	677.95	671.25	681.05	682.40	665.10	214.48	1300.05	665.60	46	670.80
Bayer Crop	4516.70	4487.60	4544.90	4544.90	4404.10	29.35	6539.95	4276.85	30	4482.25
BCL Ind.	27.01	26.74	26.95	27.28	26.60	569.88	49.30	26.07	-	-
BDL [5]	1284.00	1296.80	1297.80	1305.80	1276.10	803.55	2096.00	1102.90	82	1296.60
BellaCasaFa	260.95	262.50	262.95	271.35	258.95	97.20	497.35	246.65	-	-
Belrise Inds	174.60	176.94	176.00	177.90	173.55	5129.46	200.90	89.15	-	-
BEML [5]	1495.90	1512.00	1516.50	1523.10	1493.80	177.68	2437.43	1232.35	49	1511.05
BEML Land	169.58	167.55	171.31	172.98	162.21	90.50	235.00	162.21	-	-
BergerPaints [1]	404.50	416.15	404.80	420.40	404.30	676.14	604.60	391.50	45	416.20
BFLYGANDHI	604.00	583.70	604.00	615.00	575.90	41.40	844.00	554.40	24	585.20
Bhagira.Chm	187.77	190.29	189.85	196.10	189.81	115.99	331.00	182.86	-	-
Bhagynagar [2]	144.40	147.69	145.49	149.17	143.41	79.47	194.00	63.01	-	148.10
BHANSALI E [1]	82.70	81.60	82.65	83.52	80.89	357.70	123.60	75.52	12	81.50
BHARAT BIJ [5]	2316.80	2304.90	2332.70	2375.00	2275.00	20.19	3472.55	2009.45	20	2304.60
Bharat Elect [1]	429.50	439.35	432.45	441.05	430.30	14421.13	473.25	252.25	54	439.65
Bharat Forge [2]	1697.00	1746.00	1708.00	1755.00	1691.20	1099.38	1936.35	919.10	62	1745.25
Bharat Gears	94.88	96.68	96.00	97.98	95.02	15.34	154.35	65.00	11	96.55
Bharat Ras [5]	1279.30	1301.80	1287.50	1347.00	1269.00	17.48	3030.25	1238.55	15	1301.10
Bharat Wire	153.97	158.24	157.00	159.95	152.80	107.94	248.70	150.35	14	157.75
BharatCoking	34.49	34.21	34.60	34.98	34.04	8128.64	45.09	31.16	-	-
BharatSeats	160.39	162.69	161.60	164.75	158.20	76.37	239.45	69.84	-	-
Bharti Airte [5]	1788.80	1827.00	1797.00	1834.50	1791.10	7181.49	2174.70	1619.95	48	1827.00
Bharti Hexa	1486.40	1531.00	1486.40	1540.00	1480.00	130.92	2052.90	1260.00	-	-
BHEL [2]	253.50	256.35	255.50	257.15	250.00	7083.92	305.85	193.00	112	256.25
Bigbloc [2]	50.52	50.90	50.11	52.34	50.11	121.45	80.60	48.10	-	51.16
Bikaji Fds	623.35	616.40	622.30	627.25	613.50	75.82	818.70	592.55	-	-
Billionbrain	158.08	161.07	159.40	161.50	157.20	17500.63	193.80	112.00	-	-
Biocon [5]	377.05	377.55	379.95	383.05	374.95	2698.12	424.95	295.30	315	377.80
BIRLA CORPN.	786.80	826.40	790.00	833.60	776.20	327.52	1537.15	773.90	20	827.75
Birlanu Ltd	1248.80	1202.80	1250.00	1253.40	1194.20	39.83	2428.30	1194.20	-	-
Birlasoft	348.60	362.70	352.30	367.00	349.65	1821.98	474.00	331.00	-	-
Bk of baroda [2]	279.95	283.25	280.55	283.95	277.30	5072.81	325.55	204.25	8	283.25
Bk of India	150.67	151.38	151.10	151.75	148.54	8579.11	178.45	94.25	7	151.45
BL kashyap [1]	47.81	48.68	47.81	49.50	47.81	524.57	80.07	42.71	-	48.73
Black Box	496.70	513.45	500.00	525.00	492.20	589.42	613.80	320.85	-	-
Bliss GVS [1]	202.15	210.76	204.94	213.74	202.20	871.53	244.05	105.05	29	210.40
BLS [1]	244.10	240.65	245.15	246.60	240.00	740.73	428.30	238.35	-	240.90
BLS e-Svc	142.33	142.27	142.79	143.70	141.50	1868.12	232.50	124.30	-	-
Blue Jet Hlt	356.40	352.60	356.40	364.75	349.00	505.97	1027.80	344.05	-	-
Blue Star [2]	1804.10	1815.30	1809.00	1831.70	1780.00	386.88	2266.70	1521.20	90	1816.65
BlueDart Exp	5110.50	5148.50	5200.00	5214.50	5098.00	7.99	7222.35	5028.15	42	5146.85
BluestoneJew	512.80	533.55	512.80	561.00	509.65	929.12	793.00	399.80	-	-
BluspringEnt	45.96	45.77	45.80	46.23	45.02	536.45	100.88	44.55	-	-
BMW Ventures	60.58	59.85	59.70	60.53	59.21	114.50	78.00	50.02	-	-
Bodal Chem [2]	43.63	43.52	44.00	44.41	43.35	189.04	81.50	41.25	20	43.60
Bom Dyeing [2]	102.19	105.28	102.40	105.89	101.20	1384.07	196.50	99.85	-	105.15
BombayBur [2]	1495.60	1511.20	1502.60	1521.00	1495.70	30.62	2156.10	1477.10	174	1513.50
Borosil	233.09	228.44	231.90	233.30	226.60	116.42	397.95	214.50	-	-
Borosil.Ren.	407.90	411.15	409.20	419.15	408.20	335.94	721.00	401.00	-	-
Bosch Home	1271.40	1257.20	1283.00	1292.10	1250.10	23.74	1890.00	1250.00	-	-
BOSCH	30355.00	30645.00	30595.00	30910.00	30390.00	11.58	41894.30	25938.20	39	30626.45
BPCL	304.95	300.05	305.30	305.90	298.15	16467.62	391.85	258.40	5	299.90
BPL	47.15	47.55	47.70	48.46	47.12	70.90	100.30	47.00	5	47.91
BrainbeesSol	214.06	212.89	214.05	215.13	209.05	924.06	438.70	207.05	-	-
Brigade	650.75	649.25	648.00	653.95	637.75	386.65	1332.35	634.95	39	649.60
BrigadeHotel	58.19	58.99	58.94	59.45	58.00	169.21	91.77	55.40	-	-
Britannia [1]	5842.00	5857.50	5849.00	5868.50	5801.50	260.17	6336.95	4525.05	58	5860.00
Brooks Lab	57.03	55.40	58.98	59.00	55.10	143.11	165.95	54.62	25	55.70
BSE Ltd	2862.60	2973.60	2890.00	2980.00	2867.90	5772.95	7588.00	2021.50	-	-
BYKE Hosp	33.88	33.01	34.06	35.35	32.20	165.98	102.30	32.37	30	32.72
C										
Camlin Fine [1]	131.71	128.64	132.00	133.29	125.00	332.43	334.70	125.00	-	129.65
Campus Act.	232.85	229.60	231.10	234.65	228.10	172.86	304.40	210.00	-	-
CAMS	639.50	632.80	645.50	645.50	630.10	1424.25	4375.00	623.25	-	-
Canara Bank [2]	134.51	136.58	135.00	136.85	133.67	21872.42	162.90	82.23	6	136.50
Canara HSBCL	145.60	147.85	145.45	149.15	144.12	765.00	159.00	106.00	-	-
Canara RobAM	231.95	234.20	234.00	236.35	232.25	381.37	353.40	214.20	-	-
Canfin Hom [2]	840.40	828.05	850.00	853.80	824.00	172.92	970.00	601.00	11	828.45
CAPACITE	180.28	207.78	180.48	214.90	180.48	16644.67	396.00	178.90	10	209.20
CapillaryTec	515.15	507.60	520.00	520.00	503.20	134.33	798.95	481.00	-	-
CapitalIndia	24.69	26.20	24.70	26.89	24.54	540.35	44.50	24.42	-	-
CAPLIN POI [2]	1636.00	1635.10	1649.90	1650.00	1624.90	51.00	2396.95	1551.05	34	1634.40
Carborun [1]	758.55	752.85	761.00	764.05	744.90	94.44	1127.00	738.25	40	752.95
Care Rating	1564.90	1553.70	1575.00	1575.00	1544.50	22.20	1964.80	1057.65	28	1554.05
Carraro Ind	439.45	428.60	439.45	444.50	420.85	69.43	614.50	253.15	-	-
Cartrade Tch	1656.00	1724.70	1656.00	1757.90	1646.70	404.69	3290.50	1362.50	-	-
Carysil	777.45	778.85	781.20	787.70	767.60	89.16	1071.90	512.00	-	-
CASTROL [5]	186.34	186.48	187.10	187.10	185.50	1297.17	236.80	180.60	19	186.55
CCL PRODU [2]	1043.30	1038.80	1044.80	1053.60	1025.70	145.42	1074.30	475.00	66	1039.50
CDSL	1184.50	1199.30	1190.00	1206.00	1181.60	1858.35	1828.90	1047.45	-	-
CE Info Sys	887.40	868.60	890.00	906.00	866.30	240.18	2166.70	866.30	-	-
CEAT	3412.00	3414.30	3440.00	3442.00	3386.00	64.85	4431.60	2322.05	20	3414.80
Ceigall Ind.	272.35	279.00	272.35	281.80	266.85	276.39	307.90	222.61	-	-
CEINSYS TECH	938.45	931.00	959.60	974.85	921.00	60.50	1067.85	855.00	-	-
Cello World	399.35	387.60	400.00	403.30	384.30	456.24	673.80	384.30	-	-
CemIndia Pro	532.35	529.50	532.55	540.95	521.00	238.76	944.00	476.60	-	-
Central Bank	35.04	34.94	35.33	35.33	34.69	4813.48	47.28	32.81	7	34.94
Centrum C [1]	22.60	21.88	22.26	22.60	21.51	666.10	41.90	19.70	-	21.85
Centuryply [1]	645.75	662.60	653.80	685.60	645.00	20.89	856.65	630.00	53	664.20
CERA SANIT [5]	4580.90	4601.60	4578.50	4616.60	4530.50	21.87	7271.40	4463.00	26	4602.25
CESE [1]	156.55	155.93	156.55	158.25	155.25	1205.56	185.25	136.80	24	156.10
CG Power&I [2]	698.65	708.40	701.00	712.00	697.00	2292.18	797.75	518.35	92	708.25
CGCL [1]	171.57	169.71	170.70	171.59	168.46	887.44	231.70	150.60	22	169.80
CHALET	724.25	717.40	724.80	736.00	714.10	131.63	1080.00	702.00	25	718.05
Chaman Set.	234.90	234.80	234.90	239.05	231.10	46.64	395.75	228.80	-	-
Chambal Fert	413.05	428.65	416.65	432.20	409.70	1283.48	742.45	400.00	9	428.50
Chemcon Spl	149.86	147.83	150.60	151.99	146.66	31.75	295.00	146.50	-	-
Chemfab Alk	354.10	363.45	360.00	378.45	353.65	9.90	905.55	345.60	-	-
Chempl.San	263.93	259.28	259.97	268.68	251.61	134.13	491.90	211.03	-	-
Choice Intl	617.80	629.80	622.20	638.40	622.20	551.22	860.50	476.50	-	-
CholaFinHo [1]	1570.60	1521.90	1562.80	1576.10	1510.00	199.26	2299.00	1386.60	411	1521.15
CholaIn&Fin [2]	1527.10	1529.00	1530.10	1557.40	1511.00	972.41	1831.80	1358.75	27	1528.20
CIE Auto.Ind	448.95	459.35	450.05	465.00	445.20	235.45	526.00	356.75	-	-
Cigniti Tech	1063.30	1056.30	1060.00	1061.90	996.50	145.92	1928.85	996.90	14	1051.30
Cipla [2]	1300.00	1281.90	1300.00	1302.60	1275.60	2034.28	1672.20	1275.65	23	1281.45
CityUnion [1]	242.55	240.05	240.90	243.25	237.05	3111.96	319.95	144.00	14	240.15
CLEAN MAX ENVI	859.60	890.70	870.00	907.50	858.70	255.79	960.00	768.00	-	-
Clean S Tech	700.95	689.55	701.00	706.55	684.10	204.82	1600.00	673.50	-	-
CLS Fin	243.05	247.00	243.00	251.90	242.05	65.75	380.20	227.45	-	-
CMS Info Sys	290.35	286.75	290.00	294.70	284.85	715.47	541.15	284.85	-	-
COAL INDIA	460.30	462.25	460.30	465.50	458.00	9193.24	475.95	350.15	17	462.10
Coastal Cor.	45.94	46.22	48.50	49.45	45.12	145.90	53.99	30.01	-	-
CochinShip [5]	1334.70	1359.60	1349.00	1366.00	1328.00	897.81	2547.25	1223.10	50	1360.00
CoffeeDayEnt	24.60	24.78	24.88	25.08	24.42	696.84	51.49	23.37	-	24.85
Coforge	1080.60	1073.90	1087.90	1087.90	1008.10	6318.40	8699.00	1008.10	-	-
CohanceLifeS	293.45	301.25	295.45	303.00	291.25	711.71	1250.00	266.70	-	-
COLGATE P [1]	1941.10	1932.90	1949.90	1958.30	1930.50	289.86	2745.95	1920.00	39	1932.85
COMPUCOM [2]	13.68	13.74	13.91	15.05	13.51	245.95	24.19	11.40	-	13.70
Concord Bio	1158.10	1129.20	1150.00	1184.60	1119.00	344.15	2150.40	1068.60	-	-
Concord Env	243.30	241.25	246.20	246.95	240.25	196.24	659.90	235.00	-	-
CONFI PE [1]	32.06	31.54	32.15	34.45	31.15	2611.98	63.59	27.00	13	31.61
ContainerC [5]	454.30	452.40	458.00	458.00	450.10	1178.10	652.52	443.40	27	452.50
Control Pri	616.10	642.30	619.35	650.00	609.60	20.74	918.55	571.90	8	645.70
Coromandl [1]	1958.80	2037.90	1958.80	2090.00	1955.00	333.88	2720.00	1781.00	28	2039.20
Corona Remed	1554.70	1561.00	1570.00	1580.00	1544.40	54.86	1699.00	1336.60	-	-
Cosmo First	660.85	639.85	660.00	666.15	634.05	81.52	1307.20	525.70	-	-
CPCL	988.55	1065.05	981.00	1077.70	968.00	9950.14	1103.00	515.65	8	1065.20
Craftsm.Auto	6792.50	6917.00	6850.00	6969.00	6741.00	49.15	8220.00	3700.00	-	-
CREDITACC	1177.30	1168.90	1170.00	1176.10	1155.40	239.26	1496.60	860.00	39	1169.00
Credo Brand	76.33	74.66	76.58	76.64	74.50	128.21	189.00	74.20	-	-
CRISIL [1]	4005.80	4009.00	4034.90	4044.80	3995.70	28.57	6329.95	3893.85	48	4009.75
Crizac Ltd [2]	196.23	204.58	196.23	206.50	191.76	331.42	387.50	192.25	22	205.75
Crompton [2]	247.15	248.65	248.45	252.00	245.50	1547.56	367.50	217.50	32	248.50
CSB Bank	357.15	353.65	358.00	360.20	348.15	448.13	574.70	270.00	10	353.45
Cubex Tubing	87.61	90.87	87.52	92.42	87.30	97.99	143.82	67.34	16	90.90
CUMMINS (I) [2]	4589.70	4596.40	4633.00	4656.00	4565.00	610.45	4987.00	2594.75	56	4597.80
Cupid Ltd [1]	78.75	79.05	80.10	80.95	78.75	14325.10	105.48	10.00	-	79.30
Cybertech	101.56	106.14	101.56	106.80	101.56	45.76	274.80	95.30	14	106.10
CYIENT [5]	854.50	850.85	859.00	869.75	841.00	308.48	1376.90	843.00	21	854.00
Cyient DLM	300.60	296.55	309.00	348.00	286.15	31534.42	540.00	282.60	-	-
D										
D B CORP	206.05	204.63	205.65	209.10	202.00	74.96	290.80	198.05	11	204.40
D B REALTY	99.06	98.19	99.06	100.24	96.65	1416.79	218.94	95.00	61	98.15
Dabur [1]	458.85	452.60	460.30	460.70	451.90	1315.80	576.80	420.05	55	452.50
Dalmia Sug [2]	292.15	294.65	296.90	313.95	293.00	191.09	464.00	262.75	7	294.00
DAM Cap Adv	121.69	121.48	123.52	124.60	120.00	667.57	303.50	119.22	-	-
Data Pattern	3095.90	3300.50	3096.00	3329.90	3094.50	2096.19	3609.50	1392.25	-	-
DATAM G [5]	694.80	696.20	690.15	700.00	686.50	39.09	1119.95	522.85	44	695.75
Davang.Sugar	3.73	3.98	3.74	4.05	3.71	4722.36	5.50	3.03	-	-
DB Abhushan	977.50	994.90	999.00	999.00	955.10	14.83	1729.60	949.60	-	-
DBL	432.05	432.30	431.95	435.60	429.70	102.50	587.90	381.05	39	432.75
DCAL [2]	165.33	163.53	164.68	165.47	159.81	567.76	321.15	154.30	-	163.55
DCB Bank	168.91	169.26	170.45	170.60	165.43	1057.11	203.55	102.00	8	169.45
DCM Shriram	32.82	33.39	33.20	34.00	32.25	148.19	63.10	32.25	-	-
DCM SHRIR FINE	22.29	22.91	22.29	24.98	22.29	317.48	52.49	22.50	-	22.82
DCM SHRIR INT	70.20	84.24	71.25	84.24	71.01	1761.35	84.27	70.10	-	84.27
DCMSHRI [2]	1051.00	1061.80	1055.90	1068.80	1032.30	108.48	1501.70	946.15	24	1061.20
DCW [2]	40.46	41.32	40.46	42.30	40.10	2111.36	90.46	39.87	29	41.41
DCX Systems	168.11	169.28	168.65	171.22	167.30	839.27	363.75	153.60	-	-
DDev Plastik	230.90	225.95	233.00	235.50	225.00	152.96	360.00	219.87	-	-
DE NORA	708.25	717.55	698.00	735.00	698.00	13.39	995.00	559.00	29	718.20
Dee Develop.	299.30	313.10	304.30	318.00	298.10	1870.21	336.20	183.00	-	-
Deep Ind	349.00	353.10	351.80	356.75	342.10	228.41	578.00	330.00	-	-
Deepak Fert.	934.90	909.50	934.00	937.85	906.10	501.90	1776.95	902.25	36	910.20
DEEPAK NIT [2]	1391.70	1394.40	1391.00	1415.90	1391.00	84.39	2173.00	1383.55	90	1395.35
Delhivery	401.25	402.30	401.45	406.95	399.85	1801.93	490.00	238.50	-	-
Delph.World	9.84	10.31	10.25	11.25	9.81	1265.03	264.00	9.60	-	-
DELTA CORP [1]	53.37	52.93	53.51	53.92	52.60	1355.70	98.86	52.11	15	52.94
DEN NETWORK	26.18	26.17	26.20	26.53	25.97	530.62	42.80	25.17	11	26.12
Denta Water	236.45	237.20	237.30	242.75	234.00	98.95	479.60	222.00	-	-
Dev Info Tec	25.75	28.73	25.51	28.90	24.25	848.62	125.90	22.25	-	-
Devyani.Eng	107.66	107.85	107.42	111.30	105.25	4113.76	191.00	102.60	-	-
DhamprBioOrg	97.42	96.44	98.20	99.94	96.10	145.31	115.25	57.34	-	-
Dhampur Sug	115.74	118.19	117.00	120.87	116.25	536.26	161.95	108.85	11	117.85
Dhanalak Bnk	22.63	22.58	22.98	22.98	22.48	460.42	33.38	22.00	10	22.56
Dhanuka Ag [2]	977.40	987.60	977.40	1004.50	969.00	32.42	1960.00	952.00	17	986.95
Dharmaj Crop	236.93	240.83	237.09	243.99	232.20	52.25	386.50	175.00	-	-
Diamond Pwr	127.56	125.48	130.80	130.80	124.21	1313.45	183.50	86.20	-	-
DIAMONDYD [5]	914.70	917.50	914.70	938.70	909.10	72.41	1295.45	863.00	-	913.95
Diffusion En	239.75	239.10	245.20	245.20	237.60	85.84	418.20	231.85	-	-
DigitideSol	77.54	75.50	78.70	78.70	75.11	362.97	279.69	75.11	-	-
DISH TV [1]	2.34	2.20	2.40	2.40	2.18	11913.38	6.69	2.18	-	2.22
Divgi Torq.	658.25	673.50	660.00	689.60	658.95	23.47	802.90	410.10	-	-
Divi's Lab [2]	6071.00	6086.50	6074.00	6147.00	6051.50	183.60	7077.70	4941.70	63	6084.90
DIXON [2]	10263.00	10289.00	10379.00	10459.00	10211.00	518.01	18471.50	9620.00	84	10281.10
DLF [2]	530.35	547.80	531.25	550.55	529.70	5442.20	887.50	525.00	50	548.05
DLINK IND [2]	394.30	393.30	392.35	397.50	390.05	49.91	588.90	358.25	14	393.25
DMART	3817.90	3781.40	3827.80	3853.00	3775.00	229.56	4916.30	3528.65	79	3780.80
Dodla Dairy	1011.60	999.50	1015.90	1023.90	996.00	43.92	1525.00	964.10	-	-
Dolat Algo	72.39	74.27	71.66	75.50	71.21	288.50	111.05	68.00	-	-
DOLLAR [2]	245.45	248.50	248.00	255.00	241.90	31.77	430.00	233.95	14	248.85
Dolphin Off.	397.40	387.15	396.90	400.55	380.60	59.23	501.95	245.05	-	-
DOMS Ind	2139.70	2156.70	2129.50	2185.00	2110.10	98.52	3064.60	2023.90	-	-
DPSC	7.92	8.14	7.95	8.25	7.70	160.24	15.48	7.70	-	-
Dr AgarwalHe	423.85	426.25	421.00	438.20	415.00	266.99	568.00	327.00	-	-
Dreamfolks	70.89	69.93	71.80	71.80	69.60	131.76	304.85	69.36	-	-
Dredging Cor	893.05	871.95	900.90	909.50	867.00	182.20	1245.90	496.30	-	873.25
DrReddy'sLa [1]	1276.90	1283.80	1279.90	1291.40	1265.00	1003.68	1377.95	1025.90	23	1283.10
Dwar Sugar [1]	36.63	36.55	37.18	38.54	36.25	856.51	52.55	32.14	34	36.78
DYNACONS SYS	883.20	881.70	879.00	901.95	878.90	15.51	1213.70	802.10	13	880.00
DYNAMAT.TECH	9332.00	9533.00	9429.00	9591.00	9225.00	14.49	11500.00	5437.40	130	9529.95
Dynamic Cab.	268.05	270.25	271.80	273.00	266.80	114.46	1036.00	261.10	-	-
DYNEMIC PRO	204.38	204.88	206.98	210.89	202.00	32.02	414.70	202.00	14	204.05
E										
Easy Trip Pl	6.89	6.83	6.95	6.99	6.75	13462.10	14.02	6.12	-	-
Eclerx Ser	1528.60	1474.70	1525.00	1539.50	1464.00	225.23	2492.98	1058.00	32	1475.95
Ecos (I) Mob	121.99	122.13	123.56	124.40	121.57	184.33	358.40	121.56	-	-
EDELWEISS [1]	106.73	108.59	107.04	109.47	106.65	3799.43	130.65	73.51	36	108.40
EFC (I) Ltd	199.41	195.57	201.00	201.58	191.48	571.25	357.00	191.48	-	-
Eicher Motor [1]	6827.50	6910.00	6827.50	6974.50	6770.00	555.87	8232.80	4950.60	38	6914.20
EID Parry [1]	786.15	809.70	790.75	815.65	786.15	211.83	1246.45	686.60	411	810.45
EIH [2]	314.55	315.80	319.25	319.25	312.90	110.64	434.35	302.35	28	316.30
Eimco Elecon	1495.60	1547.80	1495.60	1553.90	1485.10	18.26	3001.10	1300.40	19	1547.70
Elec.Mart In	90.88	91.23	90.88	92.59	90.10	234.62	168.50	84.90	-	-
Elecon Eng [1]	375.65	382.80	376.50	394.50	372.15	564.44	716.55	348.05	23	382.70
Electro Cast [1]	69.61	68.51	70.38	70.79	67.50	2531.49	138.70	60.13	11	68.54
ELECTROTHERM	625.00	647.25	625.55	671.25	618.65	77.65	1280.00	560.95	17	651.10
Elgi Equipm [1]	468.65	468.80	472.10	473.85	462.10	331.10	608.25	390.05	40	468.60
Elin Elec.	117.56	120.65	118.50	121.99	117.45	190.36	234.00	110.05	-	-
EllenBarrInd	180.50	195.49	180.00	198.55	175.00	2499.95	637.70	175.00	-	-
Emami Ltd [1]	424.10	418.55	423.00	427.45	411.00	1001.02	655.40	405.00	21	418.40
EMAMI PA [2]	69.87	68.33	70.45	71.39	68.00	39.15	122.66	68.20	12	68.35
Emcure Phr	1458.40	1505.40	1474.50	1523.50	1471.90	206.78	1585.60	889.00	-	-
Emmvee Photo	210.28	216.88	213.24	219.75	209.70	3333.83	248.40	171.51	-	-
EMS	277.80	278.40	277.35	289.75	275.00	315.67	695.40	256.05	-	-
Emudhra	412.30	407.60	412.00	413.40	405.00	84.15	894.10	400.00	-	-
Endurance	2391.40	2328.10	2409.50	2416.20	2320.00	88.06	3078.95	1555.65	45	2326.10
Enginrs Ind [5]	188.99	189.40	189.00	191.15	186.05	2214.53	255.25	149.25	15	189.35
Entero Hlth	1001.20	1026.60	1001.70	1030.00	1001.70	59.18	1510.80	944.00	-	-
Enviro Infr.	145.26	145.98	146.42	147.42	144.13	652.08	306.40	134.71	-	-
Epack Dur.	240.37	242.61	242.29	245.89	239.91	520.52	421.35	216.50	-	-
Epack Prefab	157.44	152.40	159.90	159.90	151.31	429.54	344.00	150.57	-	-
Epigral	860.95	853.35	869.60	869.60	844.10	104.01	2114.00	822.50	-	-
EPL	180.12	187.05	179.49	190.02	178.36	799.10	254.00	175.28	-	-
Equitas SFB	56.10	55.85	56.48	56.82	55.52	2177.90	73.40	50.00	-	-
ERIS [1]	1309.90	1280.40	1316.00	1316.00	1275.00	84.16	1909.55	1187.10	60	1284.55
ESAF SFB	23.48	23.32	23.18	23.81	23.18	569.41	36.20	23.18	-	-
Escorts	3060.00	3052.80	3082.10	3092.00	3030.20	75.99	4171.35	2902.65	26	3053.55
Essar Shp	23.08	24.17	23.40	25.60	23.36	362.75	43.00	21.25	9	23.96
Ester Inds [5]	90.94	91.71	91.01	94.20	91.01	89.29	155.55	89.10	73	91.45
Eternal Ltd	222.04	234.63	223.00	236.13	222.75	85823.18	368.45	194.80	-	-
Ethos	2024.60	2041.00	2024.00	2050.00	2000.00	24.74	3245.90	1919.40	-	-
Eureka Forb.	435.65	431.25	440.40	440.40	421.30	458.50	668.30	403.20	-	-
Euro Pratik	234.15	226.55	235.40	239.40	224.45	247.81	390.00	205.10	-	-
EVEREADY (I) [5]	300.15	301.70	301.95	304.60	296.20	54.84	475.20	272.80	29	302.30
Everest Inds	347.40	343.80	340.90	392.95	336.10	142.11	748.00	336.60	-	347.20
EVEREST K [2]	106.97	104.67	106.20	106.49	103.68	252.43	157.55	97.00	14	104.55
EXCEL [1]	1.07	1.05	1.08	1.11	1.03	4674.73	1.75	0.65	-	1.04
Excel Ind [5]	859.50	855.15	859.50	877.80	840.00	18.19	1438.00	840.60	15	848.30
ExcelsofTe	76.92	75.68	77.02	77.60	75.00	489.13	142.59	68.00	-	-
Exicom Tele	85.75	88.78	86.80	95.48	85.50	2028.53	217.00	83.10	-	-
EXIDE IND. [1]	295.15	301.90	296.95	303.60	295.25	1849.19	430.85	290.80	24	302.10
Expleo Sol.	710.55	718.40	715.70	726.55	703.35	47.32	1370.90	703.35	-	-
F										
Fabtech Tech	138.01	137.98	139.11	141.93	136.25	75.38	262.80	134.42	-	-
FACT	805.55	812.30	812.40	850.00	785.00	1837.16	1111.00	565.20	-	811.55
Fag Bearings [2]	3773.90	3914.30	3798.00	3950.00	3764.70	72.74	4465.00	2851.00	51	3918.10
FCS Softwa [1]	1.43	1.45	1.45	1.50	1.42	1520.70	3.28	1.42	-	1.45
FDC [1]	341.35	340.55	343.30	346.40	339.50	48.82	528.30	330.05	23	340.40
Fed Mog Goe	375.85	387.95	375.00	389.00	374.05	35.60	622.00	321.50	12	389.20
FedBank Fina	127.24	130.45	127.99	132.00	127.00	542.73	178.48	80.00	-	-
Federal Bnk [2]	260.85	264.55	260.85	266.50	255.80	12836.89	301.75	175.60	17	264.80
FIEM Inds	2005.00	2003.20	2044.00	2048.70	1991.00	42.19	2554.30	1156.00	22	2004.70
Filatex Fas	0.17	0.17	0.17	0.18	0.17	126343.37	0.74	0.17	-	-
FILATEX INDI [1]	40.04	39.95	40.09	40.48	39.25	732.16	66.10	34.03	10	39.80
Fine Org [5]	4311.10	4291.60	4320.00	4336.70	4270.10	5.40	5490.00	3355.05	39	4287.35
FINEOTEX [1]	21.35	21.49	21.50	21.90	21.27	1300.80	35.76	19.21	-	21.50
Finkurve Fin	56.78	55.48	57.89	58.64	55.00	76.49	134.90	55.00	-	-
Fino Pay.Bnk	140.43	141.25	140.00	147.69	135.87	4065.86	339.00	135.87	-	-
Finolex Ind. [2]	180.25	176.08	180.70	181.86	175.50	428.89	238.00	144.05	23	176.15
FinolexCable [2]	845.00	857.40	856.80	883.00	842.20	398.85	1028.45	701.00	21	856.45
FischerMed	33.20	34.86	33.90	34.86	33.03	1900.68	1194.40	32.91	-	-
FiveStrBusFn	358.15	355.25	360.45	361.25	349.25	900.44	850.00	343.25	-	-
Flair Writng	297.95	302.80	294.05	306.95	294.05	50.59	357.00	194.99	-	-
Foods & Inns	53.50	52.80	53.54	54.38	52.51	128.06	128.45	49.89	-	-
Force Mot.	20720.00	20990.00	20720.00	21330.00	20355.00	97.81	26450.00	7000.00	-	-
FORTIS HEALT	807.90	820.20	811.95	825.60	795.00	2355.34	1105.00	521.05	355	820.15
Foseco India	4769.50	5166.50	4762.50	5200.00	4720.00	12.18	6819.00	3268.25	48	5166.90
Fractal Anal	764.80	796.30	771.00	799.90	765.20	380.12	920.70	765.60	-	796.40
FSL	217.72	216.98	218.35	220.11	214.24	598.74	403.80	200.60	33	216.95
FSN E Com	237.00	240.00	239.40	241.00	234.50	6166.62	285.60	163.51	-	-
FujiyaPow	182.75	186.25	183.00	190.32	183.00	150.39	230.99	172.00	-	-
Fusion Micro	156.46	158.00	156.50	162.00	152.57	525.37	211.80	123.96	-	-
G										
Gabriel Ind [1]	830.70	844.10	842.30	856.00	832.15	276.18	1386.45	476.20	49	846.45
GAIL	146.06	147.71	147.00	148.38	145.55	13154.64	202.65	144.45	12	147.65
Galaxy Surf	1747.00	1693.10	1748.00	1756.40	1688.00	15.68	2750.00	1690.00	38	1694.80
Gallan Metal	537.40	548.60	541.45	554.65	535.40	34.87	800.60	309.85	28	547.00
Gandhar Oil	126.73	130.49	127.60	132.50	126.40	220.40	184.42	120.56	-	-
Ganesh Benz.	77.63	76.95	76.47	79.28	76.47	297.06	133.80	68.40	-	-
Ganesh Cons	157.91	158.18	158.00	164.00	157.00	99.35	309.95	152.00	-	-
Ganesh Ecosp	841.15	845.00	842.00	867.95	830.85	664.54	1738.80	653.25	49	846.00
Ganesh Hous	602.60	588.05	597.45	607.80	584.60	120.31	1169.00	566.00	-	-
Gareware	610.00	616.10	614.85	622.10	600.00	37.75	981.00	582.55	29	614.80
Garuda Cons.	155.23	160.09	157.00	160.84	154.85	654.74	249.30	87.50	-	-
Garware Hi	3850.90	3768.60	3912.10	3912.10	3739.70	41.42	4782.90	2317.35	-	-
Gateway Dis	52.16	52.47	52.40	52.83	51.57	779.35	76.50	51.39	-	-
GAUDIUM IVF N	81.57	85.00	80.29	88.00	79.22	1758.21	88.00	72.02	-	-
GE Vernova	3522.30	3671.10	3559.50	3713.70	3487.60	536.12	3999.00	1254.00	-	-
Genesys Intl [5]	275.15	264.45	275.05	275.45	263.55	485.05	798.95	258.15	26	264.60
Genus Pwr [1]	239.50	249.35	243.00	250.00	238.25	661.35	430.05	210.70	14	249.05
Geojit Fin	57.05	56.66	57.05	59.79	56.21	459.61	94.79	56.12	-	-
GHCL Text	73.27	73.16	72.40	74.18	72.06	174.86	99.00	65.00	-	-
GIC Housing	139.50	144.80	139.99	145.50	138.01	92.94	206.00	137.40	5	144.55
GICRE [5]	362.55	367.80	362.65	373.25	359.15	326.80	453.60	351.00	8	367.70
Gific Bio Sc [1]	282.60	293.85	282.55	299.00	280.00	154.80	409.00	268.65	58	294.10
Gillette (I)	7938.00	7957.00	8000.00	8098.50	7928.00	19.12	11505.00	7551.05	42	7948.50
Ginni Filamm	35.35	35.22	36.97	36.97	34.18	85.68	57.71	18.94	6	35.15
GK Energy L	102.71	105.67	104.11	107.00	101.10	360.82	239.60	96.01	-	-
Gland Pharma	1609.20	1633.90	1633.00	1640.00	1601.30	29.95	2131.00	1277.80	-	-
Glaxo Pharma	2403.00	2429.60	2404.90	2440.00	2396.00	31.16	3515.95	2220.00	41	2433.65
Glenmark P [1]	2175.40	2145.90	2179.90	2184.70	2136.00	773.81	2297.20	1336.95	41	2147.40
Global Edu.	97.83	99.45	97.15	105.00	97.15	71.64	112.35	41.00	-	-
Global Hlth	1040.80	1036.90	1040.00	1047.40	1029.00	104.08	1456.50	1010.00	-	-
GlobeCivil	42.85	42.68	42.85	44.22	42.40	211.53	95.00	42.40	-	-
GLOBUS SPR	808.95	822.65	814.50	839.80	809.05	53.60	1303.95	802.15	30	821.95
Glottis Ltd	43.79	43.46	43.80	44.22	42.80	142.29	93.00	42.51	-	-
GM Breweri	967.15	963.35	972.00	994.95	952.00	145.44	1328.00	591.05	14	965.85
GMM Pfaud [2]	864.90	860.40	867.05	872.00	852.10	96.82	1416.30	831.00	56	860.40
GMR Airports	90.50	90.30	90.90	91.10	89.66	6931.78	110.36	73.80	-	-
GMR P&U Inf.	103.54	103.27	105.00	105.00	102.20	1723.30	141.01	97.22	-	-
GNA	383.70	390.45	384.90	397.95	378.65	58.00	470.70	269.80	15	390.35
GNFC	417.70	412.40	419.00	419.00	409.75	373.23	573.25	406.05	10	412.70
GNG Elect	367.55	376.40	370.00	385.90	360.00	386.78	401.70	239.00	-	-
Go Digit	339.80	330.95	338.15	338.15	328.35	200.76	381.40	264.60	-	-
GO Fashion	249.50	238.40	251.00	252.85	237.05	761.27	943.75	237.05	-	-
GOCL Corp [2]	230.00	231.45	230.00	234.50	229.35	51.51	417.00	226.00	8	231.70
Godavari Bio	292.50	307.60	295.75	311.00	289.05	483.90	348.70	145.00	-	-
Godawari p [1]	249.15	260.25	250.00	261.60	249.70	1989.06	290.00	170.00	22	260.15
Godfrey Phil [2]	2019.60	2010.10	2040.00	2040.40	2004.00	223.17	3945.00	1856.16	24	2007.30
Godrej Agro	574.70	577.60	573.60	595.00	572.90	213.90	876.30	506.70	20	576.80
Godrej Con [1]	1041.10	1041.10	1049.00	1049.00	1029.40	1198.05	1308.40	1020.00	76	1041.25
Godrej Ind [1]	859.55	828.55	863.60	865.40	825.25	133.76	1391.50	800.05	-	827.95
Godrej prop [5]	1560.00	1584.20	1556.00	1596.20	1547.50	509.34	2505.00	1476.05	114	1584.75
Gokaldas [5]	577.45	573.15	578.00	581.85	567.55	412.99	1060.00	531.60	22	573.00
Gokul Agro [1]	159.17	191.00	160.01	191.00	159.72	47307.70	221.40	96.00	23	189.65
Goldiam Int [2]	291.90	296.55	292.40	300.60	289.40	514.28	444.35	252.00	79	297.30
Good Luck [2]	1024.80	1046.70	1035.00	1064.30	1017.90	57.05	1352.80	608.00	21	1045.95
Gopal Snacks	269.30	272.80	270.90	274.20	267.45	79.11	398.00	255.90	-	-
GPPL	150.71	152.15	151.09	152.80	149.76	735.47	200.00	121.30	17	152.10
GPT Health.	123.03	121.55	124.26	124.50	120.36	105.14	185.00	119.34	-	-
GPT Infra	99.41	104.39	103.87	105.95	100.31	340.80	149.75	92.01	14	104.25
GR Infrapro	910.25	918.80	908.00	931.00	900.10	14.56	1444.40	892.50	-	-
Granules Ind [1]	567.00	572.00	566.90	577.90	564.00	853.59	627.45	412.05	36	571.90
Graphite [2]	613.50	620.45	616.00	623.75	609.15	599.76	747.00	413.00	29	619.95
Grasim Ind. [2]	2654.40	2683.30	2655.10	2699.00	2650.00	603.52	2980.05	2351.05	473	2682.50
Gravita Ind [2]	1399.90	1414.20	1411.90	1440.50	1390.50	235.51	2169.90	1383.00	35	1413.95
Great Easte	1373.40	1426.40	1380.00	1435.00	1379.00	984.68	1509.15	817.20	12	1425.85
Greaves Cot [2]	135.75	134.50	136.40	137.97	134.00	924.28	244.55	133.50	14	134.40
Green pwr	9.40	9.17	9.48	9.54	9.06	3880.37	15.80	8.71	-	9.16
Greenlam [1]	222.72	214.98	219.38	227.50	211.25	38.86	298.28	187.00	41	218.70
Greenpanel I	192.97	192.03	194.00	194.50	189.05	72.38	335.20	189.05	-	-
Greenply Ind [1]	193.49	192.95	193.55	195.00	189.70	102.84	351.55	188.10	27	193.90
Grind Nort [5]	1452.90	1433.20	1452.00	1452.00	1415.20	52.32	1881.35	1403.85	41	1432.80
GRM Overseas	153.19	152.67	154.00	154.40	151.60	1661.85	517.70	151.00	-	-
GRSE	2304.50	2356.80	2318.90	2368.40	2285.80	571.33	3535.00	1303.45	39	2357.95
GSFC [2]	154.46	156.72	154.80	158.11	153.60	854.20	220.75	149.55	9	156.50
GTL Infra	1.03	1.02	1.03	1.06	1.01	40516.34	2.16	0.98	-	1.02
GTPL	56.62	57.66	57.29	58.47	56.70	66.61	133.75	55.22	29	57.20
Guj Fluoro	3078.70	2991.50	3078.70	3078.70	2972.00	114.38	4083.55	2916.60	-	-
Guj Petronet	270.25	265.20	272.00	273.00	263.85	558.66	360.00	264.00	21	265.20
Guj. Alkali	416.40	414.15	416.40	418.05	412.70	40.61	700.00	410.00	89	414.45
Guj. Mineral [2]	532.10	553.10	541.00	559.40	535.10	4702.44	651.45	245.50	27	552.85
Gujarat Amb [1]	126.86	130.10	126.40	131.00	125.66	418.80	149.45	100.05	29	130.10
Gujarat Gas [2]	365.25	361.95	366.00	367.00	357.45	557.91	508.60	356.50	22	362.55
Gujarat Hea	454.75	450.25	454.50	454.90	445.00	457.16	668.00	442.25	8	450.15
Gujarat Kidn	105.87	105.34	106.00	107.65	103.73	127.66	123.00	98.36	-	-
Gujarat Them	277.10	273.05	279.00	287.65	267.50	177.23	479.00	222.05	-	-
GujIndl Pow	129.93	130.33	129.93	131.40	129.57	263.45	224.00	128.00	14	130.10
Gulf oil Lub [2]	973.00	964.90	973.00	973.00	942.00	208.92	1331.20	944.00	13	962.95
Gulf Petro [5]	28.61	28.29	28.94	29.49	28.00	109.58	51.44	28.05	5	28.41
H										
HAL [5]	3913.10	3963.10	3919.70	3971.90	3892.50	992.98	5166.00	3398.00	30	3958.00
Happi.Minds	377.35	380.70	391.80	391.80	374.20	1632.54	674.85	330.20	-	-
HappyForging	1264.00	1286.20	1296.00	1297.90	1261.50	83.48	1370.00	724.10	-	-
Hariom Pipe	305.20	306.00	309.00	319.15	304.80	127.60	572.20	301.15	-	-
HATHWAY C [2]	9.76	9.82	9.80	9.85	9.71	5452.86	17.95	9.57	-	9.83
HATSUN AG [1]	956.75	952.50	954.00	978.00	944.50	16.86	1178.80	731.05	55	954.30
Havell's Ind [1]	1297.30	1317.10	1300.00	1321.80	1291.50	849.52	1673.20	1250.15	54	1318.25
HBL Engg L	656.25	665.10	658.00	669.00	656.45	573.13	1122.00	405.00	-	-
HCG	549.05	551.20	551.95	557.70	546.75	78.93	799.35	489.27	310	550.60
HCL Infosys [2]	11.92	11.79	11.85	12.19	11.75	304.46	24.39	11.50	-	11.89
HCL Tech. [2]	1328.60	1321.10	1328.60	1328.60	1297.70	2285.67	1770.00	1275.70	29	1321.00
HDB FinSer	642.15	644.50	643.00	645.40	640.05	988.11	891.90	633.00	-	-
HDFC Bank [1]	840.60	845.35	847.70	848.90	835.10	38826.98	1020.35	812.00	18	845.85
HDFCAMC [5]	2367.20	2383.40	2379.00	2407.90	2355.50	1214.12	2965.00	1762.53	36	2382.90
HDFCLIFE	626.00	642.30	625.00	645.35	623.30	3465.32	820.50	617.25	73	642.50
HEG [2]	498.60	501.10	500.00	502.80	492.60	511.39	672.20	394.25	34	500.75
HEIDEL CEM	149.49	150.65	149.40	152.20	148.23	57.60	224.60	148.05	24	151.65
Hemisphere	128.78	131.78	129.10	132.39	128.60	465.01	190.69	111.03	-	-
Heranba Ind	171.60	170.92	171.83	177.58	170.00	202.00	403.70	167.00	-	-
HeritageFo [5]	308.80	311.60	308.90	314.25	306.80	236.87	541.60	296.15	20	311.80
Hero Motoc [2]	5278.50	5355.00	5276.50	5384.00	5232.00	403.77	6390.00	3322.60	21	5355.40
HexawareTech	416.95	407.00	420.00	421.00	404.00	706.82	900.00	400.20	-	-
HG Infra	489.10	489.35	487.80	493.00	474.00	350.82	1272.10	471.45	7	490.10
HGSL	362.40	360.00	364.25	365.05	357.25	46.44	628.80	341.60	-	359.70
Highway Infr	49.14	48.69	50.36	50.39	48.40	125.47	131.40	47.47	-	-
Hikal [2]	169.24	169.79	169.15	173.25	168.25	263.87	456.60	166.55	84	170.05
HIMACHAL F [1]	71.27	71.74	71.50	72.18	70.35	10071.34	93.95	59.83	-	71.76
Himadri Sp [1]	440.85	446.95	441.90	450.50	424.80	2055.94	534.35	351.40	31	446.55
Himat.Seide [5]	81.30	80.11	81.70	82.60	79.23	1392.57	168.85	79.12	7	80.24
Hind Rectifi [2]	1456.50	1478.50	1442.00	1512.00	1442.00	23.59	2101.00	817.25	48	1478.25
Hind Uni [1]	2175.70	2158.20	2172.80	2184.80	2145.90	1705.96	2734.31	2105.10	47	2158.50
HIND.CONST [1]	14.93	15.15	15.10	15.36	14.83	22929.48	31.47	14.62	11	15.18
HIND.COPP [5]	477.55	493.15	479.45	495.00	461.80	15297.88	759.20	183.90	72	493.10
Hind.Foods	470.70	478.90	472.00	480.40	468.00	37.44	608.00	421.50	-	-
Hind.oil Exp	126.95	122.76	126.50	131.00	122.25	1493.89	197.80	117.90	9	122.90
Hind.Znc [2]	533.85	546.35	539.00	548.00	534.15	4636.69	732.60	385.05	20	546.50
HINDALCO [1]	921.15	936.65	928.90	942.00	916.35	4862.64	1029.60	546.25	24	936.70
Hindware HME	191.12	188.22	190.00	192.86	187.47	71.46	392.70	180.00	-	-
Hitech Pipes	75.82	75.18	76.05	76.89	74.88	661.26	235.00	117.30	29	139.50
HLE Glascoat	288.45	279.75	291.00	291.55	273.30	254.85	661.95	220.57	-	-
HLV	6.98	7.21	7.00	7.29	7.00	682.27	15.75	6.68	-	-
Home FirstFi	989.20	985.20	993.80	1007.80	982.00	663.25	1519.00	878.40	-	-
Honasa Cons.	265.90	264.05	265.90	267.15	262.10	474.44	334.20	205.01	-	-
HONEYWELL	29305.00	29245.00	29305.00	29760.00	29130.00	2.97	41599.80	29105.00	50	29274.50
HPCL	353.80	346.20	354.15	355.05	340.00	14666.30	508.45	319.75	5	346.20
HPL	273.45	275.15	276.90	280.65	271.95	337.36	639.50	267.00	20	275.65
Hubtown	190.33	185.12	191.10	192.00	180.00	1814.83	366.00	149.90	21	184.80
HUDCO	172.12	172.49	173.80	174.30	169.90	3060.25	253.80	167.60	12	172.55
Huhtamaki In	160.84	162.46	161.80	163.14	159.49	128.92	272.65	156.67	-	-
HyundaiMotor	1963.90	1971.20	1963.90	1982.70	1933.30	327.97	2890.00	1541.70	-	-
I										
ICE Make Ref	794.55	814.45	800.10	817.60	790.20	25.18	1088.75	666.30	-	-
ICICI Bank [2]	1272.90	1288.70	1278.90	1294.40	1273.00	22303.10	1494.10	1240.15	19	1288.95
ICICI PRUD AMC	2884.00	2963.00	2880.00	3008.60	2826.00	948.32	3193.00	2530.00	-	-
ICICIGI	1850.50	1835.80	1850.50	1863.80	1829.40	623.48	2074.85	1660.20	34	1833.85
ICICIPruLife	583.90	592.45	583.00	601.10	581.30	633.22	706.50	517.00	62	592.45
IDBI	76.90	74.10	77.70	77.89	73.31	49230.15	118.45	72.04	8	74.05
IDEA CELL	9.39	9.25	9.46	9.50	9.21	435075.96	12.80	6.12	-	9.25
Ideaforge	392.50	438.75	395.00	460.30	385.95	11253.33	659.85	304.20	-	-
IDFCFirstBnk	62.81	63.66	63.10	63.84	62.39	21678.02	87.00	52.46	-	-
IEX [1]	118.80	119.88	119.35	120.80	118.76	4736.13	215.40	117.15	23	119.90
IFB	972.80	1001.40	974.80	1010.40	970.90	158.95	2024.90	962.65	31	1000.40
IFB Agro	683.35	683.30	683.35	697.45	679.80	17.44	1795.00	441.00	12	684.80
IFCI	55.73	55.02	55.98	56.19	54.72	13321.21	74.50	35.67	49	55.05
IG Petro	333.70	353.90	335.80	374.70	328.40	117.88	519.00	317.80	157	352.65
Igarshi Mot	306.50	310.00	306.60	314.85	305.75	38.87	665.45	301.00	72	308.10
IIFL [2]	475.45	471.55	475.00	475.90	462.60	1367.49	674.95	305.55	29	471.75
IIFL Capital	280.85	280.85	281.60	287.15	279.35	233.70	411.30	180.00	-	-
IKIO Light.	120.72	118.46	118.58	124.20	117.21	239.29	304.00	117.21	-	-
Imagica Wrld	39.53	40.05	40.00	41.00	39.71	655.11	75.55	37.62	-	-
Ind Glycols [5]	857.90	853.50	856.00	868.00	849.60	61.55	1222.85	502.50	26	854.65
Ind.Inv.Tru	131.09	132.14	129.30	136.79	126.10	18.17	265.80	121.40	51	131.35
Ind.Shelt.Fi	702.65	694.25	699.00	701.90	690.00	132.46	1011.75	650.00	-	-
Indegene	435.30	431.75	436.15	437.60	429.60	530.16	632.90	423.00	-	-
IndHumPip [2]	313.05	318.45	316.20	327.60	315.50	34.78	490.00	295.00	16	317.60
India Nippon [5]	753.40	751.15	759.60	767.05	744.00	16.12	1099.95	545.20	17	750.05
India Pesti.	140.85	138.15	141.90	141.90	137.80	116.96	245.84	123.11	-	-
Indiabulls	9.99	9.85	10.00	10.10	9.58	10872.39	21.25	8.90	-	-
IndiaCements	355.20	358.35	357.00	364.00	352.60	172.22	489.65	252.55	-	358.25
IndiaMart In	2108.00	2065.70	2117.80	2117.80	2049.90	353.12	2799.00	1900.10	-	-
Indian Bank	877.45	873.95	885.00	885.00	860.00	1399.47	1000.00	490.15	10	874.05
Indian Htl [1]	613.35	622.05	615.00	624.95	608.00	2270.60	858.85	595.00	56	621.30
INDIAN MET	1190.20	1255.70	1199.40	1267.80	1193.40	127.09	1511.05	550.85	18	1254.90
IndianOilCo	148.96	146.68	149.00	149.80	145.51	19101.79	188.90	120.05	6	146.65
IndianOverBk	32.21	32.07	32.50	32.54	31.91	4865.11	45.19	31.58	13	32.07
IndiaTour De	426.05	426.45	427.10	430.90	422.20	21.57	714.05	421.00	45	427.25
IndigoPaints	757.70	757.60	760.00	775.45	745.00	302.04	1345.90	745.00	-	-
IndiqubeSpac	142.53	138.66	144.65	145.49	136.25	94.43	243.80	136.25	-	-
Indo Amines	92.95	91.49	93.45	93.45	90.65	78.51	176.25	90.65	-	-
INDO COU [2]	233.25	232.35	235.00	235.75	230.60	140.44	350.70	210.70	40	232.30
Indo Farm Eq	124.17	125.88	124.30	127.97	124.17	135.29	271.69	122.00	-	-
Indo Rama	31.95	31.95	32.20	32.48	30.91	386.20	74.94	29.10	7	32.00
INDO THAI [1]	255.75	259.10	255.75	264.90	254.00	400.30	470.00	144.00	87	258.85
IndogulfCrop	59.58	57.84	59.59	59.59	57.00	264.68	122.00	57.00	-	-
INDOSTAR	195.61	196.90	195.00	198.58	195.00	56.25	368.55	185.10	-	196.60
IndoTech Tra	1247.20	1287.90	1253.40	1317.50	1240.10	40.36	2790.15	1138.95	15	1285.85
Indrapra Gas [2]	155.49	156.82	156.00	157.36	155.01	1226.76	229.20	152.10	15	156.80
Indraprastha	391.60	388.65	391.75	392.75	386.50	145.20	640.05	317.25	20	388.85
IndSwifLab	137.14	145.87	137.42	148.90	136.99	606.37	151.95	67.15	27	146.00
IndusInd BK	825.05	820.85	825.00	825.00	808.00	3713.24	968.60	618.05	-	821.50
IndusTowers	427.10	436.15	429.45	439.00	427.30	3131.17	481.50	312.55	-	-
INFO EDGE [2]	949.60	963.10	949.60	973.40	930.50	2216.15	1549.00	931.00	57	960.85
Infobeans Te	134.22	131.87	134.22	134.89	128.32	464.49	1030.00	120.33	-	-
INFOSYS [5]	1249.80	1232.90	1245.00	1245.00	1215.10	11223.28	1727.85	1215.15	17	1232.50
Ingersoll	3647.60	3621.40	3649.80	3691.90	3570.00	5.69	4449.95	3070.00	41	3625.95
Innova Cap	707.00	709.85	707.00	722.35	701.00	20.81	1020.70	622.00	-	-
Inox Grn Enr	141.11	139.37	141.11	142.79	137.36	998.88	279.00	104.00	-	-
Inox India	1144.40	1152.50	1143.70	1187.30	1142.50	83.57	1288.00	892.25	-	-
Inox Wind	78.40	78.21	79.00	79.20	77.26	9484.62	198.14	77.20	21	78.19
INSECTCID	569.30	566.05	572.30	575.45	565.00	45.80	1096.30	531.60	12	566.00
INSOLATION EN	91.97	93.20	92.89	96.20	92.40	620.69	104.90	91.11	-	-
INTELLECT [5]	645.20	642.65	654.20	659.80	640.40	499.22	1255.00	555.05	39	642.85
INTENS T [2]	86.19	83.81	89.50	89.50	83.14	55.69	149.90	79.10	-	84.50
InterarchBui	1716.60	1724.20	1729.00	1737.90	1701.00	63.31	2762.60	1264.00	-	-
InterGlobeAv	4222.10	4287.90	4246.00	4306.00	4208.70	1076.80	6225.05	4035.65	37	4287.75
Intl Convey.	70.34	70.08	71.08	71.88	69.16	184.25	114.54	64.50	-	-
Intl Gemm In	306.15	324.15	307.05	329.45	305.15	2646.36	442.00	287.00	-	-
Inventu Know	1330.60	1327.50	1341.20	1341.20	1316.50	136.58	1876.00	1236.80	-	-
IOL Chem [2]	68.66	68.21	68.67	69.69	68.00	1298.09	126.60	57.51	16	68.21
Ion Exch	340.75	328.90	342.00	342.00	328.00	352.07	580.75	322.10	-	-
Ipca Lab [1]	1557.00	1565.30	1569.90	1624.00	1545.50	496.28	1624.00	1200.00	40	1567.30
IRB INFRA [1]	41.36	41.52	41.30	42.08	41.15	8072.46	54.38	36.99	28	41.56
IRCON	125.83	126.52	127.00	127.50	124.27	3015.82	225.52	123.71	-	-
IREDA	115.19	116.20	115.95	116.70	114.00	6073.56	186.58	112.07	-	-
IRFC	96.44	96.74	96.45	97.23	95.74	9737.32	148.95	94.32	-	-
IRM Energy	200.56	198.16	204.60	204.60	197.20	166.30	393.00	185.00	-	-
IRTC	526.45	526.95	529.85	529.85	522.00	1317.27	820.25	518.25	-	-
ISGEC Hvy	887.40	893.50	888.00	907.40	882.85	67.53	1281.30	683.95	-	-
ITC [1]	308.25	304.85	309.95	309.95	304.05	25649.30	444.15	300.10	19	304.95
ITC Hotels	154.74	150.78	154.41	154.89	150.05	6584.98	261.62	146.25	-	-
ITI	277.15	275.25	293.15	297.70	270.00	40480.69	372.95	232.90	-	275.10
Ixigo	161.97	163.60	161.10	165.06	161.10	1046.33	339.15	123.29	-	-
J										
J KUMAR INF [5]	495.35	491.55	499.80	501.00	488.55	105.50	764.00	454.50	9	490.50
J&K Bank [1]	123.66	121.10	124.20	124.20	119.13	7246.55	128.45	82.01	6	121.10
J.K.INDURI [2]	418.40	420.60	420.00	421.90	411.20	897.78	611.60	231.65	17	421.25
Jagran Prak [2]	61.32	61.26	61.70	61.94	60.48	171.24	83.99	60.10	5	61.41
Jagson Phar [2]	183.72	185.08	184.50	190.00	182.20	290.49	301.80	154.90	29	185.05
Jai Corp [1]	96.48	97.83	96.80	98.60	96.08	309.59	178.00	81.27	10	97.95
JaiBalaj.Ind	62.74	63.27	63.50	65.27	62.06	3175.36	668.00	81.00	-	-
JAIN IRRIG [2]	31.25	30.01	31.68	31.72	29.60	4359.20	66.40	29.75	-	30.07
Jain Resourc	424.85	427.10	424.85	430.85	418.50	1238.94	461.00	247.57	-	-
Jamna Aut [1]	118.89	119.71	118.90	120.35	115.81	2596.72	152.50	70.00	20	119.55
Jana SFB	348.35	343.25	348.35	353.00	342.00	319.79	552.50	333.60	-	-
Jaro InsofT	462.50	471.35	481.00	494.70	466.50	856.65	890.00	386.00	-	-
Jash Engg	366.15	371.75	369.10	374.10	364.00	135.39	698.95	351.10	-	-
JAY NECO IND	70.69	72.74	71.14	73.77	71.00	3060.86	94.30	26.06	18	72.80
JayBh Maru [2]	86.09	84.63	86.55	87.22	84.20	194.93	115.63	55.32	11	84.95
Jaykay Enter	125.83	131.56	127.72	133.15	126.20	150.34	219.70	122.89	-	-
JB Chem [1]	2090.20	2104.00	2099.00	2119.40	2083.10	378.00	2171.40	1303.00	46	2103.35
JBM Auto [1]	486.20	492.20	488.75	498.50	488.10	254.13	790.00	477.00	72	492.30
JeenaSikhoLi	585.85	596.20	582.00	601.45	582.00	217.95	2450.00	400.25	-	-
JG Chem.	330.65	331.25	331.00	333.00	327.15	31.63	558.00	280.45	-	-
JIN POLY INV	1229.70	1205.00	1230.90	1262.40	1198.60	60.46	1480.00	621.15	1	1206.65
Jindal Drill [5]	474.20	464.90	465.00	477.95	461.50	360.00	981.00	440.00	7	466.10
Jindal Poly	924.50	969.85	932.10	970.70	929.40	479.93	972.00	359.90	17	971.30
Jindal Saw [1]	196.67	200.16	199.40	202.53	196.01	5420.46	286.50	153.20	11	200.50
JINDAL SOUTH	16241.00	16675.00	16241.00	17144.00	15962.00	3.60	27760.50	15284.00	154	16681.65
Jindal Sta [2]	709.90	730.85	707.45	735.80	694.15	974.05	883.25	497.00	22	731.10
Jindal Ste [1]	1133.00	1157.30	1135.90	1160.70	1128.00	809.03	1270.00	770.00	27	1157.10
Jindal Wor [1]	20.63	20.94	20.64	21.00	20.44	416.83	79.32	20.25	-	20.86
JindalPho	1177.70	1190.50	1170.10	1223.60	1170.10	7.55	1634.80	592.35	285	1192.50
JioFin Servi	234.35	237.60	235.00	238.70	234.35	10638.09	338.60	203.10	-	-
JK Cement	5061.00	5117.00	5058.00	5161.00	5044.00	39.55	7565.00	4225.00	36	5118.60
JK Lakshmi [5]	583.75	601.90	584.00	603.35	581.10	177.74	1020.85	575.00	16	601.80
JK PAPER	326.00	320.75	327.45	328.00	317.10	186.62	444.45	288.00	24	320.70
JM Financial [1]	119.30	119.98	119.80	122.35	117.17	3278.48	199.75	78.00	14	119.80
JNK India	243.12	242.54	242.95	245.00	238.12	106.85	419.55	200.92	-	-
JPPOWER	13.50	13.98	14.04	14.50	13.40	77350.66	27.62	12.60	-	13.98
JSW Cement	116.46	116.51	117.00	117.80	115.75	2016.82	162.15	106.65	-	-
JSW energy	505.15	505.80	505.15	512.50	500.95	1767.09	578.85	428.00	99	505.65
JSW Infra	250.40	252.95	255.20	258.90	252.00	1200.23	349.00	243.00	-	-
JSWSL [1]	1145.60	1167.20	1147.00	1169.30	1139.20	1760.48	1284.55	907.25	40	1167.05
JTL Indus.	52.26	51.42	52.90	53.00	50.99	1297.25	85.99	50.16	-	-
Jub.Ingrevia	550.05	564.65	553.00	566.50	548.40	272.76	851.80	535.20	-	-
Jub.Pharmova	839.95	837.70	839.95	846.95	828.00	137.67	1248.00	786.05	-	-
JUBL FOOD [2]	467.80	465.75	467.80	471.55	460.10	1940.59	743.95	448.50	126	465.75
Juniper Hot	203.31	202.29	204.90	205.18	201.00	62.04	345.55	193.74	-	-
Jupiter Life	1272.00	1259.30	1281.50	1281.50	1252.60	5.81	1770.00	1198.80	-	-
Jupiter Wag	262.30	264.45	265.90	267.05	260.15	1113.20	457.00	246.20	-	-
JUSTDIAL	517.30	512.45	523.80	523.80	509.15	181.75	1049.85	509.80	8	512.75
JYOTHY LAB [1]	214.90	210.80	215.25	215.85	210.00	620.10	399.95	210.00	22	210.60
Jyoti CNC Au	705.70	748.45	711.95	774.80	709.90	12082.83	1330.00	686.75	-	-
Jyoti Struct [2]	10.49	10.48	10.53	10.77	10.37	12617.49	22.19	7.92	-	10.50
K										
K.P.R. MILL [1]	826.10	826.55	831.70	839.30	818.15	210.44	1395.40	796.05	48	826.85
Kajaria Cere [1]	888.90	916.95	888.90	925.25	874.20	382.55	1322.00	745.00	41	917.30
Kalpataru Lt	295.70	299.80	308.70	325.00	296.10	618.79	457.40	286.00	-	-
KalpataruPro	1088.10	1053.90	1101.90	1140.00	1037.00	907.51	1335.60	786.30	-	-
Kalyan Jwl.	381.60	383.70	381.50	384.50	375.60	2113.69	617.70	347.50	-	-
KALYANI ST [5]	649.10	654.40	653.90	661.95	645.20	21.18	988.00	636.95	11	654.15
KAMDHENU [1]	21.89	21.74	22.00	22.00	21.65	373.87	35.96	20.50	8	21.79
Kansai Nero [1]	177.43	173.72	178.00	178.53	173.50	369.38	274.80	173.25	21	173.70
Karnataka Bk	217.70	226.15	219.50	227.00	215.50	3586.97	232.85	163.10	7	226.00
KarurVysya [2]	284.60	284.00	287.95	287.95	280.55	1757.92	343.55	155.29	12	284.30
KAVERI SEED [2]	810.15	798.75	822.30	822.30	795.00	67.51	1601.85	705.80	15	796.90
KAYA L	306.20	295.65	310.00	310.00	289.90	54.00	486.90	213.50	-	297.75
KaynesTech	3555.00	3634.90	3570.00	3651.90	3536.10	1217.77	7705.00	3294.90	-	-
KCP [1]	140.43	142.84	142.20	145.50	138.02	273.25	229.80	136.60	19	142.15
KDDL	2170.60	2172.50	2203.20	2203.20	2165.00	9.69	3350.00	2067.25	41	2170.85
KEC Inter [2]	534.60	539.30	537.50	545.60	535.00	519.10	947.30	517.90	38	539.35
KEI Inds [2]	4174.00	4216.50	4200.00	4237.00	4110.50	287.49	5301.10	2443.70	47	4212.80
KELLTONT [1]	16.45	16.40	16.70	16.70	16.02	1505.79	33.10	14.57	-	16.44
Kernex Micro	938.60	936.90	932.70	958.00	932.70	109.77	1433.95	625.55	32	938.20
Kewal Kiran	450.20	441.95	452.60	459.35	440.05	58.57	594.35	422.15	21	444.10
Keystone Rlt	379.20	382.80	381.40	386.60	374.35	35.97	697.00	371.00	-	-
KFIN Tech	901.35	900.95	914.35	914.35	892.00	1035.93	1388.50	828.80	-	-
KHADIM	96.94	94.90	98.00	98.79	93.25	94.55	310.70	93.00	18	93.60
Khaitan Chm	50.13	49.19	50.14	50.68	48.80	193.11	135.80	43.17	-	-
Kilos oil [2]	1470.20	1441.60	1468.00	1468.00	1431.40	232.02	1529.40	585.75	45	1440.75
KIMS	646.10	658.50	644.40	662.10	640.80	109.87	798.40	528.05	-	-
KIOCL	296.90	314.85	299.80	322.00	296.75	61.62	634.35	188.15	-	315.15
KIRI DYES	381.15	384.50	383.20	390.95	377.90	349.54	778.00	370.40	86	384.40
KIRL.BROS. [2]	1518.40	1517.80	1500.10	1534.90	1498.10	59.03	2475.55	1405.65	46	1519.50
Kirlosk.Elec	78.51	79.18	79.69	80.50	78.00	177.24	100.80	26.95	15	-
Kirlosk.Pne	1053.80	1050.70	1059.00	1066.80	1043.10	35.13	1550.00	990.10	-	-
KITEX GARM [1]	159.65	160.78	161.80	164.66	158.00	612.07	320.95	138.45	44	160.75
Knowledg.Mar	1538.80	1548.60	1574.70	1574.70	1510.10	98.78	3758.50	1264.05	-	-
KNR CONST [2]	120.77	118.82	120.49	121.41	118.00	1020.74	254.15	117.10	19	118.85
KOHINORF	22.90	22.44	23.50	23.50	22.12	134.68	46.00	22.24	-	22.66
KOLTEPATIL	330.30	326.60	329.50	336.40	324.35	122.19	497.80	310.00	91	328.40
Kopran Ltd	113.47	113.56	113.50	116.64	112.64	218.74	244.65	111.55	27	114.10
Kotak Mah [1]	369.85	374.20	369.85	375.15	368.60	15176.77	460.31	363.45	28	374.30
KP Energy	277.45	273.00	278.50	282.80	269.90	257.63	583.70	237.90	-	-
KPI Grn Enr	380.30	381.90	381.00	394.20	374.10	1657.83	541.00	335.65	-	-
KPIT Tech	631.95	653.70	635.00	656.10	624.90	2692.24	1434.50	624.90	-	-
KRBL [1]	290.35	283.65	292.65	292.65	280.00	804.16	495.00	225.70	10	283.90
Krishana Ph.	474.35	474.40	479.95	481.00	471.15	25.68	1050.00	210.00	-	-
Krishna def	930.90	922.50	938.00	943.80	865.20	365.75	1240.00	530.10	-	-
Kritika Wire	5.18	5.51	5.28	5.75	5.20	504.87	11.22	4.82	-	-
KRN Heat Ex.	850.25	863.35	854.00	874.00	839.55	734.38	1031.80	589.80	-	-
Kronox Lab	110.84	113.77	112.00	117.58	110.01	280.01	207.49	105.50	-	-
Kross	181.21	182.16	183.85	188.00	180.75	98.09	237.60	150.06	-	-
Krsnaa Dia.	599.65	597.30	599.15	616.05	586.50	83.24	994.60	579.15	-	-
KSB	752.60	761.10	758.60	765.65	745.25	130.64	912.00	647.80	-	-
KSH Internat	406.40	409.75	405.05	416.70	397.85	204.96	420.00	330.00	-	-
KSolves Ind	271.55	268.80	273.20	281.00	265.00	37.73	497.00	250.05	-	-
KWALITY WALL'S	24.23	24.25	24.58	24.92	24.10	1029.44	31.29	23.95	-	-
L										
L & T [2]	3469.40	3542.80	3478.00	3550.00	3450.00	5003.42	4440.00	2967.65	43	3543.10
L&T Finance	260.65	263.15	262.85	263.70	256.40	5303.71	329.45	138.64	-	-
Lal path lab	1341.00	1331.70	1337.00	1347.90	1323.90	327.29	1771.00	1187.50	42	1333.10
Landmark Car	359.90	355.55	362.80	368.70	352.30	60.91	662.00	329.80	-	-
LA-OPALA [2]	186.89	190.84	187.00	192.39	187.00	53.11	286.00	182.50	20	190.40
Latent View	280.85	275.95	282.75	285.50	274.75	945.21	517.50	273.65	-	-
Laurus Labs [2]	960.80	968.70	962.90	977.00	962.00	1160.68	1140.00	517.05	65	968.25
Laxmi Organ.	116.68	115.21	116.98	118.94	114.60	600.31	241.00	110.15	-	-
LaxmiDent	172.72	172.49	175.10	176.18	171.37	63.46	509.95	171.20	-	-
LaxmiIndFin	79.43	80.68	80.62	82.00	79.44	139.95	180.00	77.82	-	-
Le Merite Ex	440.60	460.50	447.60	465.00	443.00	85.27	537.85	280.00	-	-
LEMONTREE	103.02	106.94	103.00	108.14	101.55	8740.84	180.60	99.70	73	106.95
Lenskart Sol	498.70	501.15	498.05	508.60	496.75	1060.52	541.80	356.10	-	-
LG Balkrish	1749.00	1776.00	1749.00	1796.40	1728.00	28.17	2096.95	1080.00	19	1775.65
LG Electroni	1537.30	1564.20	1549.90	1583.70	1544.00	411.70	1749.00	1325.50	-	-
LIC	777.35	777.75	780.95	782.45	775.35	693.00	980.00	737.70	-	-
LIC Housing [2]	501.50	498.90	499.25	503.85	488.60	1890.81	646.80	488.60	5	498.75
Lincoln Phar	584.30	602.30	582.00	605.00	574.00	38.48	679.45	439.95	14	600.75
LINDEINDIA	7172.50	7327.00	7230.00	7393.50	7122.50	94.46	7865.05	5202.45	107	7321.20
Lloyds Engg	41.30	42.06	41.51	42.99	40.81	4377.70	84.27	40.44	-	-
Lloyds Met.	1147.20	1236.30	1153.10	1242.00	1151.20	1493.75	1612.00	1105.10	-	-
LNC	100.09	97.84	101.50	101.50	96.00	45.93	160.74	95.11	-	-
Lokesh Machi	203.60	199.80	203.51	208.45	197.50	54.39	225.95	129.25	-	199.60
Looyds Ent.	45.88	45.56	45.88	46.75	44.00	5013.81	96.40	37.28	-	-
LT Foods	383.60	389.60	387.00	392.05	383.00	703.10	518.55	288.25	-	-
LTIMINDTREE	4207.10	4189.20	4229.00	4229.00	4108.10	203.28	6429.50	3802.00	-	-
LTTS [2]	3324.90	3332.70	3320.00	3384.20	3266.60	272.69	4750.00	3046.85	28	3334.55
Lumax Ind	4902.00	5068.00	4949.50	5140.00	4891.50	21.94	6969.90	2150.00	31	5036.80
Lumax Tech [2]	1452.40	1562.10	1472.60	1579.00	1451.00	474.42	1823.75	452.55	121	1561.40
Lupin Ltd. [2]	2290.40	2298.20	2306.00	2312.20	2285.40	723.71	2376.00	1774.00	19	2298.25
LUXIND [2]	867.40	859.80	867.00	878.90	845.20	65.07	1640.00	805.05	23	860.00
Lyka Labs	53.14	51.58	53.08	53.80	50.47	104.60	128.60	51.00	-	51.63
M										
M&M FinSer [2]	319.55	319.80	320.05	323.00	315.00	1798.11	412.30	235.46	17	319.80
Macpower CNC	891.75	869.95	905.15	920.00	860.00	28.29	1090.00	601.20	-	-
Macrotech Dev.	848.75	842.20	860.00	860.30	835.00	1466.26	1531.00	831.95	-	-
Madhya Bh.Ag	449.30	449.60	449.95	461.80	444.95	376.72	489.45	240.00	-	-
Magellanic	21.78	22.16	22.00	22.35	21.56	738.65	105.65	21.20	-	-
MAH HOLIDAY	264.05	262.65	261.10	265.40	259.30	93.04	381.55	241.00	21	262.90
Mah Logis	375.65	375.25	373.60	378.30	369.55	122.95	435.35	218.20	100	375.70
Mah&Mah [5]	3036.10	3128.90	3052.00	3139.30	3024.50	3491.89	3840.00	2360.45	25	3130.50
Mah.seamle [5]	559.90	557.85	559.90	560.90	549.95	323.26	774.00	500.00	9	558.45
Maheshwa.Log	42.59	44.60	42.71	47.94	41.13	171.34	65.00	39.04	-	-
MAHINDRALIFE	342.80	344.15	340.25	349.45	340.25	94.21	453.00	253.81	100	344.50
Maithan All	898.00	919.10	907.40	925.85	897.60	33.87	1265.00	834.05	6	916.60
MamataMach	377.20	384.35	378.55	385.00	377.00	31.21	541.00	311.55	-	-
Man ind [5]	396.45	396.40	399.90	399.00	390.00	193.86	490.90	248.15	18	396.60
Man Infra [2]	93.01	89.87	93.05	94.90	88.92	1251.40	191.90	89.05	23	89.95
Manakasia [5]	52.84	49.46	52.84	53.61	49.00	133.31	85.73	49.05	24	49.92
Manali Petro [5]	44.68	44.20	44.68	45.60	43.90	255.90	81.00	43.82	-	44.31
Manappura [2]	251.20	256.85	251.45	260.55	249.70	7837.94	320.95	204.30	14	256.75
MandB Eng	286.65	280.75	290.95	291.75	280.00	104.61	535.90	270.00	-	-
Mangal Cred.	167.62	169.28	168.03	173.90	164.05	91.11	215.75	145.00	-	-
Mangalam Cem	792.80	815.45	795.05	821.00	786.30	53.49	939.90	640.00	28	816.05
MangalElec	233.04	230.57	232.90	233.56	229.00	66.92	573.70	222.16	-	-
Mankind Phr	2094.70	2068.20	2095.80	2106.40	2056.00	449.93	2716.50	2012.30	-	-
ManojValiDem	150.59	147.93	148.00	149.90	146.90	56.51	280.00	145.13	-	-
Manomay Tex	218.64	210.79	221.92	221.92	203.20	102.53	259.88	154.10	-	-
Manorama Ind	1299.20	1303.60	1295.50	1326.10	1286.30	79.93	1760.00	849.95	-	-
Marath N [5]	381.30	392.20	378.90	399.70	377.10	587.74	530.00	341.05	15	390.40
MARICOLTD [1]	750.10	754.75	750.10	757.50	742.80	1054.60	813.10	602.85	51	755.15
Marine Elec.	174.46	176.22	174.46	178.99	173.50	228.44	258.00	151.00	-	-
MarkolinePav	153.45	156.23	153.76	158.15	153.20	177.15	188.00	131.65	-	-
MARKSANS [1]	164.76	163.97	164.76	166.00	163.50	461.44	270.60	157.25	30	164.10
MARSONS	133.24	133.15	133.90	139.59	131.51	650.87	152.00	131.51	-	-
Maruti Udy [5]	12757.00	12972.00	12790.00	13100.00	12686.00	113.94	17371.60	11207.20	28	12993.55
MASFIN	294.40	294.65	295.90	298.90	288.20	155.10	354.95	230.35	15	295.25
Mastek [5]	1470.40	1460.30	1478.10	1495.60	1438.50	218.03	2817.75	1439.00	24	1461.80
MATRIMONY [5]	393.35	417.70	399.25	423.20	388.05	59.52	598.95	365.30	27	418.20
Max Estate	362.10	365.00	363.80	368.00	356.10	357.67	564.30	341.10	-	-
Max Healthca	970.60	976.40	976.70	987.70	969.00	2641.46	1314.30	933.80	-	-
Max India	142.22	142.88	145.47	146.96	141.37	46.89	241.67	138.60	-	-
MAYUR UNI [5]	502.05	503.90	508.95	509.00	500.00	33.38	629.30	434.90	12	504.05
Mazagon Dock	2331.80	2362.30	2340.00	2373.50	2308.40	1335.16	3775.00	2125.90	-	-
MBL INFRA	22.01	21.87	22.20	22.40	21.13	827.65	56.90	21.00	-	21.99
MCLEOD RU [5]	35.32	35.41	35.79	36.54	35.03	1069.34	68.73	29.65	-	35.48
MCX [2]	2555.60	2671.80	2579.90	2681.00	2570.00	4027.32	2706.00	905.35	94	2671.35
Medi Assist	312.35	319.10	312.80	322.35	310.05	188.06	504.20	294.70	-	-
Medplus Hlth	825.75	820.05	825.95	829.60	818.10	87.79	1045.30	678.05	-	-
Meesho	134.77	145.73	135.90	148.24	132.88	13901.72	254.40	125.56	-	-
MeghamaniOrg	41.85	41.54	41.85	42.41	41.31	588.41	106.30	41.25	-	-
Menon Bear [1]	123.01	126.99	122.00	128.00	122.00	43.25	145.20	73.00	27	126.60
Metro Brand	911.20	920.40	911.20	932.30	892.80	93.05	1340.40	892.80	-	-
METROPOL [2]	1839.40	1858.00	1848.00	1861.00	1813.00	32.57	2259.30	1383.70	67	1857.00
MFL	61.85	62.30	61.50	63.34	61.50	92.74	109.10	55.13	-	-
MFSL [2]	1645.20	1654.00	1637.00	1670.90	1621.50	459.17	1891.35	1032.90	-	1656.70
MGL	1010.20	1016.10	1005.00	1026.10	1004.00	178.57	1586.00	990.00	10	1015.80
MIC Electr.	32.11	33.19	32.15	33.49	32.01	2058.21	82.37	31.81	-	-
Midhani	306.00	320.65	308.20	327.00	305.30	746.82	468.40	217.05	55	320.05
Midwest Ltd	1181.70	1221.70	1181.80	1242.00	1173.10	40.08	1859.90	1048.50	-	-
MINDACORP [2]	481.30	489.35	483.50	495.00	477.00	165.51	646.15	445.25	57	488.85
MindTeck(I)	168.91	172.89	169.70	175.28	167.95	59.19	307.00	141.00	25	171.55
MINERAL&M [1]	52.55	53.26	52.60	53.50	52.34	1153.10	82.20	42.55	-	53.18
Mirc Elect [1]	22.47	22.58	22.88	23.36	21.30	36.60	37.46	20.15	-	22.80
MM Forgings	427.00	427.40	427.45	444.50	423.15	39.19	500.00	276.05	20	428.45
Mnkcmil Ltd [1]	112.64	112.91	113.49	115.15	112.06	231.38	182.00	71.56	29	113.40
MOIL	280.50	297.65	281.60	299.70	280.15	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	41	297.90
MOLDTKPA [5]	496.90	492.55	494.00	497.95	475.00	67.56	890.00	415.00	24	491.45
Monarch Netw	265.00	266.40	265.00	268.00	261.35	51.74	398.80	239.85	-	-
Morepen Lab [2]	37.75	38.06	38.00	38.50	37.42	2024.28	70.40	33.47	37	38.06
Moschip Tech	165.23	168.33	165.55	169.19	163.53	1049.36	288.45	129.98	-	-
Mothersn Sum	39.15	38.72	39.50	39.50	38.20	1815.05	44.70	30.66	-	-
MOTILALOFS [1]	669.95	680.70	683.30	691.65	667.50	1152.60	1097.00	487.85	42	681.90
Motisons Jwl	12.98	12.92	13.00	13.14	12.82	1677.25	24.02	10.62	-	-
MPHASIS	2081.10	2074.10	2087.80	2101.20	2030.50	640.52	3035.15	2025.05	28	2073.80
MPS	1498.70	1511.90	1499.20	1530.00	1482.20	49.76	3071.85	1340.00	22	1512.00
MRF	132495.00	132750.00	133695.00	133695.00	134280.00	12.20	162500.00	105059.80	25	132593.70
MRPL	206.77	200.36	208.22	212.00	198.67	192.30	238.79	144.76	25	200.60
Mrs.Bect.Fd	180.34	182.27	182.00	184.57	180.61	350.05	1654.00	174.38	-	-
MSP Stl	29.94	30.61	30.12	30.90	29.85	1182.20	59.00	23.56	-	30.53
MSTC	405.70	412.10	412.00	423.95	402.00	119.59	582.45	393.45	-	-
MTAR Tech	3438.20	3625.50	3488.00	3650.00	3452.00	438.07	3920.00	1155.60	-	-
MTNL	24.63	24.23	25.00	25.09	24.00	1170.67	56.40	24.20	-	24.30
MufinGreen	100.07	103.32	101.91	104.90	98.25	1280.87	126.34	63.11	-	-
Mukand Ltd	117.52	126.79	117.01	127.97	116.68	235.69	160.85	84.64	18	126.70
Muthoot Fin	3361.60	3419.20	3370.20	3428.00	3330.40	627.32	4149.00	1965.00	16	3420.65
Muthoot MFin	145.46	148.36	145.40	149.89	144.30	95.85	199.39	119.25	-	-
N										
N C L IND.	170.72	174.79	170.10	178.94	170.00	81.27	239.20	165.60	12	174.85
NagarAgri [1]	115.93	120.98	116.40	121.72	114.10	605.01	309.41	80.73	-	120.95
Nandan Den [1]	2.25	2.26	2.25	2.33	2.22	3247.55	4.41	2.21	-	2.25
Nandani Crea	30.26	30.14	30.77	31.28	29.81	67.25	54.59	26.00	-	-
Natco Pha [2]	946.15	942.90	948.05	956.00	926.45	508.30	1059.60	660.05	11	943.35
NATIONAL FER	68.60	68.97	69.01	69.60	67.90	1998.96	112.11	67.17	23	68.95
NationalA [5]	372.25	395.15	377.00	396.80	371.05	19748.71	431.40	140.00	12	395.25
Nava	538.15	551.30	544.00	553.60	536.35	214.75	735.00	396.30	-	-
Navin Fluori [2]	6171.50	6282.00	6232.00	6318.00	6180.00	154.37	6460.00	3664.55	73	6296.05
NAVKARCORP	83.90	83.43	84.06	84.59	82.25	318.03	140.35	78.60	-	82.92
Navneet Edu [2]	127.28	127.60	126.78	130.52	126.78	189.64	168.00	115.25	12	127.90
Nazara Tech	232.60	239.30	233.55	240.70	231.15	474.98	1453.00	220.10	-	-
NBCC [1]	82.18	83.13	83.14	84.08	81.75	3880.28	130.70	80.60	-	83.11
NCC [2]	141.84	143.22	143.22	145.06	139.85	3420.52	242.00	136.00	14	142.95
NDR AutoComp	649.10	665.55	641.55	669.60	640.00	22.87	1120.00	572.85	-	-
NDTV [4]	71.66	72.17	71.66	73.00	71.11	69.36	138.20	70.90	-	71.67
NELCAST [2]	120.16	120.02	120.00	122.65	118.45	226.90	180.65	78.00	22	120.40
Nelco Ltd.	592.10	591.45	592.65	597.20	584.00	95.31	1160.95	572.00	-	-
Neogen Chem	1389.60	1359.20	1399.70	1399.70	1352.60	19.67	1660.75	966.00	-	-
Nephrocare	526.80	515.25	524.20	539.10	508.00	54.88	616.00	446.00	-	-
NESCO [2]	1021.70	1045.40	1023.00	1066.60	1018.50	32.99	1638.85	867.00	18	1045.00
NESTLE (I) [1]	1213.40	1206.90	1213.40	1225.00	1201.60	973.91	1339.85	1055.00	73	1206.30
Netweb Tech	3226.60	3304.40	3254.00	3332.00	3208.20	1136.48	4479.00	1251.55	-	-
Network18 [5]	30.64	30.62	30.61	31.17	30.44	3839.63	65.31	30.00	-	30.66
NetworkPeoSR	878.60	932.90	875.00	949.00	875.00	63.52	2312.75	846.60	-	-
Neuland Lab	12233.00	12273.00	12399.00	12477.00	12050.00	12.03	19748.80	10050.00	88	12273.30
Newgen Soft	451.20	445.00	455.95	459.00	434.50	1614.68	1379.15	434.75	21	444.05
Neyveli Lig	257.00	262.25	257.85	265.00	256.00	1813.37	292.35	202.05	19	262.25
NH	1640.10	1657.60	1651.60	1666.60	1620.00	25.09	2100.00	1357.00	69	1655.25
NHPC	75.27	76.89	75.90	77.10	75.67	22958.62	92.30	68.66	24	76.83
NIACL [5]	132.21	133.24	132.21	133.90	131.60	280.48	214.75	130.65	19	133.15
NIBE	1008.40	998.90	1000.80	1013.10	992.30	40.22	2001.40	761.50	-	-
NIIT [2]	63.04	61.87	63.00	63.40	61.20	263.29	150.55	60.73	34	61.91
NIIT Lrn.Sys	299.25	289.20	298.00	298.00	285.75	158.48	454.00	285.75	-	-
NipponAM	850.75	848.35	830.75	857.00	829.85	770.44	1009.00	494.05	-	-
Nitco Tiles	66.99	72.65	67.53	72.95	66.16	1033.95	160.40	64.20	39	72.93
NITINSPINNER	353.65	374.70	353.65	377.95	350.60	165.68	426.95	300.00	13	374.75
Niva Bupa	71.65	71.59	71.62	72.12	71.33	1500.69	91.00	61.50	-	-
NMDC [1]	77.56	79.62	78.00	79.70	76.91	12004.16	86.74	59.66	10	79.20
NMDC Steel	35.90	36.96	36.15	37.14	35.70	2883.21	49.65	32.13	-	-
Nocil	136.45	145.29	136.00	147.00	136.01	433.34	201.49	125.35	35	145.65
Northern Arc	214.00	217.55	214.00	219.60	210.10	689.63	290.00	141.47	-	-
NRB Bearing [2]	251.40	255.35	248.00	256.50	248.00	87.36	315.70	185.00	19	254.85
NTPC Green E	84.90	86.12	84.00	86.39	84.13	8616.31	118.66	83.74	-	-
NTPC	382.40	383.35	382.95	386.25	378.30	9720.90	394.50	315.55	18	383.45
Nucle.soft L	753.40	766.85	759.45	774.70	742.20	39.93	1375.75	723.85	12	767.45
Nuvama Wealt	1158.80	1157.40	1170.00	1170.50	1139.45	91.57	1643.00	1000.00	-	-
Nuvoco Vist.	287.85	291.45	287.90	294.85	285.05	157.32	477.50	280.30	-	-
O										
OBEROI REAL	1418.10	1458.30	1435.00	1460.00	1427.30	452.60	2096.25	1396.00	31	1459.55
OCCL	86.11	85.87	86.90	87.76	82.68	144.72	159.42	72.83	-	-
Odisha Cem [2]	1853.00	1854.90	1871.30	1871.30	1844.50	99.26	2495.95	1604.00	238	1854.90
Oil Country	46.97	44.36	48.79	48.79	44.36	37.12	56.93	33.09	-	44.41
OIL INDIA	460.10	473.75	460.30	475.00	456.40	3362.64	524.15	322.15	18	473.75
Ola Electric	24.51	24.31	[illegible]	24.90	24.18	[illegible]	71.24	23.21	-	23.61
OlectraGreen	897.45	903.55	906.00	909.60	895.10	232.71	1714.20	866.60	-	-
OM Infra	83.17	88.36	83.00	89.00	82.31	279.22	146.22	82.30	-	-
OMAXE	68.59	72.37	68.90	80.98	68.30	2095.15	113.51	62.85	-	72.22
OMNITECH ENG	218.68	218.32	219.67	220.38	214.00	319.28	230.00	176.25	-	-
One Point One	45.98	45.46	45.49	45.49	44.50	495.60	71.00	41.01	-	-
OneMobikwik	185.13	181.00	186.00	186.04	179.50	662.42	354.40	174.50	-	-
OnesourceSpe	1493.20	1486.20	1482.80	1494.50	1443.00	176.58	2248.00	1057.00	-	-
ONGC [5]	261.25	264.70	261.75	265.50	259.25	15662.66	279.30	205.00	10	264.70
ONMOBILE	48.37	49.38	48.39	49.57	47.62	181.45	75.00	40.00	14	49.39
Onward Techn	225.45	230.20	229.10	235.65	228.30	61.05	382.00	206.80	16	230.40
OPTIEMUS	333.70	329.30	333.70	340.25	325.10	348.17	718.95	320.00	126	328.80
ORACLE FIN [5]	6414.00	6302.00	6450.00	6450.00	6234.50	163.87	9899.00	6308.00	-	6307.95
Orchid Phr	504.95	528.95	507.60	537.30	501.75	109.65	899.00	489.00	-	-
ORICON ENT [2]	46.18	47.20	46.43	47.62	46.10	65.75	85.39	34.00	-	47.75
ORIENT CEM [1]	133.41	136.58	133.41	137.00	132.81	408.62	362.65	131.25	9	136.50
Orient Elec.	167.99	162.65	166.55	169.77	162.00	240.12	249.80	155.35	-	-
Orient Hotel	86.53	83.66	87.67	88.00	82.68	109.90	160.00	82.05	26	87.80
Orient Paper [1]	16.08	16.01	16.05	16.41	15.93	332.65	31.54	15.70	-	15.95
Orient Tech.	264.15	263.55	265.78	268.00	260.50	153.42	513.40	254.00	-	-
Orient Tri	5.60	5.23	5.56	5.68	5.15	422.55	17.63	5.10	-	5.35
Orissa Min [1]	3509.40	3539.70	3504.00	3582.40	3504.00	12.28	6132.00	3450.00	-	3530.80
Orkla India	548.40	554.60	549.50	560.65	544.35	221.03	760.00	533.25	-	-
Osia Hyper	6.11	6.11	6.11	6.11	6.11	5.81	39.18	3.08	-	-
OswalPumps	291.80	302.90	296.00	307.30	289.65	236.06	888.40	283.10	-	-

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CHENNAI
businessline.
WEDNESDAY - MARCH 18 - 2026

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
P										
P&G Health	4902.80	4920.00	4940.00	5000.00	4893.10	6.93	6739.00	4725.00	-	-
Pace Digitek	163.90	166.90	167.50	172.98	163.20	920.16	231.95	153.05	-	-
Page Ind	30200.00	30515.00	30200.00	30675.00	30200.00	8.13	50470.60	29800.00	44	30504.05
Pakka	76.43	80.80	77.02	82.33	75.29	188.58	226.78	74.12	-	-
Panacea Bio [1]	316.80	317.20	321.65	326.00	314.30	93.11	581.00	306.00	-	317.45
Panama Pe [2]	256.20	262.55	250.00	268.70	250.00	41.73	411.15	236.00	13	263.80
ParadeepPhos	109.48	112.30	109.67	113.70	108.80	4050.75	234.39	89.73	-	-
Parag Milk	201.07	197.89	201.00	202.10	196.23	666.91	377.20	142.10	15	197.55
PARAMOUN [2]	33.21	33.75	33.21	34.55	32.67	814.44	62.39	30.73	18	33.69
Paras Defen	634.45	644.45	639.80	648.00	632.20	747.46	1945.00	608.60	-	-
Park Hotels	107.09	109.27	107.02	110.50	105.13	549.35	173.20	105.13	-	-
Park MediWo	185.15	194.74	186.49	196.25	185.12	540.63	208.72	138.10	-	-
Parsvnath [5]	6.51	6.78	6.58	7.22	6.54	615.54	27.46	6.10	-	6.80

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
SBC Exports	31.34	31.77	32.00	32.30	31.18	14819.97	32.85	10.95	-	-
SBFC Fin.	91.44	89.67	90.44	91.42	89.00	6011.17	123.00	82.00	-	-
SBI Cards	695.55	693.85	702.00	712.00	687.80	1866.24	1027.25	687.80	-	-
SBILIFE	1909.20	1932.10	1903.00	1938.70	1901.50	1255.81	2132.90	1391.15	78	1932.05
SChand Co [5]	143.05	145.85	143.20	149.90	142.34	45.43	257.50	138.55	58	147.30
SchlossBanga	415.90	407.85	415.95	419.60	403.25	375.02	474.40	382.50	-	-
ScodaTubes	117.76	121.12	118.94	123.60	116.41	145.34	230.85	110.00	-	-
SE INVESTM [1]	34.79	34.50	34.89	35.46	33.01	10687.47	41.50	29.40	15	34.61
SEDEMAC MEC	1471.00	1503.60	1471.00	1523.80	1461.00	137.31	1613.50	1413.10	-	-
Senco Gold	290.85	295.90	293.80	298.00	289.35	235.13	405.70	227.40	-	-
Senores Phar	744.30	752.75	748.00	757.20	739.25	49.73	876.50	440.30	-	-
SEPC	5.01	4.85	5.01	5.10	4.78	38018.90	16.89	4.78	-	-
Servote.Pwr	66.23	68.89	67.46	70.00	65.86	483.66	168.50	57.51	-	-
Seshaasai Te	249.97	249.24	250.00	253.99	245.60	123.90	437.45	227.01	-	-

Exchange Traded Funds

Company	Pr Cl	Cl	NSE Cl	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	BSE Cl
Zerod Top100	10.05	10.16	1456.80	11.57	8.01	-	
ZerodhaA-Gol	24.18	24.41	7374.58	27.94	12.83	-	
ZerodhAMCGil	29.99	29.98	197.25	30.94	28.71	-	
ZerodhAMCSil	24.82	25.56	13856.96	38.01	9.00	-	
ZerodhAM-Nif	9.31	9.39	2443.86	10.97	9.07	-	

*: Closing price is the average of trade price(s) for the last half an hour;52-Week High/Low figures pertain to BSE.

Shares of face value other than ₹10 is indicated in brackets immediately following the name of the company.

Qty (No of shares traded) is denoted in thousands.

The PE(price-earnings multiple) of each stock is based on the latest declared earnings.

The PE computation takes into account the per share earnings of each company for the latest 12 months.

BSE Stocks

Company	Pr Cl	Cl
ShriraPist	2940.75	2984.90
Shukra Phr [1]	40.65	40.03
Shyam Metal	760.85	776.85
Siemens En [2]	2784.00	2771.00
Sigachi [1]	18.61	18.59
SignatureG [1]	789.55	793.90
Sika Inter. [2]	948.70	914.35
Silver Touch [2]	106.05	105.75
Silverline	12.30	11.69
Sirca Paint	408.80	428.05
Sky Gold	334.35	338.75
Smallcap	39.08	39.38
Sona BLW Pr	488.80	502.25
Spandana Sph	208.95	201.55
SPEL SemiCon	129.95	133.05
SpiceJet	13.63	13.34
Spright Agr [1]	0.50	0.50
Srestha Finv. [1]	0.23	0.23
Sri Lotus De [1]	118.20	119.90
SRU Steel	1.54	1.58
Stallion India	113.35	114.00

Company	Pr Cl	Cl
Sylph Tech [1]	0.96	0.96
Syncom For [1]	11.82	11.62
Syrma SGS	727.20	764.45
Taneja Aero. [5]	245.85	248.55
Tarc [2]	123.35	120.95
Tata Capital L	309.10	310.70
Tata Tech [2]	528.55	524.70
TataMot CV [2]	437.75	441.80
TBO Tek [1]	1180.40	1176.95
TCPL Packag	2495.35	2417.65
Techno Elec [2]	1080.35	1093.40
Tejas Netwrk	447.15	444.20
TennecoCle	527.75	526.50
TGV Sracc	79.22	80.99
Tilak Vent [1]	0.90	0.89
Timex Group [1]	271.15	280.45
Titan Biotec [2]	350.15	367.45
Titan Int [1]	0.69	0.66
TMB	602.95	609.40
Toyam Spor [1]	0.81	0.78
Transrail Li [2]	491.35	497.10

Company	Pr Cl	Cl
Vashu Bhagn	52.86	51.07
Vedant Fash [1]	337.45	340.90
Veeram Sec [2]	9.96	9.98
Vidya Wires Li	53.14	53.93
Vikas Life [1]	1.26	1.25
Vikram Solar L	182.55	185.25
Vikran Eng [1]	60.28	60.14
Vintage Coff.	122.70	123.10
Visagar Fin [1]	0.32	0.30
Vish.Pr.Pung	36.65	36.53
VishalMega	106.10	103.25
VL e-Govn	12.08	12.15
Waaree Enr	2790.35	2881.95
Waaree Re.T[2]	811.05	826.25
Wakefit Innova	156.25	157.55
Wardwiz.Inn [1]	6.13	6.01
Welcure Dr [1]	0.27	0.27
Welsp SplSol [6]	35.23	35.16
Westrn.Carr. [5]	93.05	91.80
WPIL [1]	385.95	380.80
Yatharth Hsp	650.25	657.30

NSE Trade for Trade